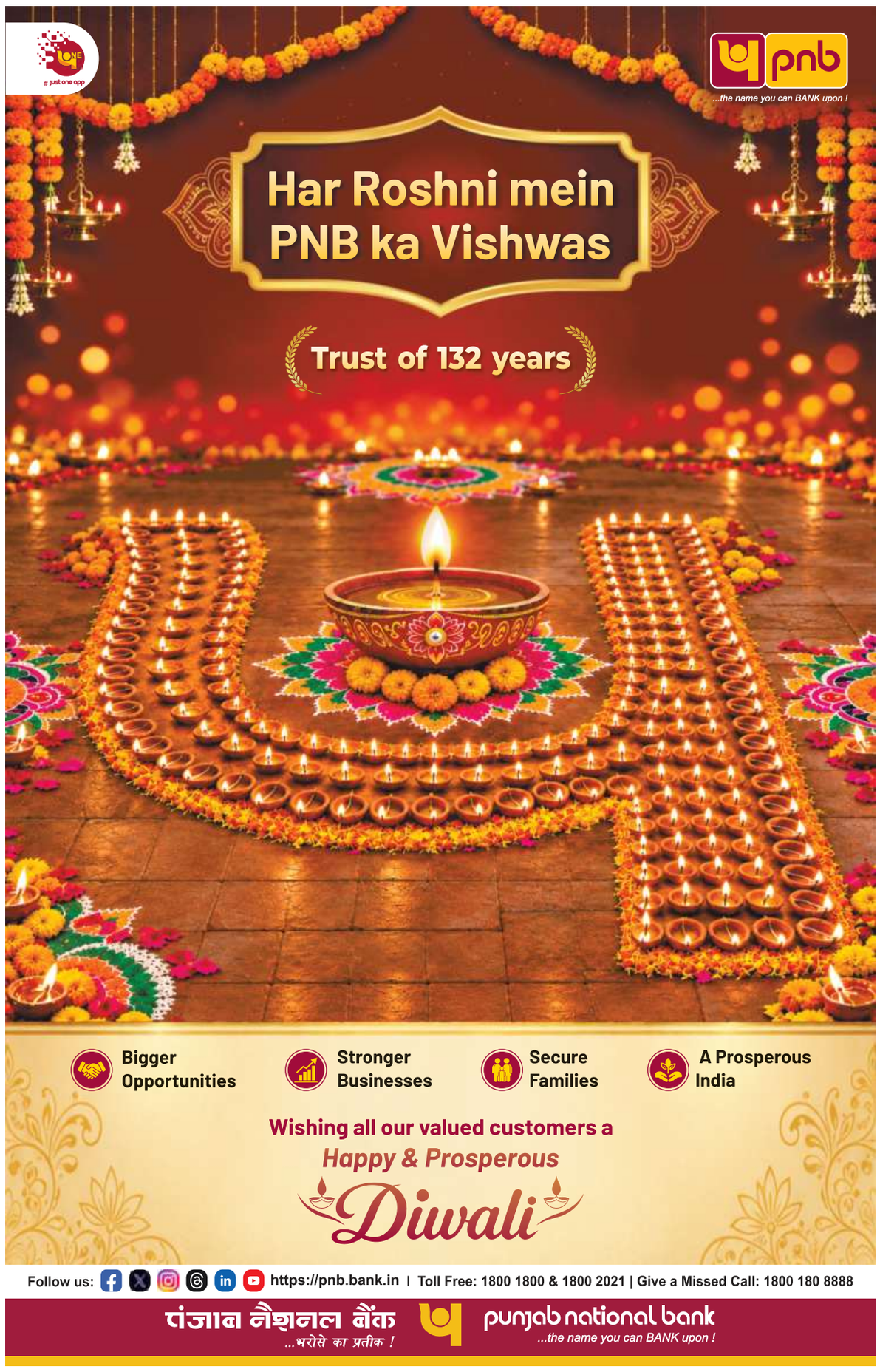
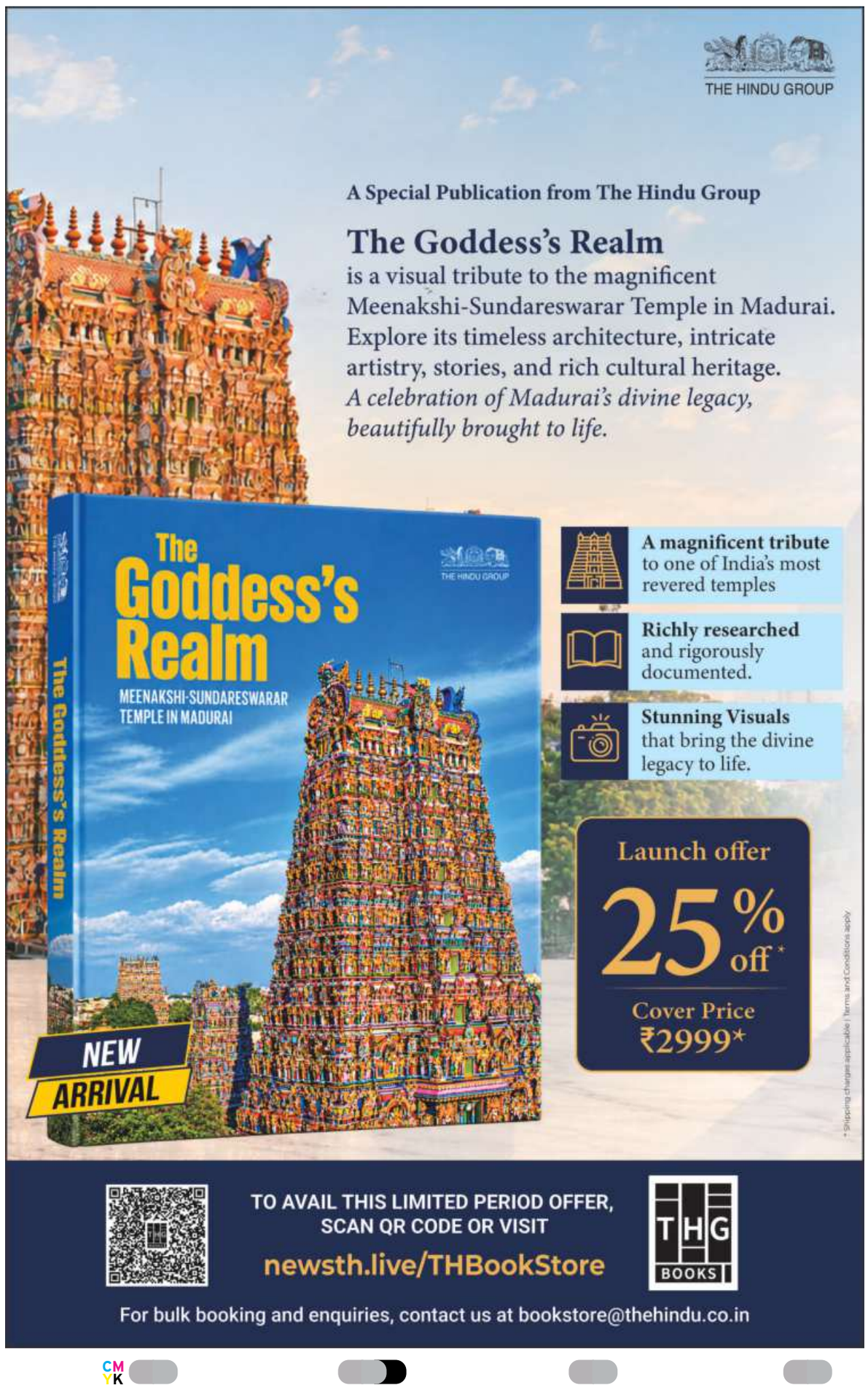

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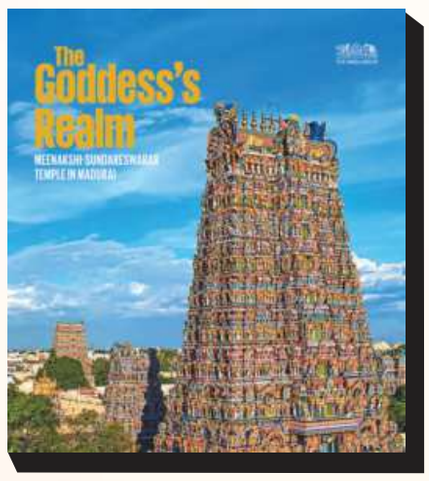
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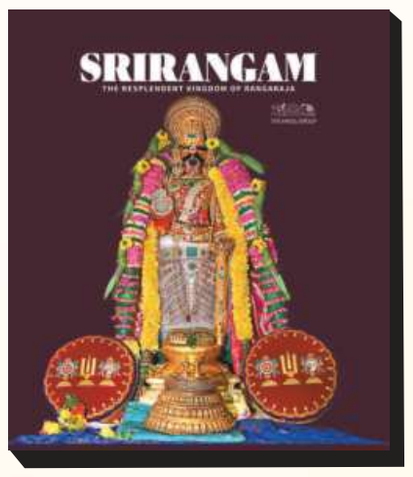
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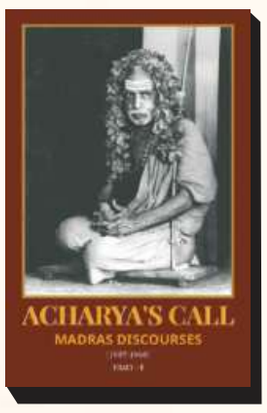
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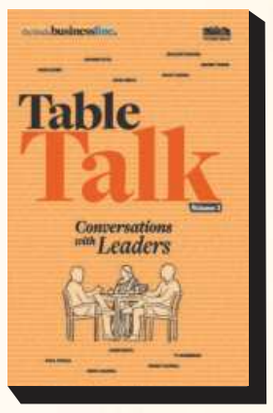
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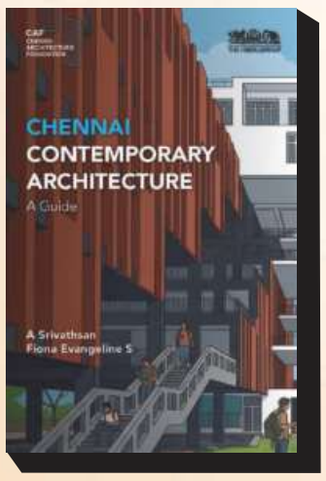


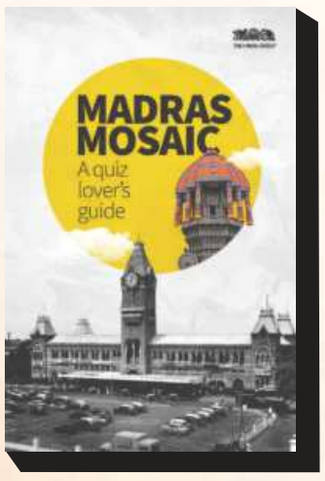


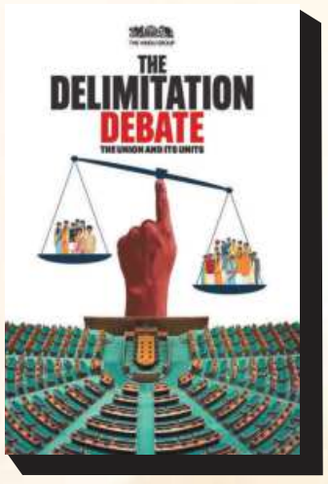


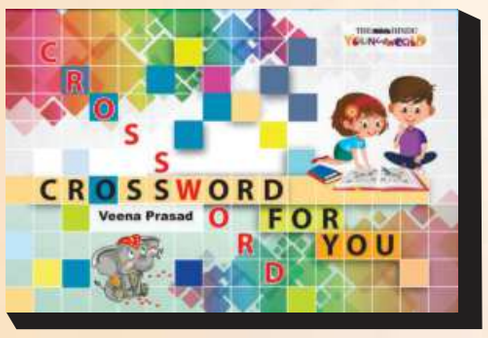


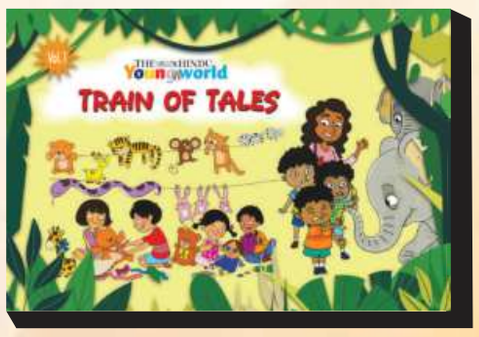












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A LEADER'S STORY

Where I truly belong

This is not a political book. It is a personal one, says Sonia Gandhi as she shares excerpts from her memoir

MAGAZINE » PAGE 1



ED not a 'super cop', can't file private complaint: HC

ED's power under PMLA is 'derivative and not original', says Karnataka HC; it adds that the agency can't prosecute an offence on its own when competent agencies decline to act on its information

Krishnaprasad
BENGALURU

Declaring that the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) is "not a super cop," the High Court of Karnataka said the agency cannot file a private complaint to initiate a money-laundering probe when the competent agencies decline to prosecute a scheduled offence based on the information filed by the ED.

The court ruled that the ED's power under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act (PMLA) is "derivative and not original," and that filing a private complaint under Section 200 of the Code of Criminal Procedure or Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita was not contemplated under the PMLA Act.

> One institution in the country does not become supreme so that it is in a position to abuse the powers conferred on it. Law recognises the requirements of checks and balances
> KARNATAKA HIGH COURT



"One institution in the country does not become supreme so that it is in a position to abuse the powers conferred on it. Law recognises the requirements of checks and balances. The ED is not a super cop to investigate anything and everything which comes into its notice," the court said, adding that the ED must exercise only those powers expressly conferred on it by the PMLA.

Justice M.I. Arun passed the order while allowing a batch of writ petitions filed by Malur MLA and Congress leader K.Y. Nanjegowda, who also chairs the Kolar and Chikkaballapur Milk Union Ltd. (KOMUL) and the Malur Land Grant Committee, and others.

Case background

The case stemmed from a private complaint about an alleged "land scam" on the basis of which the ED registered an Enforcement Case Information Report (ECIR) in November 2023. While probing this, the ED reportedly found evidence of a "job scam" involving KOMUL, and shared its information with the police. As they did not act on this information, the ED itself filed a private complaint on this matter.

The petitioners challenged the ED's ECIR, the order confirming seizure of articles, summons issued to them, and the private complaint filed by the ED before a special court.

"If the ED is permitted to file a private complaint, it will be in a position to file a private complaint against any person by itself and take up investigation against them. This is not contemplated under the provisions of the PMLA," the court clarified.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 9

Rahul asks how much ethanol is actually in petrol, calls for action

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Alleging that the amount of ethanol being blended into petrol was, in many cases, higher than the specified limit, Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi on Saturday cited a report by the Karnataka government's Department of Food, Civil Supplies, Consumer Affairs and Legal Metrology, saying that 11 out of 14 samples tested by the State government contained more than 20% ethanol.

"E20 turned into 420 – stealing petrol from the public's cars," Mr. Gandhi said in a social media post. E20 is the ethanol-petrol blend, which is supposed to have only 20% ethanol, that is available in petrol pumps across the country.

Seeks answers

He demanded an answer from Prime Minister Narendra Modi. "Mr. Modi, tell us – what's being put in the country's tank? How much ethanol is actually in the petrol? When will action be taken against companies mixing in more than 20%? And the challenge to debate still stands. We'll add this issue too – who is actually benefiting from your policies?" Mr. Gandhi said.


Rahul Gandhi

The Centre has rejected Mr. Gandhi's allegations and questioned the sampling method used in the report.

CONTINUED ON » PAGE 9

IN BRIEF

Akhilesh to visit Ram Temple on December 12

LUCKNOW
Samajwadi Party chief Akhilesh Yadav will visit the Ram Temple in Ayodhya on December 12, former SP MLA Pawan Pandey said on Saturday, an announcement set to spice up politics in the State ahead of Assembly poll in 2027. The ruling BJP has been targeting Mr. Yadav for not visiting the temple. » Page 4

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CLASSIFIEDS » PAGE 6
MAGAZINE » 8 PAGES

Punjab records 3,000 stubble burning cases as Tarn Taran tops list; 795 FIRs registered

Press Trust of India
CHANDIGARH

The number of stubble burning incidents in Punjab has crossed the 3,000 mark, with Tarn Taran, Ferozepur and Sangrur accounting for the bulk of the cases, the Punjab Pollution Control Board (PPCB) said on Saturday.

According to PPCB data, the State recorded 3,144 farm fire incidents between September 15 and November 6, up from 2,787 cases reported till November 5. Tarn Taran reported the highest number of farm fires at 611, followed by Ferozepur at 410, Sangrur at 281, Bathinda at 262 and Amritsar at 231, the data showed. Fines amounting to ₹54.55 lakh have been imposed as environmental compensation in 1,077 cases so far, of which ₹30.05 lakh has been recovered, according to PPCB data. The data also showed that 795 FIRs were registered in connection with farm fire incidents during this period under Section 223 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), which deals with disobedience of an order promulgated by a public servant.


Smoke billowing from a paddy field as a farmer burns post-harvest crop stubble on the outskirts of Amritsar on Nov. 4. PTI

State authorities have also made 931 red entries in the land records of farmers found burning crop residues, including 301 in Tarn Taran and 98 in Ferozepur.

Stubble burning in Punjab and Haryana is often blamed for the rise in air pollution in Delhi-NCR.

With the window for sowing the rabi crop, wheat, being very short after the paddy harvest in October and November, some farmers set their fields on fire to quickly clear the crop residue.

AIR QUALITY 'VERY POOR' » PAGE 2

Fourth judge quits SIR tribunals in Bengal

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Retired Calcutta High Court judge Biswajit Basu resigned from a special intensive revision (SIR) tribunal on Saturday citing personal reasons, becoming the fourth judge to step down from the Election Commission of India (ECI)-constituted tribunals. Nineteen appellate tribunals are tasked with hearing about 38 lakh appeals of voters deleted from the electoral rolls in West Bengal.

The retired judge had earlier expressed unhappiness with the functioning of tribunals. "Resolving lakhs of cases in this manner is a little difficult. Since this has been done on the directions of Supreme Court, it has to be carried out," he had said. He has sent his resignation to Chief Justice of Calcutta High Court Ravindra Vithalrao Ghuge. Justice Basu (retd.) has also been appointed as Chairman of the Commission on Institutional Corruption by the BJP government.

Retired judge Biswajit Basu had earlier expressed unhappiness with the tribunals' functioning

The ECI had constituted 19 appellate tribunals to hear appeals related to the inclusion or exclusion of voters in the electoral rolls as part of the SIR exercise in the State. These tribunals were headed by retired judges of the Calcutta High Court. Judges who have resigned from these tribunals so far include former Calcutta High Court Chief Justice T.S. Sivagnanam, Justice Ranjit Kumar Bag (retd.) and Justice Indrajit Chatterjee (retd.).

All the judges who have resigned from the tribunals have cited personal reasons for their decision to quit. Justice Sivagnanam (retd.) was the first to quit in May 2026, followed by Justice Bag (retd.) and Justice Chatterjee (retd.).

The judges presiding over the tribunals had also expressed displeasure over the slow pace of disposal of pending applications. The SIR, held from October 2025 to February 2026, resulted in the deletion of 91 lakh electors.



Delhi's air quality stays 'very poor', set to worsen to 'severe' during Deepavali

Dwarka, IIT Delhi, ITO, Alipur and Bawana continuing to reel under 'severe' pollution; CM appeals people to celebrate Deepavali in an 'eco-friendly and safe manner'; five held in north-east Delhi for the illegal sale, storage of firecrackers

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Delhi's overall air quality remained in the 'very poor' category for the sixth consecutive day on Saturday, with Dwarka, IIT Delhi, ITO, Alipur and Bawana continuing to reel under 'severe' pollution, according to official data. The air quality is expected to deteriorate further and remain in the 'severe' category over the Deepavali period, from Saturday to Monday, the Air Quality Early Warning System for Delhi stated.

Despite the Supreme Court order this week allowing firecrackers to be burst only between 8 p.m. and 10 p.m., people continued to set them off across the city beyond the permitted hours.



Firecrackers burst beyond the 8 p.m. to 10 p.m. window as Delhi's AQI stood at 362 at 4 p.m. on Saturday . SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Chief Minister's appeal

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta appealed to Delhiites to celebrate Deepavali in an eco-friendly and safe manner. She urged them to use green firecrackers in accordance with the prescribed norms and celebrate the festival with *diyas*, rangoli, sweets and a spirit of mutual harmony. "Delhi is my family, and ensuring a better life, a secure future and dignity for every member of this family is my government's highest priority," she said, according to a statement from the Chief Minister's Office (CMO).

Ms. Gupta said Delhiites had celebrated Deepavali together at 'Jugmug Diwali' at Central Park in Connaught Place, which featured a drone show and diyas. The event, inaugurated by the Chief Minister on Friday, concluded on Saturday.

In figures

Delhi's 24-hour average air quality index (AQI) stood at 362 ('very poor') at 4 p.m. on Saturday, down from 382 ('very poor') a day earlier, according to the Central Pollution Control Board's (CPCB) daily bulletin. The AQI measures air pollution on a scale of 0 to 500. A reading of 201-300 is classified as 'poor', 301-400 as 'very poor', 401-450 as 'severe' and 451-500 as 'severe plus'.

The contribution of stubble burning in neighbouring States to PM2.5 levels in Delhi on Saturday was expected to be 1.7%, down from 7.9% on Friday, according to data from the Union Ministry of Earth Sciences. Meanwhile, the Delhi police arrested five persons in separate cases for the illegal sale and storage of firecrackers in north-east Delhi and seized 91.9 kg of fireworks, an official said on Saturday.

The cases were registered at the Jyoti Nagar, Shastri Park and Dayalpur police stations as part of a district-wide crackdown on unauthorised firecrackers.

Construction curbs force many migrant workers to return home

Shrimansi Kaushik
NEW DELHI

The ban on dust-generating construction and demolition activities across the Delhi-National Capital Region (NCR) to curb winter air pollution has brought construction work to a halt, forcing hundreds of migrant workers to return to their home States or seek alternative employment.

The Commission for Air Quality Management (CAQM) on October 31 imposed a ban on dust-generating construction and demolition activities across the NCR and adjoining areas from November 5 to 20, exempting essential public infrastructure projects, including metro, railway and healthcare facilities. Separately, the Delhi government imposed similar restrictions from November 1 to January 31.

Bimala Kumari, a construction worker from Etah in Uttar Pradesh, has had to rely on friends working as domestic helps to find employment for the winter months. She is now working as a domestic worker. "We have been told by the contractor that there will be no work until February. We were unaware of the pollution-related restrictions before coming to Delhi two months ago," she said, adding, "I am now working as a domestic help and hoping to support my daughters."



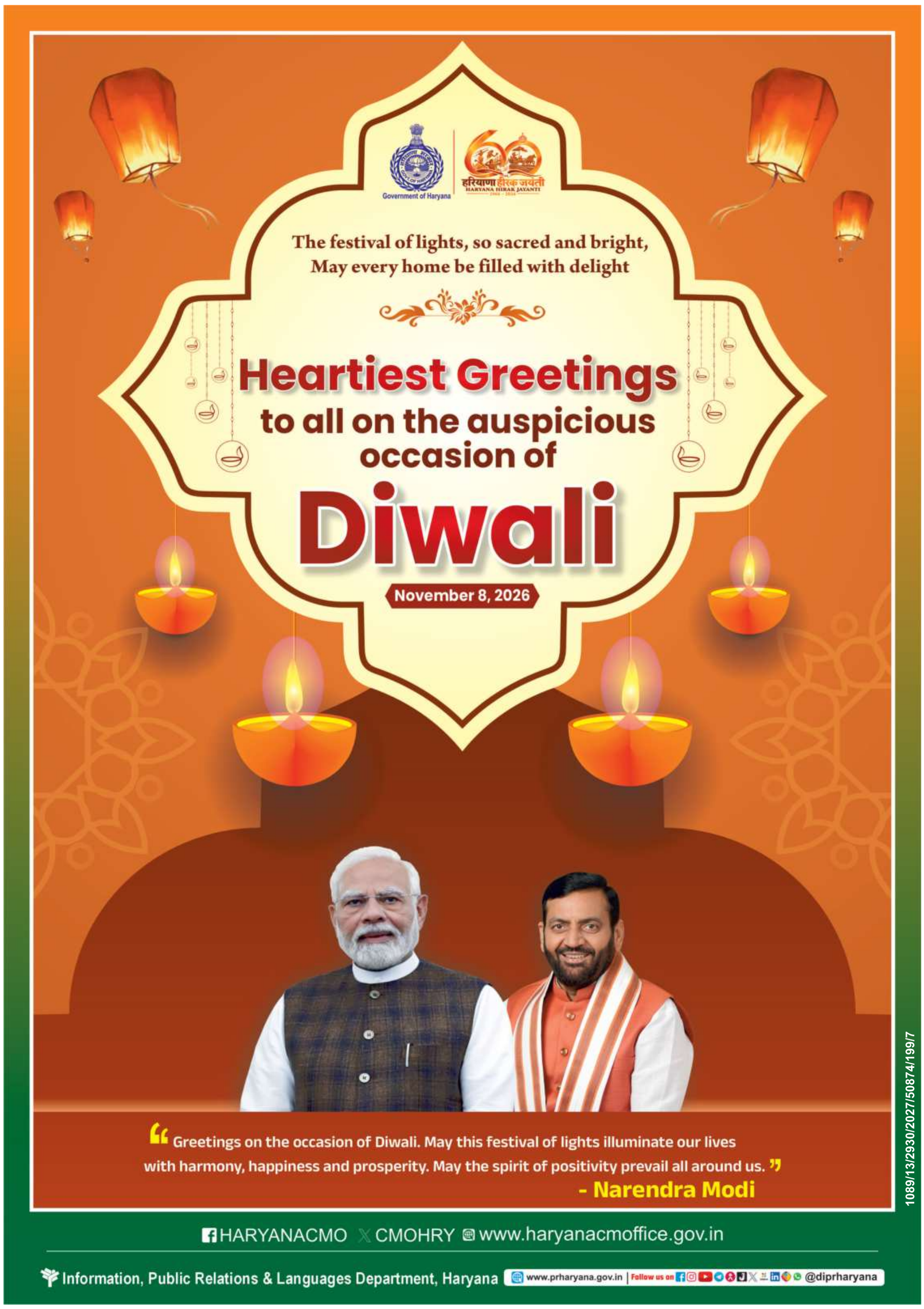
Construction activity remains suspended across Delhi-NCR till Jan. 31. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Tabrez, a construction worker from Shakarpur in east Delhi, said his contractor had asked workers to look for alternative employment. He has since returned to his native village in Bihar. Workers who had hoped to find employment in neighbouring areas such as Gautam Buddha Nagar and Faridabad have now found those options drying up as well.

Projects shelved

The restrictions have also caused difficulties for homeowners with ongoing construction projects.

Mukesh Kumar, a resident of Mahavir Enclave in south-west Delhi, had hired a contractor a month ago to rebuild his house from scratch. "This is a major setback for me, as I had moved into a rented apartment with my family while the house was being rebuilt," he said.





Authorities suspect that one more person remains trapped under the rubble. SHASHI SHEKHAR KASHYAP

Old Delhi building collapse toll rises to six; owner arrested

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The death toll in the collapse of a three-storey building in old Delhi's Chawri Bazar rose to six on Saturday after four more bodies were recovered from the rubble, an official said.

The four workers whose bodies were recovered on Saturday were identified as Pankaj Sharma, 42, Vipin Ram, 40, Shantu, 22, and Dinesh Sah. The bodies of two workers recovered on Thursday were identified as Kishori Sah, 40, and Sanjeet Kumar, 45. All six were from Bihar. The two injured workers, who were pulled out of the debris along with Kishori and Sanjeet, were reported to be stable and undergoing treatment at a hospital, the official added.

Owner arrested

Meanwhile, the Delhi police on Saturday arrested the building owner, Saimullah alias Ayub, a resident of Gali Shahtara. Three contractors, Siraj, Tajuddin and Furkan, were arrested on Friday from Faridabad.

All four have been booked under Sections 105 (culpable homicide not amounting to murder), 290 (negligent conduct in constructing or repairing buildings), 125(a) (rash or negligent acts endangering human life and causing hurt) and 3(5) (acts committed by several persons in furtherance of their common intention) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita.

Rescue continues

Rescue and debris-clearance operations continued on Saturday, with narrow lanes and space constraints in the congested market area preventing the use of heavy machinery, including earthmovers.

Harish Mathur, District Project Officer, Delhi Disaster Management Authority (DDMA), old Delhi, who is coordinating the operation, told *The Hindu* that at least one more person is suspected to be trapped under the rubble.

According to the police, around 15 construction workers were present at the site when the building collapsed. Four labourers had been rescued by nearby residents and taken to hospital soon after the collapse.

The rescue team comprises 38 personnel from the National Disaster Response Force, 30 labourers from the Municipal Corporation of Delhi and 10 to 12 personnel from the Delhi Fire Services. A DDMA team is also assisting, while an incident command post has been established to coordinate the operation.

Faridabad: neighbour kills man over parking dispute

The Hindu Bureau
GURUGRAM

A 42-year-old senior executive of a Singapore-based IT company was shot dead allegedly by his neighbour following an argument over parking in Faridabad's Sector 21C on Friday evening, a police officer said, adding that the accused, Mohan Sharma, was arrested on Saturday.

According to the officer, Paramjith Dhankhar had returned from Singapore two days earlier. His son Shaurya, 19, who witnessed the incident, escaped unhurt.

"About 14 to 15 rounds were fired, of which eight or nine hit the victim. A murder case has been registered against the accused," said Surajkund SHO Prahlad Kumar.

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INBRIEF



Shah reviews Gujarat-related matters, chairs MHA meeting

Union Home Minister Amit Shah on Saturday chaired a high-level meeting in Ahmedabad to review matters related to Gujarat with senior officials from various divisions of the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA). Chief Minister Bhupendra Patel and Minister of State for Home Harsh Sanghavi also attended the meeting. "Union Home Minister and Minister of Cooperation Amit Shah *ji* chaired a meeting on State-related subjects with various divisions of the MHA," an official release stated. PTI

Sanitation workers resume work after talks with M.P. CM

Sanitation workers across Madhya Pradesh resumed door-to-door garbage collection on Saturday morning after calling off their four-day strike following late-night talks with Chief Minister Mohan Yadav, officials said. According to the sanitation workers' union, the breakthrough came after the State government agreed to initiate the regularisation process for workers employed for 25 days a month, a move expected to raise their monthly wages from ₹10,500 to up to ₹20,000. PTI

Akhilesh to pay a visit to Ram Temple on Dec. 12; Adityanath seeks apology

SP chief's move is being interpreted as party leadership experimenting with 'soft Hindutva'; U.P. CM wants him to repent for 'neglect, insults and past actions' before stepping into Ayodhya shrine

Press Trust of India
LUCKNOW



Akhilesh Yadav last visited Ayodhya in October 2026 to attend a religious *katha*. FILE PHOTO

Samajwadi Party (SP) chief Akhilesh Yadav will visit the Ram Temple in Ayodhya on December 12, former party MLA Pawan Pandey said on Saturday, an announcement set to spice up politics in the key Hindi heartland State ahead of the Assembly poll in early 2027.

The ruling BJP has been targeting Mr. Yadav for not visiting the Ram Temple over "appeasement politics", while the SP chief has been vociferously raising the issue of *chanda chori* in the Ram Temple and blaming the BJP and Sangh Parivar outfits.

"Both Akhilesh*ji* and his wife Dimple Yadav*ji* will visit Ram Temple and also visit the Hanumangarhi temple at Ayodhya on December 12," Mr. Pandey, who has again been named SP candidate from Ayodhya, told media persons in Ayodhya.

The announcement comes as the Yogi Adityanath-led U.P. government focuses on organising grand Deepotsav celebrations in Ayodhya.

Mr. Yadav's proposed visit is set to stir political discourse in the State and will be his first visit to the grand temple since its January 2024 inauguration. He last visited Ayodhya in October 2026 to attend a religious *katha*.

It is being interpreted as SP leadership experimenting with "soft Hindutva" in an apparent bid to counter the BJP, which has consistently reminded the masses about the police firing in Ayodhya on unarmed karsevaks in the 1990s, when the SP government led by Mulayam Singh was in power.

Mr. Yadav has so far countered all queries about his Ram Temple visit, saying it would happen only after the SP-built Kedareshwar Dham in Etawah is completed.

'Repent for actions'

Reacting to the SP's announcement on temple visit, Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath said "those who had fired on Ram devotees, subjected saints to lathi charge, and ignored Ayodhya" should only visit the Ram Temple after apologising to the devotees and saints.

"Those who had neglected and insulted (Ayodhya), who had opened fire on Ram devotees and subjected saints to lathi charge, should certainly come to Ayodhya, but only after apologising. Let them apologise once to Ram devotees and once to the saints. Let them repent for their actions," he said, while addressing the 10th edition of Deepotsav.

T.N. CM writes to PM over Mekedatu dam project inspection

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI



C. Joseph Vijay

Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Saturday wrote to Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressing concern over the site inspection conducted by Central officials in connection with the Karnataka government's proposal for the Mekedatu dam.

He urged Mr. Modi to ensure that no statutory or administrative approvals are granted without the consent of the co-basin States, while emphasising the need for sustained availability of water in the Cauvery basin of Tamil Nadu. In his letter, he said there was an apprehension growing among farmers of Tamil Nadu over the recent developments with respect to the proposed Mekedatu Dam Project of Karnataka.

"The said proposal of Government of Karnataka to construct Mekedatu reservoir across Cauvery with a huge capacity of 67.16 TMC, just upstream of inter-State border between Karnataka and Tamil Nadu, would not only prevent the flows due to Tamil Nadu but also prejudicially affect the monthly deliveries to the inhabitants of Cauvery Basin of Tamil Nadu, as stipulated by the Hon'ble Supreme Court," Mr. Vijay said in his letter.

There have been frequent news reports on Karnataka Chief Minister's meeting with the officials of Ministry of Jal Shakti and Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change for clearance of detailed project report of Mekedatu Project, without the concurrence of Tamil Nadu, Mr. Vijay said.

"Earlier, a team of officers of the Government of India reportedly visited the proposed Mekedatu Dam site, as per the statements emanating from the State of Karnataka," he said.

Patnaik visits flood-hit Ganjam district amid BJP's 'missing' jibe

Satyasundar Barik
BHUBANESWAR



Naveen Patnaik visiting flood-hit Ganjam district on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Odisha Leader of the Opposition and former Chief Minister Naveen Patnaik on Saturday visited Ganjam, his home district, which was badly affected by floods caused by Cyclone Arnab.

His visit came after the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) accused him of being indifferent to his own constituency.

Posters portraying Mr. Patnaik as "missing" also appeared in Hinjili. Ten days ago, extremely heavy rainfall battered Ganjam, rendering thousands of families homeless, destroying acres of paddy crops.

Locals share plight

"Thousands of people gathered at different locations to meet Mr. Patnaik and share their plight with their leader. Farmers, carrying damaged paddy stalks and sugarcane plants, expressed anguish over their losses, alleging that government apathy in managing the floods had ruined their livelihoods," the Biju Janata Dal (BJD) said in a statement.

"The BJP government in Odisha failed to make a proper disaster plan ahead of Cyclone Arnab that made landfall in Andhra Pradesh. There was warning of heavy rain over southern Odisha districts, yet the administration moved in a lackadaisical manner exposing people to the fury of nature," said Sujata Rout, who recently joined the BJD.

2 more children test positive for Shigella infection in Keralam

The Hindu Bureau
KOZHIKODE

Two more children from Meppayil Senior Basic School, Kozhikode, Keralam, who were admitted to hospital with vomiting, fever, and diarrhoea, have been diagnosed with shigellosis.

One of the three children admitted to the Government District Hospital had fallen ill earlier. Blood tests on all three children have now returned positive. The children are aged 7, 8, and 10. Initial blood tests had returned negative results.

Children showing symptoms have been arriving at hospitals since last Friday.

Over Saturday, Sunday, and Monday, a total of 104 people suffered from vomiting, fever, and diarrhoea.

Patients sought treatment at private hospitals as well as the Government District Hospital.

Those affected had eaten egg curry and curd as part of their school lunch.

Teams from the Health and Education departments, led by the District Medical Officer, inspected the school.

Students are no Savarkars to apologise, says Prakash Raj

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

Actor and activist Prakash Raj said here on Saturday that "the youth of the country are not Savarkars to write sorry petitions for raising questions and protesting for their rights."



In solidarity: Prakash Raj at the protest site in the Sanskrit varsity in Kalady on Saturday.

"This generation is not violent like your Godse. They protest with the strength of what Gandhi taught them. They ask questions empowered by the rights Babasaheb Ambedkar gave them," he said, after expressing solidarity with the relay fast organised by the suspended activists of the Students Federation of India at the Sree Sankaracharya University of Sanskrit at Kalady, Keralam.

He was referring to the Syndicate's decision to withdraw their suspension once they submitted an apology stating that they will not breach disciplinary norms in the future.

Sixteen students were suspended in connection with the protests held on campus on August 13, which took place while the first meeting of the re-constituted Syndicate was in progress.

'Dictatorial attitude'

He said that the university authorities and the Keralam's Higher Education Minister Roji M. John were showing "a dictatorial attitude" towards the protest.

The actor said he would join the protesting students if they were not allowed to appear for exams.

SPOTLIGHT

A bridge between past and present

A German publication ranked Bihar Museum among the best in the world. A gist of what went into the making of the museum and what visitors think of its contribution to the development of Indian civilization

Mayank Kumar

On November 3, Soumya Pathak, 23, a final-year medical student studying at a medical college in Ambala, Haryana, is exploring exhibits showcasing relics from prehistoric times at the Bihar Museum in Patna. Pathak belongs to Muzaffarpur in Bihar, and is looking at some coins from the Mauryan (321-185 B.C.E) and Gupta ages (early 4th to mid-6th Century C.E.).

She passes through interactive galleries which highlight Bihar's pivotal role in shaping two major world religions: Jainism and Buddhism. "I have been thinking of coming here for a long time, but after reading on social media that the museum is ranked the best in Asia, I decided to spend a day here," she says. Pathak is enroute to Muzaffarpur for the Deepavali holidays and came to the museum directly from Patna's Jay Prakash Narayan airport, about four kilometres away. Pathak is proud of her State that is often in the news for poverty and violence.

Last week, Bihar Museum was ranked as the ninth best in the world and first in Asia by Germany-based international travel guide *Worth a Journey*. It made headlines with the Bihar government's Department of Tourism sharing the information, bringing back in focus Bihar's contribution to the development of Indian historic civilization.

An ode to museology

Pathak stands alongside Aishwarya, a Class VIII student from a Kendriya Vidyalaya, paying close attention to the school's history teacher, who is talking to the students about Didarganj Yakshi, a life-size, free-standing female figure representing a yakshi (a nature spirit or fertility deity) from the Mauryan period.

"I had never paid this kind of attention in my history classes in school," Pathak says, adding that it is wonderful to see students so involved. "Reading about an ancient artefact in a book can feel disconnected, but seeing, smelling, and interacting with the actual objects bridge that gap," Pathak says. PM SHRI, Kendriya Vidyalaya, Sasaram, is roughly 150 kilometres away and students from the school are in Patna for the museum visit.

Located in the heart of Patna, the Bihar Museum is a showcase of the State's distinguished history and dynamic culture. "Since its opening in 2015, the museum has become a popular destination for visitors from around the world," says Ram Kumar Singh, a mobile water vendor adjoining the museum at the busy Bailey Road.



Designed by Japan's Maki & Associates in partnership with _Opolis Architects, Bihar Museum combines traditional storytelling with the contemporary principles of New Museology. MAYANK KUMAR

Spread across 13.5 acres, the museum, in a series of buildings celebrates Bihar's historical and cultural legacy. Designed by Japan's Maki & Associates in partnership with Pune-based _Opolis Architects, it combines traditional storytelling with the contemporary principles of New Museology. Its architecture brings together open spaces, natural light, and technology to provide visitors with an engaging experience, rather than the museum just being a documenter of the past.

Anjani Kumar Singh, the Director General of the Bihar Museum, says, "The Japanese concept of oku, a sense of spatial depth that creates anticipation before revelation, runs through the entire complex, culminating in the meditative Buddha courtyard at the museum's heart. What the Bihar Museum understood, perhaps better than most institutions of its generation, is that a museum is not merely a vessel for objects or a storehouse of artefacts. It is a cultural centre, a living space built for and around the people of Bihar: their stories, their artists and their aspirations."

At the entrance of the Bihar Museum is a plaque that tells how this modern museum came into being. The seeds of the Bihar Museum, the message says, were sown when museologists found that the Patna Museum, established in 1917, with 40,000 artefacts, had run out of space. It had been called 'Jadoo Ghar' or House of Magic, and only a fraction of its collection was on view.

"In this context, then Chief Minister Nitish Kumar conceptualised the Bihar Museum, a vision connecting the past of Bihar with its future," the plaque reads. In his inaugural address Kumar had said, "Though Bihar may have lost its mineral wealth with the creation of Jharkhand, its true wealth lies in its rich cultural heritage."

Umesh Chandra Tiwari, a visitor from Buxar, a district through which river Ganga flows, says the museum rekindles a sense of pride among Biharis, but also positions the State as a significant player on the global cultural tourism map. He has been visiting the place almost every year, since 2018.

Tiwari says, "This museum also showcases Bihar's contributions to Sikhism through its connection to Guru Gobind Singh, who was born in Patna. The gallery includes Sufi manuscripts, Sikh relics, and artefacts from Sher Shah Suri's reign, showcasing the cultural and religious diversity that defined Bihar." He wishes he had this museum during his growing up years in the 1970s. "Then there were no such spaces in Bihar, which brought together cultural, historical, religious, and artistic aspects." He stops at Gallery C, which traces Bihar's medieval transformation under the Mughals and other rulers.

The Orientation Gallery serves as an entry point, engaging visitors with an audio-visual experience that introduces the narrative of Bihar's ancient greatness. The galleries are organised thematically and chronologically, offering visitors a journey through the era of Bihar's history. The museum summarises Bihar's evolution.

Philip Mill, from Birmingham, England, is surprised by the collection Kurkihar Buddha bronze sculptures. "The Museum is quite good. It is taking us to the paleolithic and stone age through the Mauryan, Gupta, and Pala dynasties. For me, the Kurkihar Buddha bronze sculptures and the Kushan-period stone slabs depicting the birth of the Buddha are the key attractions," he says. The sculptures are a collection of ancient metalwork discovered in Kurkihar, a historic Buddhist monastic site near Gaya, dating to between the 9th and 12th Century C.E. Philip says he came to Bihar only for the museum and will depart to Kolkata soon.

The making

The displays, like most modern museums, are a mix of permanent galleries and temporary exhibitions. "For several centuries, the rulers of Magadha governed from Pataliputra, the city beneath modern Patna, and the museum positions that fact not as distant antiquity but as living inheritance," says Anjani, the Director General.

Anjani, a former Bihar Chief Secretary who played a pivotal role in establishment of the Museum, adds, "It is the museum's breadth beyond history that distinguishes it most sharply from its predecessors. A Diaspora Gallery acknowledges the Bihari communities who left and kept carrying their culture with them. A Regional Art Gallery honours the traditions that rarely found their way into official collections."

Pathak, who wishes to become a plastic surgeon, says she likes the Regional Art Gallery the most. It exhibits Bihar's handloom and handicraft, folk culture, and customs.

mayank.kumar@thehindu.co.in

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Govt. of Uttarakhand

Celebration of Service, Good Governance, and Devotion

Uttarakhand Formation Day

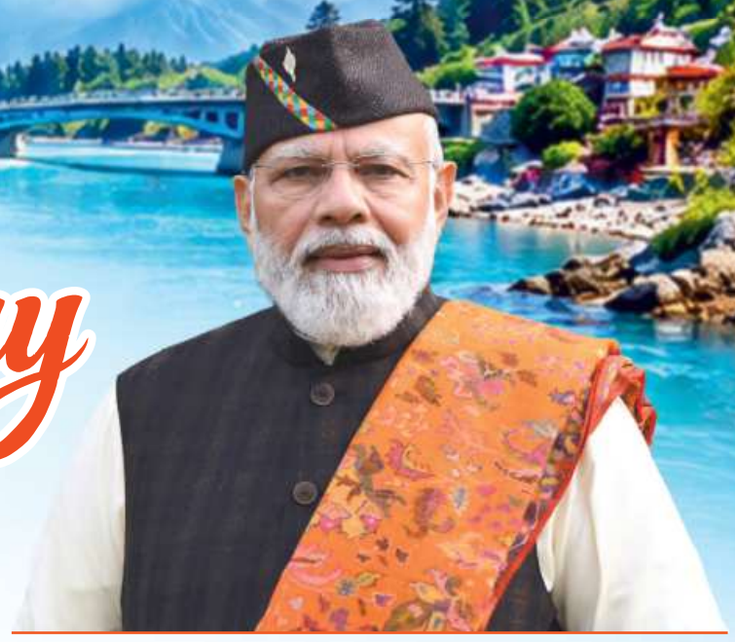
9 November



Greetings & Best Wishes

"Heartiest congratulations and best wishes to the divine people of the state on the occasion of Uttarakhand State Formation Day. Under the guidance of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, Uttarakhand is attaining new heights of development, prosperity, and self-reliance. Realizing the resolve of a developed Uttarakhand, we are committed to making a significant contribution to building a developed India by the year 2047. Come, let us all unite on State Formation Day and take a pledge to build the Uttarakhand of our dreams."

Pushkar Singh Dhami
Chief Minister, Uttarakhand



"The construction of a developed India in the 21st century rests on two main pillars: first, pride in our heritage, and second, making every possible effort for development. Today, Uttarakhand is continuously strengthening both these pillars. This decade is the decade of Uttarakhand"

Narendra Modi
Prime Minister

Devbhoomi Uttarakhand

PRIDE IN HERITAGE, CONFIDENCE IN DEVELOPMENT AND A RESOLVE FOR A SELF-RELIANT FUTURE

Governance and Historic Decisions

- First state in independent India to implement the Uniform Civil Code (UCC).
- Implementation of a strong land law, stringent anti-conversion law, and anti-riot law.
- Transparency in the recruitment process ensured through the anti-cheating law.
- 10% horizontal reservation in government jobs for statehood activists and 30% for women.

Youth Power and Employment

- Over 35,000 government jobs provided to youths in 5 years.
- More than 38,550 beneficiaries under the Chief Minister Self-Employment Scheme (Mukhyamantri Swarozgar Yojana).
- Over 3.10 lakh women became Lakhpati Didis.
- 10% horizontal reservation for Agniveers in Group-C uniformed services.

Investment and Economic Growth

- MoUs worth ₹3.56 lakh crores signed at the Global Investor Summit.
- Grounding of investments exceeding ₹1 lakh crore.
- Sales of "House of Himalayas" crossed ₹6 crores.
- Solar power generation exceeding 1,027 megawatts.

Health and Education

- Over 63.32 lakh Ayushman cards issued.
- More than 17.36 lakh patients provided with cashless treatment worth over ₹3,717 crore.
- First state in the country to implement the National Education Policy (NEP).
- 85% construction work of the Kichha AIIMS Satellite Center completed.

Vikas Bhi Virasat Bhi



Tourism and Connectivity

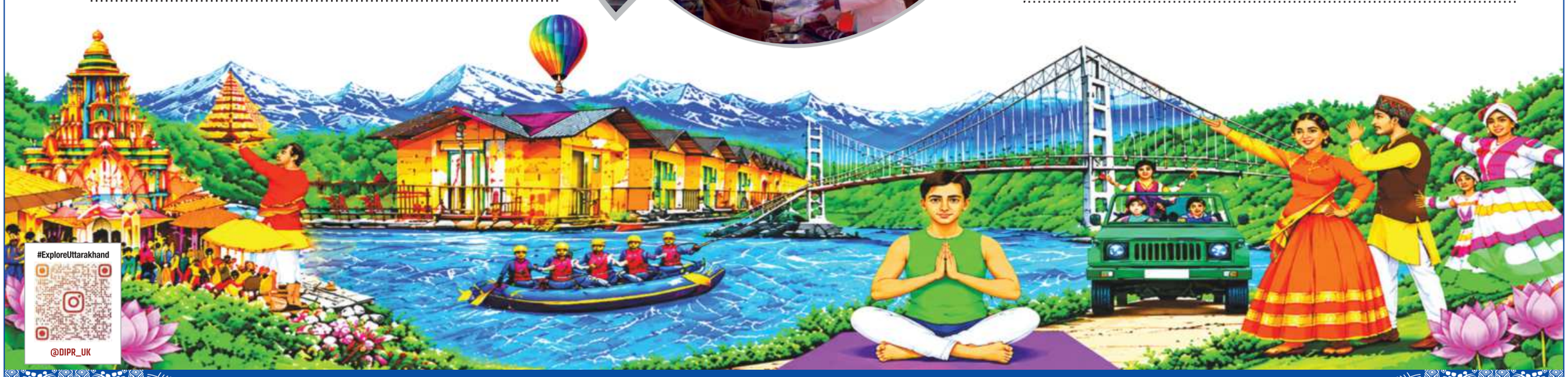
- Foundation stone laid for the Sonprayag-Kedarnath and Govindghat-Hemkund Sahib ropeway projects.
- Inauguration of the Delhi-Dehradun Economic Corridor at a cost of ₹11,963 crore.
- Arrival of over 6.33 million (63 lakh) pilgrims during the Char Dham Yatra.
- Promotion of rural tourism through 6,161 homestays.

Farmers, Women, and Rural Empowerment

- More than 3.10 lakh Lakhpati Didis.
- Subsidies provided to farmers under the Apple and Kiwi Missions.
- Trout Promotion Scheme worth ₹170 crore.
- 1,860 villages benefited through the Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY).

Sports and Youth Talent

- Uttarakhand won 103 medals at the 38th National Games.
- The state's first Sports University in Haldwani.
- Establishment of a Women's Sports College in Lohaghat.



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M ND-NDE

Classifieds

LIFE MADE SIMPLE

Matrimonial

BRINGING PEOPLE TOGETHER

THE HINDU

BRIDEGROOMS WANTED

INDEX OF MATRIMONIAL

BRIDEGROOMS WANTED
BRIDES WANTED
BRIDES & GROOMS WANTED
Classification Common for Brides, Bridegrooms, Brides & Grooms
ASSAMESE
AWADHI
BENGALI
BHOJPURI
BIHARI
CHHATTISGARHI
ENGLISH
GUJARATI
HARYANI
HINDI
KANNADA
KASHMIRI
KONKANI
MALAYALAM
MANIPURI
MARATHI
MARWARI
NEPALI
ORIYA
PARSI
PUNJABI
SAURASHTRA
SINDHI
TAMIL
TELUGU
TULU
URDU
ADVOCATE
BUSINESS
DEFENCE
DOCTOR
ENGINEER
FINANCE/ BANKING
GOVERNMENT/ QUASI-GOVERNMENT
IAS/ ALLIED SERVICES
INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY
MBA/ CA/ ICWA
NRI
COSMOPOLITAN
DIVORCEE
PHYSICALLY CHALLENGED
MARRIAGE BUREAUS
WEDDING ARRANGEMENTS

DIVORCEE

BEAUTIFUL, SINCERE 30, well–educated professional (MNC). Loving, cultured family. Seeks compatible groom. Caste no bar. Call/WA 9345 634 365

BENGALI

WANTED AN affluent and genial SouthIndia based Probashi Bengali groom (37–43)(prof/ doc/officer/ Business owners) for a Banerjee faculty, 38 working in an eminent institute in Coimbatore. 9495536431, 9600250109

DOCTOR

VANIYAR 31, MBBS/ MS, Midhunam, Thiruvadurai, Slim seeks MBBS/ MS Doctor Groom only. Contact: 9444259255

SC, PG, 26Y Doctor, Fair Girl, Expect Dr, Eng Ok – Chennai, Any Dist Ok. 86107 74168

NAIDU, GAVARA, 33 yrs/165 cms, MBBS.,MS(ongoing), pooram, simmam, good looking, slim, upper middle class, divorced without issues, seeks suitable groom, preferably Doctor. any Naidu sub caste. Ct: 63812 39087

SUPER Superspecialist M.D, DM doctor working in Bangalore 40 lakhs PA upper middle class Hindu 34 years /155 cm, fair, slim, seeks suitable groom with good habit preferable doctor, caste no bar. Contact 9845522122.

WANTED DOCTOR GROOM
ROMAN CATHOLIC, MD, DNB, (Anesthesiology), 27 Yrs, 5′ 7″, SLIM, FAIR, REPUTED SCHOOL, COLLEGE, WELL - SETTLED, CHENNAI.
CONTACT No: WhatsApp Profile
75500 65082

Wanted Hindu Doctor or Well Educated Groom in good position for well Looking Fair Doctor Bride, 34years, Working as Peadiatrics in Reputed Hospital Chennai, Star - Maham - Simham Cast No Bar. Ct: 80722 14843.

MALAYALAM

PARENTS OF 29Y Malayalee C.S.I. Syrian Christian girl (PhD) settled in Chennai, seek alliance from equally qualified C.S.I. Malayalee groom settled in Chennai. Ct: 9003281072.

PROPOSALS INVITED for a muslim divorcee girl, 29 , 5. 2", good looking govt employee hailing from ernakulam ; daughter of educated and employed upper middleclass parents from well placed and emotionally matured boys of similar background single or divorced without children, age below 35. Proposals from in and around Ernakulam preferred.. 9645227703.

FAIR, GOOD looking malayali Hindu Nair 29 yrs (Aayilyam 1997) working at Paris seeks Hindu malayali boy with Shengen visa working in EU/UK – Contact No. 9901929074

SEEKING ALLIANCE for a Hindu Malayali lady (68 yrs, Slim, M.A.) from an unmarried Hindu Malayali Allopathy Doctor. 9495621351

NRI

VANNAR GOOD looking bride Aged 31 working as software developer in Florida USA Under L1 visa needs suitable groom. Ph 9488243347, 9488243348

TAMIL

DIVORCED (NO KIDS) 43yrs M.Sc, M.Phil, Ph.D/ Job: Asst. Prof. RC/ SC (AD). Looking only for Catholic Groom with a Decent Profession. Job/Caste: No Bar Contact: 6382135986

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN 36, ENG working – MNC chennai wanted ENG groom – Christian family cont: 9444325317

PROTESTANT CHRISTIAN 32 PG fair beautiful well settled, Chennai seeks well settled Religious Protestant Christian bornafter 1991. 9840345969

CSI NADAR, MD Pursuing, looking for a groom from 31-38 from any location and subcaste from Medical professional, 8137001247

CSI, M.TECH, MNC, looking for a groom from same caste and well settled from 28-33 in Tamilnadu, 8137003550

CATHOLIC, UPPER Middle Class, MD, Doctor, looking for a groom from 27-31 from equal subcaste and occupation in Chennai circle, 8138900487

CHRISTIAN, FC, 37, M.Sc., M Phil., Asst. Prof. Pondy, Seeks Groom FC/BC, below 39 yrs. Ct: 98946-77892

TAMIL MUSLIM, Fair, 31/157, B.E., MBA, MNC Employee, Short Marriage – Khula Given, Issueless. Seeks Never- Married, Well-Settled Groom. WhatsApp: 6374495811.

CSI TAMIL, God Fearing, Fair, Homely, B.E., M.Tech., 28 Years, MNC, Parents seek alliance from suitable God Fearing, Well qualified and employed Grooms with clean habits Mobile/WhatsApp: 7200309111 / 9444002036

WANTED GROOM, Naidu Balija Girl 28 Fair Medico Pursuing MD Radio Diagnosis Seeking Groom PG Clinical Medico or Engineers With Masters Degree Class One Officers Contact: 9442272507

HINDU NADAR– Divorcee –36, BE, MBA Manager Accenture – UK London 8 L Pm Blw 40y CNB CT/ WA : 94421 26376

MUDALIAR 32YRS 5.4 M.A, working Anusham, Raagu Kedhu Dhosham, well settled family in Chennai seeks suitable Groom Ct: 99628 63220

VISWAKARMA/ GS/ 44/ 150/ ME(CSE) Rich Fair Employed seeks suitable Groom. Ct: 94863 20982

SC DKV 32 / 152 Asst. Director, Govt. Seeks Boy working in Govt. sector with same or higher cadre. 9442878255, 9489815304.

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar,27yrs,CA, Well Educated Business Family in Chennai Ph;7200187009

HINDU NADAR Groom wanted 28 yrs,BE, SWE,2 LP/M well Educated Family Ph: 9380791999,9841329471

GROOM WANTED Chettiyar 31 yrs,B. Tech,SWE,80 k p/m Elite Business Family.Ph; 9047192999

GROOM WANTED CNB,29yrs,Civil Service, well Educated Family.Ph: 6385293227

MUDALIAR SUPER Speciality Doctor 38 divorcee no issues seeks suitable groom. Caste no bar. Ct: 9710932333

MUDALIAR (CNB) : 27/ Fair, B.Tech, MS (USA), Abbott.Lab, USA, Elite Family, Seeks groom only USA – 9840050218/ 9962530015

SUITABLE, QUALIFIED Alliance invited for a fair and slim 33year Doctor (Dentist) MDS Vanniakula Kshatriya Girl working as Senior Lecturer in Chennai. Dhanusu rasi, star Moolam (4padam) Ct: 9382167197/9962781009

SEEKING EMPLOYED Bridegroom below 37y for Hindu SC fair, educated, divorced, homely & employed 34y Bride from Elite Family. CNBar 7303518877

ALLIANCE INVITES My Daughter Hindu Mudaliar 43yrs,+2 Diverse No Child caste No bar 9444274968/ 8144741234

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar, 29 yrs, BE, Rich and Affluent business family in Chennai 7200187009

GROOM WANTED Rich Mudaliyar,28yrs, Bcom, MBA, Elite Business family 7338877275

GROOM WANTED CNB,41yrs, MBA, Elite business family in Chennai 6385293227

TAMIL

ALLIANCE INVITED FOR ACCOMPLISHED IYER BRIDE

Iyer Koushika parents invite alliance for US educated daughter (29/170cm, Anusham, Never Married). Global upbringing; currently working in Europe and processing US permanent residency. She is creative, artistic, family oriented and spiritual. Father, MNC CEO and mother are from Kerala. Seeks empathetic, well-read Brahmin partner (MBA, Doctor, CA, Technologist) with strong values, keen on professional/ entrepreneurial career in the US, Europe or India.

Please contact : india.mkss1997@gmail.com

ADI DRAVIDAR, Krithigai 37 Doctor, working in Govt organization, Chennai seeks suitable groom. 9159558588

MUDALIYAR, 44, divorced, rich/affluent, looking for a groom from equal caste and status from 1st or 2nd marriage, 8138900412

VANNIYAR, DIVORCED, MD, Doctor, looking for a 2nd marriage profile from any caste with well educated and settled, 8137001255

YADAVA, MBBS, looking for Doctor profile from equal caste in Tamilnadu from 24-30, 8138900575

REDDIAR, RICH/AFFLUENT, MS, looking for a groom from same caste from 26-33 in Kongu districts, 8138900523

HINDU NADAR 1993 Born Fair, divorcee B.E (MIB) Employed seeks suitable alliance (CNB). CT: 9944960343

GROOM WANTED Mudaliyar,28yrs,M. Tech, Elite Business Family in Chennai.Ph: 7550025241

MUDALIAR 23 MBBS 163Cm Good Look well Settled Family Seeks Drs/Engrs/Business CNB 8778514465/ 7200866346

GROOM WANTED Hindu Nadar 29yrs, MBBS, MS, rich and affluent family. Ph: 9841329471,9380791999

GROOM WANTED SC (Ad),26yrs,BE, Well Educated Family in Chennai . Ph:9176718886

GROOM WANTED SC (Ad), MBBS, MD, well Educated Family.Ph: 6385293227

✔ ALLIANCE INVITEDA well–educated, well–settled Chennai family invites alliance for their 26–year–old, 169 cm, fair–complexioned, SC Tamil daughter, working as a Securities & Capital Markets Associate with a top–tier corporate law firm. BBA, LL.B. (Hons.), LL.M. Family–oriented, grounded in strong values. Father retired as Executive Director of a leading PSU. Seeking a highly qualified, professionally accomplished groom from a respectable family, employed in Government/PSU/Private sector, preferably based in Chennai, Mumbai or Bangalore.Contact: 9444415358

35 YEARS fair B Tech NIT MBA IIT working in MNC Chennai, CNB Seeking suitable Bridegroom. Ct:9940507235.

VANNIYA KULA Kshatriya, (27/164cm) , LLM, Working in a Pvt. Company as Deputy Manager, Good Looking Seeks Suitable Groom. Ct. 99406 55572.

HINDU NADAR 29, B.E, MBA Software Engineer, Salary 12L/PA, Kanni Rasi Hastam Natchathiram, Own House & Land in Chennai & Native. Seeks suitable Groom Ct 9444780965, 9444716255

KIND, ATTRACTIVE 41, well–read, health–care professional. Cultured family. Seeks compatible groom. Religion/caste no bar. Call/WA 9345634365

Naidu Girl 30/165 cm Aswini pursuing PhD Doctoral studies in Satellite Communications Quantum Neuromorphic Computing European Space Agency Europe- completing by Jan 2027 seeking suitable groom PhD / MS in USA / Europe. Ct: 9840103686

VANNIYAKULA SHATRIYAR Girl 28Years B.E Kettai, Asst Manager,Govt Bank. Seeks Suitable Groom Ct:9894128789

MUDALIAR 25/161, Fair, Beautiful, BE, MS, Infosys, 2000000 PA, Affluent Family CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

PILLAI BRIDE 26 Yrs/157cm, Fair, Pooja, BE (Hospital Management) Seeks a suitable groom from CANADA ONLY. CT: 9894107825, 9500595339.

HINDU SC AD 30/155 cm MTech Bio Well settled Seeking Groom from age 31to 34 India & Abroad Ct 9176667499

SM4 TAMIL Brahmin Iyer Girl, 37/ 5'6", CA, MBA, issueless div (short marr.), affluent family. Seeks well–edu/emp Boy, never marr/ issueless div, 37–42 yrs from cultured, affluent family. Cont: 9043949107 / asalliancemail@gmail.com

Bride Groom Wanted for DOCTOR
Bride, 34 yrs, 5′7″, divorcee, doctor (MBBS,MD,DM), from an elite business family, Hindu Nadar, based in Tirunelveli, seeks a suitable groom from an affluent family (Caste/Religion no bar)
Kindly contact 9994851637/ 9790445335

TELUGU

SEEKING ALLIANCE for a Ph.D, Cultured, Naidu Girl 36 years 165 cm from a respectable family. Looking for a qualified well settled groom not later than 1987 or 1988. Caste no bar. Contact: 9790908109

GROOM WANTED Naidu,28yrs, MBBS, MD, Divorce, well educated family 6385293227

NAIDU 29/162 Telugu/Chennai B.E. MNC Bank 15LPA seeks elite/educated professional groom Father– 9445908221

NAIDU 27/165, Fair, Beautiful, BE, MBA, Accenture,2200000 PA, Affluent Family, CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

URDU

Sunni Muslim Family invites Alliance for their Daughter, MBBS 28yrs, ht. 168cm, fair, slim, graceful and working, from unmarried Muslim Professional Graduates and PGs Boys. Please send photo and biodata on 9490117099

BRIDES WANTED

BUSINESS

Wanted Bride for R.C.Nadar affluent Business Boy, 29 Years, 180 cm, B.E. M.B.A. seeks Bride Ct: 9842142870

COSMOPOLITAN

DIVORCEE MALE 48 Tamil Engineering Graduate well settled in Bangalore seeks suitable girl 8310509368

NAIDU.27/09/99.BE.BMS.STUDIED–SETTLED IN Dubai.Bride relocate to Dubai. CNB. +918248966362/9444329693

G. GOWRISHANKAR 37 / 173cm B.Com DAE Working in London PR holder 83, 000 Pound/PA.Hindu Intercaste Parents Seeking Working Bride. 9677090227

DIVORCEE

SINCERE, UNDERSTANDING 43, 173cm, positive, well–educated, well–settled professional. Seeks compatible S Indian bride. Call/WA 9345 634 365.

DOCTOR

CHRISTIAN, CAST No Bar, 29yrs, PG Doctor, Expect MBBS Doctor, Chennai, Any District Ok. 73977 76595.

ENGINEER

Railway Engineer Bangalaore 34 Thiyya (Kerala) Seeks Bride. Contact: 8113832105

ENGLISH

Vanniyakula Kshatriya, Chitirai, B.E, M.S(USA) July 95, 176cm, Texas, USA work permit, well settled family at Chennai, Looking for Brides working at USA. Ct: 98846 04233 / 81220 72363.

HINDI

BRAHMIN,BE/MBA TOP Univ,FinTech, Veg,39/172cm,smart Canada citizen. Seeks edu,nev–married,elegant girl, similar community.I'm open to any City/Language.WatsApp bio& pic:9911237600

KANNADA

HINDU, NEVER Married. Age 45, height 5 ft 7 inch. IIT, Ph.D. University Professor in US, Green Card. Non–smoker, Non– drinker, vegetarian. Seeking Veg bride below 37 yrs. No caste bar. Contact: 8600315420

MALAYALAM

CHRISTIAN (RC), Age:28, Graduate, Business man, Seeks Graduate, Working Bride. Preferably Malayalee Christians. CT:9840839191

HANDSOME EZHAVA boy, Uthram, 25, 181 cm, B.Tech., Mechanical, 9495245179.

AYUSH MED Graduate(divorcee) seek partner from charming Professional Graduate/Gazetted Officer/+2 Teacher aged 52-58. Contact: 9496191756.

HINDU NAIR boy, 31 years, fair 181cm tall, software developer in an MNC seeking alliance from working professionals preferably engineers, doctors. Family – retired defence officer settled in Chennai. Contact: +917904635440

ALLIANCE INVITED for a Nair community boy, 36 yrs, Engineer, settled in USA for the last 15 yrs for his 2nd marriage. The girl should be from USA itself. For details contact 9995007328

Intercaste N'biar / Nambisan Boy 31 Yrs, 180 cm, Never Married, Tech-Lead-MNC, seeks match working / willing to work in B'lore, Caste-L'uage-no bar. Phone: 9886210028 / 9845203970

Malayalee Christian Boy, 30 Yrs, 181, M.Tech(IIT), MNC, 67 LPA, Hyderabad, Phone: 9447432585

NRI

Nair boy California SF based M S NRI 33 years Mumbai born seeks suitable alliance from U S based Hindu girl. Please reply to: 1960sank@gmail.com M 08356061628

TAMIL

CHRISTIAN NADAR, 41, US Educated, Professional, well settled in Chennai, earning 1.5 crores per year. seeks well qualified Christian bride 32-38 years old. Ct: 94432 56614

TAMIL

RC 1973 born divorce manager State govt PSU 1.25 lkpm MBA Chennai seeks suitable bride Ct: 9444015276

CSI TAMIL, God Fearing, Handsome, Clean habits, B.Tech., PGDM, 30 Years, MNC, Parents seek alliance from suitable God Fearing, Homely, Well qualified and employed Brides from good families Mobile/WhatsApp: 7200309111 / 9444002036

TAMIL VISWAKARMA 40/180 CM, BE MBA (Engg), chitrai, kanni, HCL Chennai, First marriage seeks bride CNB. CT: 99440 97021

INTERCASTE –FATHER Devendra Kula Vellalar, – Mother Brahmin Son Born Oct 1996, height 5.6 ft, good looking , working in an Autonomous organization, Min of Finance in Mumbai 35 lacs pa, looking for educated working girl in Govt/MNC/IT. Willing to shift to Mumbai .Contact 9444108810/9677064363

41 BE Mudaliar Chennai 1st Marriage Asst Manager Pvt Decent Background 9952010118,8610518808

HINDU VANNIYAR 47 MBA 177cm 2Lacks PM CNB First Marriage Elite Rich Family Seeks Bride. Ct: 94456 06903

VISWAKARMA/ GS/ 44/ 170/ ACA, ACMA/ MNC Charted Accountant/ 18LPA. seeks Bride. Ct: 94863 20982

MUDALIAR, 35/165, M.Tech. Professor working in Coimbatore, Native Chennai seeks bride from any caste and good family. Ct:9791507303

SEEKS SUITABLE bride in US for Smart, Well Educated, Mudaliar Boy, May '96, 180cm, M.S (C.S) Working CA Bay Area , I140 approved , Caste No Bar. Parents contact: 9566046660

BRIDE WANTED CNB, 30yrs,B. Tech,Well Educated family background in Chennai .Ph;9384772710

SC HINDU Mithunam 33/180 BE, MBA, Smart, IT Chennai seeks Homely, Educated, Mingle with Join&Well settled Family. Ct: 9789920881/ 8778546961

BRIDE WANTED CNB,34yrs, divorce, Own Industrial Background in Coimbatore Ph:6385293227

AUSTRALIAN TAMIL Hindu Saivite professional parents (father investment banker, mother doctor) seek alliance for son 27/165cm, fair complexion, slim built, business graduate employed as an Executive at leading global media organisation, from girls who are professionally qualified, with similar built and complexion, cultured with good family values and background who are happy to settle down in Australia. Email drmenakahkrishnan@gmail.com

HINDU AGE 30, BE, Senior data analyst- 21 LPA - Indico Airlines- Grugoan, Delhi. Native place - Neyveli,Tamil nadu Contact: 9487319473

HINDU ADI Dravidar / Gramani 180/ 30 Magam / Simmam Asst Engr / MNC in Chennai 4–5LPA seeks Graduate bride from decent family employed / Ready to go job. 9344486122, 9443286122

HINDU GAVARA Naidu, age 41 / Ht. 170 cm working in 5 star hotel, Manager (abroad) Salary 1 lakh / month. Seeks Suitable Bride. 9003194290.

DIVORCEE HINDU, 35yrs No issues, M.Tech, well settled Software Engineer, seeking bride with no issues. Caste no bar. 9841862535, 9941962421

TAMIL MUSLIM 30/172 MD Gastroenterology, Seeks prof qualified bride 8220042091 mdullahsafi@gmail.com

DOCTOR MD, Age–39, CSI, Bangalore. Own House. Well settled family. Caste No bar. Ct: 8754756329

CHRISTIAN NADAR, Doctor, MBBS, PGDCC-P(NI), Cardio - Physician, Divorcee, no kids. 38yrs/178cm, lives in Nagercoil. seeks qualified / divorced bride. Ct: 90039 83230

MUDHALIYAR, CA, 24L pa, Age–40, Kettai, Never married, Own House, 6 Acre land, Sub Caste ok. 7305460763

TAMIL/ TELUGU Naidu Groom 1981 Aug/ BDS Surgeon & London MBA seeks Bride from good family background. Ready to work or relocate Abroad. Contact V.J.Naidu 98867 82390/ 99622 46305

TAMIL

MUDALIYAR, KETTAI, 40/165, M. Tech.,Ph.D.,HOD,Pvt. Engg.College, Pondy. Seeks Bride 31 to 37yr. 8807281316

THEVAR-AGAMUDAIYAR,RICH/AFFLUENT, Business, looking for a bride in same caste from 24-28 in anywhere in Tamilnadu, 8138900312

PILLAI 45 Divorcee M.Com Central Govt service Rs.14 lakhs PA seeks Graduate bride caste no bar 9094020665

BRIDE WANTED: BE,SWE/34lpa/35yrs/172cm.Well–Settled in Bangalore and educated family. Seeking a suitable ,educated bride from a good family background. Contact No: 9845401461.

Tamil Hindu SC 29 yrs B.Tech IT professional in MNC seeks slim fair girl. CNB, Ph: 8825427551.

SMART, AMBITIOUS 38, 173cm, loyal, open–minded, intelligent professional. Seeks compatible S Indian bride. Caste no bar. Call/WA 93456 34365

HINDU 46 BE 9994351766 Carleton IISc https://ingeniousdesigntech.com https://tamilfilmmakerspro.com

HINDU YADAVA 31, 176 cm, MBBS, Seeking Alliance from an Upper-class family, preference for same caste MBBS/MD, BDS/MDS, family Ct: 9942005782/9444674978

HINDU, SC (AD), 42 yrs, 165 cm, Ph.D., Asst. Prof. (C), State University (Chennai), seeks a suitable bride (caste/religion: no bar) ; Ph: 8863837344.

INTERCASTE, 29 yrs/171 cm, M.Sc., IT professional, Chennai, veg, CNB, warmly welcoming an educated and understandable bride. Ph: 9962789557

MUDALIAR 28/186, Handsome,MBBS, MD, (DM) Kauvery Hospital, 3500000 PA, Elite , CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

WELL SETTLED Navigation Officer, 40 years, Divorce, 18L/ annum. Belongs to Vanniya Kula Sathriya Looking for Genuinely Interested Bride may Contact: 63690 04108

Iyer B.Charanam/ Koundinyam/ Avittam '88 B.Com/MBA working in Chennai seeks working bride. 6374043306.

Seeking BRIDE for Bridegroom
Hindu, Kulalar/Udayaar, 44 yrs, 170 cms, M.Tech, IT professional, Caste open for discussion. First Marriage Only
CT: 93842 76066

32 Years, Groom, Prof. PhD, Christ Nadar (Nobar), 2nd-Marriage, seeks Tamil Bride Contact: 7299565821.

TELUGU

MUTHURAJA NAIDU, Age 29, 5'10", BE, Punarpoosam, Good Job. Seeks Balija/Gavara, Bride From Chennai. Broker Excuses. Ct :8668067409.

Looking for a Naidu girl below 29 yrs working in USA or in CANADA with PR status for a Balija/Gavara boy, 29/176 cm working in USA with H1B VISA. Please contact +91-9443724981

NAIDU 31/180 Handsome, MBBS, MS, (MCh) Miot Hospital, 4000000 PA, Elite Family CNB. 9043991629, 9043987029

BRIDE WANTED
38 years, 173 cm, Divorced (previous marriage lasted only one week and was not consummated), holding a Double Master's Degree,Employed in Singapore. Seeking a suitable Bride aged 28-35 yrs from a Good Brahmin Family, preferably Employed and willing to relocate to Singapore.
Contact: 9949579697

URDU

URDU KHAN 40/180 Fair Handsome BE Sr. Manager Abu Dhabi well placed Divorced No child, seeks Muslim Girl PG around 35 Fair Good looking Upper Middle Class fly preferably Chennai. Ct: 9884155405/ 9962303700

MARRIAGE BUREAU

US EUROPE Canada All Caste Religion 1st Marriage,Remarriage. 8248757840

GENERAL

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE It is informed to the Public at Large that my Client (s), Mr. Chander Bhan Garg S/o Late Ghurey Lal & Mrs Vimla Devi Garg W/o Late Vishamber Nath Garg both R/o J–13/6, Rajouri Garden, Delhi , hereinafter called the Joint Owner of the Land and Building No. J–13/31 (Plot No.31 in J–13) i.e. Plot measuring 401 SqYrds (335.3 SqMtrs) along with its constructed structure (GF/ FF/ SF/ TF & Basement/ Stilt with Roof Rights) as per the Lay Out Plan site as well as Building Plan Sanctioned by the Authority : Delhi Municipal Corp./ Admin. That the Joint Owners of the Residential Building have (Jointly) sold the Part of Building as follows : (1) "Entire Gr. Floor House" measuring Covered/ Super area 252 SqMtrs without the Roof/Terrace rights to Mr. Satish Kumar Saluja (Purchaser) S/o Hardyal Saluja R/o B–2/ 135, Gurdwara Road, Paschim Vihar, Delhi–63 (vide Regd. Sale Deed No. 15443/ B–1 V–7743 / P–29–38 dt. 28.6.2022), AND (2) "Entire Basement Floor" measuring covered / super area 216.265 SqMtrs without Roof/Terrace rights to Joint Purchaser(s) Mr. Shivam Dhall S/o Kewal Krishan Dhall R/o D–35A, Rajouri Garden, Delhi and Mr. Jagan Kumar Arora S/o Ram Saran Das Arora R/o AD–31 – FF, Tagore Garden, Delhi (vide Regd. Sale Deed No. 8701/ B–1 V–8880/ P–90–99 dt. 11.4.2023). Above dwelling units (Floors) are sold through Builder/ Broker (Mr. Manoj Kumar S/o Om Prakash R/o 2/20, Janak Puri, Delhi and Mr. Kunal Nijhawan S/o Anil Nijhawan R/o A–33, Shankar Garden, Vikas Puri, Delhi. The dwelling units are provided with all Electricity/ Water Line Fittings and the above Purchaser(s)/ subsequent Owners are having right to get their Connections/ Services : Electricity/ Jal/ Telecom/ PNG Meter, as available/ permissible by concerned Authority w.r.t. above Residential units/ Premises, but no structural changes shall be allowed and No any Violation/ destruction/ encroachment /TressPass shall be permissible other than their purchased area and the common utility Areas as mentioned in respective Sale Deed(s). The above Purchaser are absolute Owner of the quoted premises with independent rights. In case of any Violations/ Unlawful activity disobey applicable Laws or subsequent Change by concerned Civic–Legal authority. If any one dealing/ involve in unlawful or violative activity shall be doing at their own risk. My Client(s) shall not be responsible. S. Sharma (Advocate) Mob. 8800247534 Ch. 416, Patiala House Court Complex, New Delhi–110001

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THE HINDU
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HC quashes defamation case against Shivakumar, Siddaramaiah

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Extending the benefit of an earlier order that quashed the BJP's defamation case against Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha, Rahul Gandhi, the High Court of Karnataka has now quashed the defamation proceedings against Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar, former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah, and the Karnataka Pradesh Congress Committee (KPCC) over the Congress's advertisements in various newspapers in May 2023 that alleged corruption in the then BJP government.

NDA continues its winning streak in A.P. local body polls

TDP-led bloc is far ahead in the race, winning in over 320 ZPTCs, including 77 that were declared unanimously elected, and leading in nearly 100 others; similar picture is unfolding in 7,767 MPTCs

V. Raghavendra
VIJAYAWADA

The Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and it's National Democratic Alliance (NDA) allies, the Jana Sena Party (JSP) and the BJP, continued their stellar performance in the elections to the Zilla and Mandal Parishad Territorial Constituencies (ZPTCs and MPTCs) after crushing the YSRCP in the Urban Local Body (ULB) elections in Andhra Pradesh.

Polling was conducted for 582 ZPTCs and 7,767 MPTCs in 28 districts on November 5, following the declaration of 77 ZPTCs and 2,051 MPTCs as unanimously elected.



On a roll: A TDP candidate celebrates her victory in the MPTC election in Vijayawada on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The TDP-led ruling coalition was far ahead in the race in both the ZPTCs and MPTCs, winning in over 320 ZPTCs, including the 77 that had been declared as unanimously elected, and leading in nearly 100 ZPTCs. A similar picture was unfolding in the 7,767 MPTCs at the time of filing this report.

The TDP gained an unassailable lead in both the polls in Kadapa, which had been a stronghold of the YSRCP. After scoring an impressive victory in the polls to the Pulivendula Municipality, the TDP won the Pulivendula ZPTC also.

The TDP was in the driver's seat in the ZPTC seat of Kuppam (Chief Minister and TDP leader N. Chandrababu Naidu's home turf) and in a vast majority of the other ZPTCs, and MPTCs in Chittoor and Annamayya.

Reacting to the results , TDP State president Palla Srinivasa Rao said the mood was overwhelmingly in favour of his party and its allies due to their good governance, and it was a profound mandate for welfare, development and social justice.

'Hijack threat': IndiGo plane returns to Bengaluru

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

A Lucknow-bound IndiGo flight made an emergency return to Kempegowda International Airport (KIA) in Bengaluru on Saturday after a handwritten note with a hijack threat was discovered inside the lavatory shortly after take-off.

Flight 6E-451 had departed from Terminal 1 when cabin crew found the note. The message read, "This flight is going to hijack at 6.30, ignore and see consequences (SIC)."

The crew immediately alerted the pilot-in-command, who informed Air Traffic Control and sought priority clearance to return to Bengaluru.

Merger buzz: NCP and NCP (SP) would take own decisions: CM

Press Trust of India
NAGPUR

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis on Saturday said the NCP and NCP (SP) were independent parties and would take their own decisions on reports of a possible merger, asserting that the BJP-led NDA would be consulted if any such move was being considered.

Speaking to reporters in Nagpur, Mr. Fadnavis was asked about NCP leader Sunil Tatkare's recent statement and reports of discussions between the two factions on coming together. The CM said the two were separate political parties and would take their own decisions. While Sharad Pawar leads the NCP (SP), Deputy CM Sunetra Pawar heads the NCP, an NDA ally and a partner in the ruling Mahayuti coalition in the State.

Mr. Fadnavis said it would not be appropriate for him to comment on behalf of the two parties, adding that the two sides would decide their own course of action. "What I am certain about is that if they decide to take such a step, or if discussions are under way, they will consult us as well. We are the major partner in the Mahayuti alliance and in the NDA. As of today, neither side has consulted us or informed us that such discussions are taking place. If they are, they will inform us, and once they do, we will respond," he said.

Timings
DELHI

SUNDAY, NOV. 08	
RISE	06:38 SET 17:32
RISE	05:37 SET 16:39
MONDAY, NOV. 09	
RISE	06:39 SET 17:31
RISE	06:35 SET 17:16
TUESDAY, NOV. 10	
RISE	06:39 SET 17:31
RISE	07:34 SET 17:57

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	31	16
Safdarjang	31	16
Palam	28	16

Delhi Palam Today
30°C Shallow fog and mist in cool morning. Day will be slight warm. Pollution level will be severe. Weather will be dry.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
29°C The weather will be dry. Day will be slight warm. Night will be cool. Pollution level to increase.

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DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E- mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 19-10-2026, one person namely Farooq Ahmed S/O Abdul Rashid R/O Ward No. 06 Jothana Tehsil and District Kathua A/P Ucha Pind Tehsil Ramkot lodged a written report at PP Ramkot stating therein that on 18-10-2026 his daughter namely Kaniza Bano, age 19 years went missing from complainant's dera at Ucha Pind Tehsil Ramkot. The complainant along with his family members tried his best to locate his daughter, but all in vain. On this, missing report vide DD No. 06 dated 19-10-2026 has been entered at Police Station Billawar.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still un-traced.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

Description Roll :-

• Name	Kanizo Bano
• Father	Farooq Ahmed
• Permanent Address	Jothana Tehsil Kathua
• Present Address	Ucha Pind
• Tehsil	Ramkot
• Police Station	Billawar
• Age	19 years
• Height	5 feet 03 inch
• Complexion	Fair
• Built	Normal
• Face	Oval
• Eyes	Brown
• Languages known	Hindi/Pahari/Gojri



Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010 (Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in (Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311(Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Billawar 01921-22022
5. SHO P/S Billawar- 9186316020
6. IC PP Ramkot-9186316032

Sr. Superintendent of Police, Kathua.

DIP/J- 13984/26

Government of Jammu and Kashmir
Agriculture Production Department
Civil Secretariat, Jammu/Srinagar

Subject: Inviting applications for the position of Vice-Chancellor, Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology, Kashmir.

The Hon'ble Lieutenant Governor of Jammu & Kashmir has constituted a Selection Committee for recommending a panel of suitable aspirants for the position of **Vice Chancellor, Sher-e-Kashmir University of Agricultural Sciences and Technology, Kashmir (J&K).** The position is to be filled up on tenure basis for a period not exceeding **03 years** or attainment of **65 years of age**, whichever is earlier. Aspirants for this position should not be more than **62 years** of age as on the closing date of application.

The committee invites applications from eminent agricultural scientists with outstanding credentials and also solicits appropriate nominations from renowned personalities of eligible candidates fulfilling the following criteria:

I. Essential Qualifications and Experience:

1. A distinguished scientist or academician with Doctor of Philosophy degree in Agriculture/Veterinary or related fields.
2. More than 10 years of experience in the grade of professor or equivalent position in any academic organization of repute.
3. Administrative experience of atleast 3 years in handling affairs of any university or a national institution as Dean/Joint Director/Director or equivalent.

Or

05 years experience at the level of Head of the Department/Division or equivalent position in any academic organization of repute.

4. Minimum of 20 research publications in peer-reviewed national/international journals including books.
5. Demonstrated experience in leadership.

II. Desirable Experience:

1. Good understanding of financial management including revenue generation, planning and fiscal control.
2. Demonstrable success in developing and executing National and International collaborative arrangements.
3. Experience of working in Statutory Authorities of a university such as Board of Studies/Academic Council/ Executive Council/Board of Management.
4. Experience of handling accreditation procedures, quality assessment and guiding students for Masters' and PhD.
5. Experience of international exposure through participation in meetings, workshops, seminars, or conferences held outside the country.

III. Mode of Application and General Conditions:

1. Applications received through e-mail only, from eligible candidates shall be entertained and considered for further processing. Such applications should reach by or before **27th November, 2026 to:**

Dr. Sahil Jandyal, JKAS
Additional Secretary to the Government,
Agriculture Production Department,
Civil Secretariat, J&K
E-mail : sahiljandyal.kas@jk.gov.in

2. The CV/Bio-data must contain general information (name, present position/ post last held, date of birth, address for correspondence, e-mail ID and contact/mobile number), educational qualifications, area of specialization, service details (including date of appointment as Professor/equivalent), administrative posts held, publications, number of persons guided for **Post-Graduation & Ph.D degree** along with relevant supporting certificates/documents.
3. Applications received after the last date shall not be entertained.
4. The selection committee reserves the right to call only shortlisted candidates for personal interaction, out of the applicants, based on the suitability of the applicants for the position.
5. The committee reserves the right to withdraw the position or cancel the advertisement without assigning any reason.
6. Canvassing or influencing the members of selection committee will lead to disqualification.
7. Incomplete applications will be summarily rejected.
8. The details are also available on the official website: **apd.jk.gov.in** for ready reference.

No: Agri-SKST/18/ 2021 (CC. 23973)
Dated: 06.11.2026

Sd/-
Shailendra Kumar, IAS
Financial Commissioner (Additional Chief Secretary)
Agriculture Production Department, J&K UT
(Convener, Selection Committee)

DIPK- 7455/26

CEO admits ID duplication due to 'processing error'

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

After *The Hindu* reported that at least 803 voter IDs were linked to 397 people in Mahadevapura Assembly constituency even after the special intensive revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, which was intended to weed out duplicate entries, the office of the Chief Electoral Officer (CEO), Karnataka, said that the discrepancies flagged in the report were due to "procedural circumstances during data processing".

The report highlighted instances of people holding multiple voter IDs in Mahadevapura, as well as cases where the same Elector Photo Identity Card (EPIC) number appeared in the final rolls of two different constituencies.

Multiple forms

In response, the CEO's office said that during the SIR, some applicants had submitted multiple Form 6 applications (seeking inclusion) through the Citizen Service Portal. As these applications were "processed independently", multiple EPIC numbers were inadvertently generated for the same individual.

However, the SIR was intended to identify and eliminate precisely such discrepancies through a comprehensive revision of the electoral rolls to get a "clean roll".

The phased revision process was meant to flag repeat applications, but the system processed them "independently", allowing multiple voter IDs to slip into the final rolls.

Clarifying how identical EPIC numbers appeared in the final rolls of two constituencies, the CEO's office said that in some cases, Form 8 applications seeking migration to another constituency had been approved and the electors' names incorporated into the rolls of their new constituencies. However, the corresponding Form 7 applications seeking deletion of their names from the previous constituencies remained pending.

CHIEF ELECTORAL OFFICER, HARYANA

ONE MORE CHANCE
HARYANA SIR 2026

Your name missing from the Draft Electoral Roll?

If you were marked Absent, Shifted, Dead or Duplicate (ASDD), you can still get your name included in the Final Electoral Roll.

1 Check the list

ASDD lists shall be displayed afresh at Polling Stations, Panchayat Bhawans, ULB & BDO offices and on the CEO Haryana website.

2 Get your form

Your BLO will deliver your enumeration form either physically or by WhatsApp / SMS / e-mail. Or you can download and fill it on the website or the ECINET App by entering the same EPIC number that existed before your name was deleted.

3 Submit to your ERO / AERO / BLO

AT SAME ADDRESS
Enumeration Form + Annexure-B
Mention reason why you couldn't submit enumeration form earlier. Submit yourself, through family, or online on ECINET with e-sign.

SHIFTED WITHIN HARYANA
Enumeration Form + Annexure-C
Submit to the ERO / AERO of the Assembly Constituency where you have shifted. No Form-8 needed.

ALREADY SUBMITTED FORM-6
No need to apply again
Your Form-6 submitted during SIR will be processed.

✓ **Same EPIC number** that was assigned to you prior to SIR shall be re-assigned once your enumeration form is accepted.

Homeless? The BLO's field verification will be accepted as residence proof.

NEED HELP?
Voter Helpline 1950 • "Book a call with BLO" on ECINET App
Website ceoharyana.gov.in Facebook /ceoharyana Instagram @ceo.haryana
X @ceoharyana YouTube @ceo.haryana

2270/13/24/2027/50875/199/7

UP Rajya Vidyut Utpadan Nigam Ltd.
PARICHHA THERMAL POWER PROJECT - PARICHHA, JHANSI

1. **GEM/2026/B/8225740 Dated 31.10.2026** "Supply, Installation and operation of in-house Brick manufacturing unit at PTPP, Parichha." Estimated Cost Rs. 33,42,900/-, EMD Rs 65,000/-, Bid Submission end dt. 21.11.2026 up to 06:00 PM.
2. **GEM/2026/B/8231961 Dated 03.11.2026** "Deployment of 01 no. C Type Ambulance for 02 years at PTPP, Parichha." Estimated Cost Rs. 17,76,800/-, EMD Rs 35,000/-, Bid Submission end dt. 13.11.2026 up to 02:00 PM.
3. **GEM/2026/B/8248870 Dated 06.11.2026** "Dusting of UCB, Service building and sanitation of loo in the service building of 2x250MW." Estimated Cost Rs. 21,33,399/-, EMD Rs 36,000/-, Bid Submission end dt. 21.11.2026 up to 02:00 PM.

NOTE:- For Information regarding Addendum/Corrigendum/ Rejection of Bids kindly regularly visit website **https://gem.gov.in** & **uprvunl.org.**

संo 210/टी0एस0डी0–प्र0/पीटीपीपी/ दिनांक 07.11.2026

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ADMISSION NOTIFICATION

SL NO.	Name fo Course	Duration of course	Eligibility / Essential Qualification	No. of Seats	Preferred Medium of Instruction
1	One Year Post Graduate Certificate Course in Screen Acting	48 Weeks	Graduate Degree or Equivalent from any recognised University	20	English, Hindi
2	One Year Post Graduate Certificate Course in Film & Video Editing	48 Weeks	Graduate Degree or Equivalent from any recognised University	10	English, Hindi
3	One Year Post Graduate Certificate Course in Song Creation, Music Production & Sound Recording for Film	48 Weeks	Graduate Degree or Equivalent from any recognised University	10	English, Hindi

An initiative of Information and Cultural Affairs Department aimed at guiding youth towards the art of filmmaking

The application form can be downloaded from the Institute's official website: **tfti.ac.in** from 07/11/2026. The last date for submission of application (physically or via email): 26/11/2026 upto 5.00 PM. Application by registered post will be accepted till 5.00 PM of 30/11/2026. All other details like terms & conditions, selection procedure etc. can be seen in the official website: **tfti.ac.in**

ICA/D/1312/26

THE HINDU
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Tel: 080-22225645, Website: www.keonics.in

No.: KSEDC/P323/2026-27 Date: 07.11.2026

E-Tender Notification

As per Karnataka Transparency in Public Procurement Act 1999 and 2000, Karnataka State Electronics Development Corporation Limited (KEONICS), Bengaluru invites tender of 15 days through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal **"Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Consulting Agencies for providing IT Non Consulting Services for a period of Two (2) Years"**. The information regarding the tender is made available at **https://kppp.karnataka. gov.in**. For any tender related queries or more information, Bidders may contact KEONICS during office hours. **(Telephone Number 080-2222 5645).**

Sl. No.	Tender Notification No.	Details of Tender	Last date to submit the tender
1	KEONICS/ 2026-27/ SE0148	Request for Proposal (RFP) for Empanelment of Consulting Agencies for providing IT Non-Consulting Services for a period of Two (2) Years	30.11.2026

DIPR/CP/RO3610/AAPL/2026-27

SD/-
Director (Finance)

From Page One

ED can't file private complaint, says HC

The petitioners argued that once the predicate offence collapses, even on technical grounds, the ED cannot continue PMLA proceedings. If the ED uncovers a different scheduled offence, its only permissible course is to share information with the competent agency, not to file a separate private complaint and probe it, they said.

Accepting petitioners' contentions, the court held that Section 66(2) of the PMLA casts a duty on the ED to intimate the concerned agency, not to take up the investigation itself.

"In law, where an act is to be done in a particular way, it must be done in that way and in no other way," the court said, invoking the constitutional separation of powers and the need for checks and balances.

The court pointed out that the PMLA does not expressly empower the ED or its officials to file a private complaint in respect of a scheduled offence and, on that strength, investigate the accused under the PMLA.

Allowing the ED to prefer a private complaint by itself, when the other government authorities deem it inappropriate to initiate proceedings, "would amount to permitting the ED to act as a super cop and it goes against the philosophy of the Act which requires a predicate offence to be in existence for the ED to initiate proceedings as contemplated under the PMLA," the court said.

How much ethanol is actually in petrol: Rahul

The Congress leader said the Karnataka government collected petrol samples from seven districts and had them tested at an accredited lab. "Look at the results – 11 out of 14 samples contained more than 20% ethanol... – whether government-owned or private – all exceeded the limit and the companies' own labs didn't even report the ethanol content," Mr. Gandhi said.

"In other words, you're paying for expensive petrol, but ethanol is being pumped into your tank. Who loses out? You," he claimed, saying that cars were not built to handle that much ethanol and that this would lead to lower mileage, repeated trips to the mechanic. "A car you bought with such enthusiasm is being ruined," he said. He added that there were no signs at filling stations telling customers what is being put in their tanks – "no choice at all".

Centre counters allegation

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas, in a press note, said the three public sector Oil Marketing Companies (OMCs) – IOCL, BPCL, and HPCL – have clarified that the claims, as reported, are not supported by testing conducted in accordance with the prescribed statutory and technical procedures. "E20 petrol supplied by the three OMCs across the country, including Karnataka, conforms to IS 17021, the Bureau of Indian Standards specification for ethanol-blended motor gasoline," the release said.

"They have also raised concerns regarding the sampling procedure and testing methodology adopted for the October 2026 exercise," it added.

The Ministry also questioned the sampling method used by the Karnataka government. "The Motor Spirit and High Speed Diesel (Regulation of Supply, Distribution and Prevention of Malpractices) Order, 2005, issued under the Essential Commodities Act, 1955, read with the Marketing Discipline Guidelines (MDG) 2024, prescribes a defined procedure for sampling, retention, testing and communication of results," it said.

"The prescribed procedure requires six one-litre samples to be drawn, with two samples handed over to the dealer against acknowledgement, two retained by the oil company or department, and two sent to a laboratory specified under Schedule III of the Control Order or notified in the Official Gazette," the Ministry said.

Jharkhand BJP leader calls for CBI probe into death of tribal activist

Leader of Opposition in State Assembly Babulal Marandi asks Chief Minister Hemant Soren who is responsible for protecting tribal land and people; activist Nisha Bhagat had accused the govt., police and 'land mafia' of harassing her

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

The Leader of the Opposition in Jharkhand Assembly Babulal Marandi on Saturday demanded a Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) probe into the case of the alleged suicide of tribal leader and social activist Nisha Kumari Bhagat.

The senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader visited Bhagat's home in Gumla district to pay tribute to the late tribal leader. He also met with her family members.

During his visit, Mr. Marandi slammed the Hemant Soren-led State government over her death. Mr. Marandi held Mr. Soren directly responsible for Bhagat's suicide, and said she was a daughter of the tribal community.


A visitor pays his respects before the body of tribal activist Nisha Kumari Bhagat at her residence in Jharkhand on Saturday. PTI

'Dire situation'

Mr. Marandi added that a dire situation had emerged in Jharkhand, where law and order had collapsed and the State was effectively being run by a parallel system controlled by goons, middlemen and the land mafia.

There were many goons, middlemen and members of mafia who operated under the direct patronage of the Chief Minister in every region, block and police station across the State, he alleged.

"The entire administrative machinery, including SPs (Superintendents of Police), DCs (Deputy Commissioners) and Circle Officers, acts at the behest of these people and for their financial gain. Common citizens, seeking redress for their grievances, are left running from pillar to post between government offices and police stations, yet their concerns go unheard," Mr. Marandi said.

A single phone call from the mafia was enough to mobilise the entire administrative setup, he further claimed. "The current situation reveals who really controls the governance and administration in Jharkhand," he said.

"The terror of the land mafia in the State has escalated to such an extent that ancestral and private land belonging to ordinary citizens and tribal communities is being openly captured. The illicit trade of buying and selling such land is flourishing," Mr. Marandi said.

"The Chief Minister must answer – who is ultimately responsible for the protection of tribal land and the safety of the tribal people? If Hemant Soren is unable to govern the State, he has no moral right to remain in the Chief Minister's chair. He should resign immediately," he said.

"An impartial investigation must be conducted to uncover the truth. Ajay Tirkey [a converted Christian leader known for his missionary work and proximity to the Chief Minister], the Sub-Inspector at the Pithoria police station, who was named by Nisha Bhagat before her suicide, must be arrested immediately. A CBI inquiry should be conducted into the case," Mr. Marandi said.

Sameer Oraon, former national president of the BJP's Scheduled Tribes Morcha, praised the deceased activist. Nisha Bhagat was a fearless and resilient tribal woman who consistently raised her voice to protect the religion, culture, traditions, and faith of tribal communities, as well as their rights over water, forests, and land, Mr. Oraon said.

"In her video, Nisha Bhagat mentioned several names, including those associated with the Chief Minister, Ajay Tirkey, and the Jharkhand Police. An impartial investigation into the entire matter is essential," Mr. Oraon said.

When a tribal woman was seeking police protection, why had the police failed to take her complaints seriously, he asked.

Tribal rights activist Nisha Bhagat on Friday allegedly took her own life in Ranchi, shortly after a livestream broadcast of about 10 minutes on Facebook, in which she accused Mr. Soren's government, the police, and certain individuals associated with the land mafia of harassing her.

(For those in distress, counselling is available at Tele MANAS 14416.)

Bihar mound named site of national importance

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

An ancient mound in Bihar's East Champaran district has been declared an archaeological site of national importance through a central government notification.

The site – Ranivas Mound, at Kesariya – is spread over 1.63 acres and is under the ownership of the Bihar government, reads the gazette notification dated November 4 that was issued by the Ministry of Culture.

"In exercise of the powers conferred by... the Ancient Monuments and Archaeological Sites and Remains Act, 1958 (24 of 1958), the Central Government hereby declares the said archaeological site and remains specified in the site plan and schedule annexed hereto, to be of national importance," the gazette notification said.

A total of 3,686 sites around the country are under the care of the ASI, the Centre had informed Parliament in February 2026.

Currently, 70 sites in Bihar are under the ambit of the ASI.

IAF's heavy-lift aircraft makes record touchdown at Ladakh's Nyoma airbase

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

In a historic feat, a Russian-origin heavy-lift transport aircraft of the Indian Air Force (IAF) successfully landed at the Nyoma airbase in eastern Ladakh at an altitude of over 13,600 feet, achieving what the force described as the highest touchdown for the plane anywhere in the world.

The airbase is located at a distance of around 25 km from the Line of Actual Control (LAC) with China.

The IAF described the landing as an enduring capability of the aircraft backed by the "exceptional skill, precision and professionalism" of its crew.

"An Indian Air Force IL-76MD has scripted history with a successful landing at Nyoma, marking the highest-altitude landing ever achieved by the aircraft anywhere in the world," the IAF said on social media.


Rarefied air: The IAF described the landing as an enduring capability of the aircraft backed by its crew's 'exceptional skill'. PTI

The IAF said the touchdown was a "milestone" that reinforces India's strategic airlift capability.

The strategically significant air base, located at a height of 13,629 feet, was operationalised in November last year. The airbase is capable of handling fighter jets, helicopters and transport planes.

It was the fourth such air force base in Ladakh. The three others are located in Leh, Kargil and Thoise. The Kargil airstrip is located at an altitude of around 10,500 feet.

The Defence Ministry has been focusing on enhancing infrastructure at almost all airfields along the LAC including the Advanced Landing Grounds (ALGs) as per operational requirements.

It is also boosting infrastructure at Daulat Beg Oldi Advanced Landing Ground (ALG) in the Ladakh region.

The Daulat Beg Oldi ALG is located close to the LAC at an altitude of 16,700 feet, and is known as the highest airfield in the world.

Tough stance on Kishau dam project led to victory in BBMB dues case: Sukhu

Press Trust of India
SHIMLA

Hailing the Supreme Court verdict in the Bhakra Beas Management Board (BBMB) arrears case, Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu on Saturday said that the decision came in the State's favour on account of the "tough" stance his government took during discussions on the Kishau Dam project.

Mr. Sukhu said that during meetings with the Union Power Minister and officials, he had consistently raised the issue of dues arising from BBMB projects and made it clear that the rights of Himachal Pradesh in the matter must be resolved before any further progress was made on the Kishau Dam project.

Affidavit in SC

He said the State asserted that it would not share the cost of the 440-MW Kishau Dam project, and the Haryana government assured that it would file an affidavit in the Supreme Court in favour of Himachal Pradesh for the release of arrears of its power share from BBMB projects.


Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu

Ruling in favour of Himachal Pradesh, the Supreme Court on Friday said the hill State would get 11,973 MU of electricity from Punjab and Haryana over 20 years. The arrangement will be as per a 2011 Supreme Court verdict settling power dues arising out of Bhakra Nangal and Beas hydro projects since 1966 at the rate of 7.19%.

Talking to media persons here, Mr. Sukhu claimed that the case of arrears, pending for the past 15 years, would have taken many more years to decide if the government had not pursued it vigorously in the top court.

'Exploring better price'

He said that the State government is exploring a better price to sell the electricity received from the BBMB. If the electricity is sold at the rate of ₹6 per unit, the State could earn around ₹500 crore, but the government is working towards securing a better power agreement that could increase the revenue to approximately ₹1,000 crore.

The Chief Minister said that the State government was moving ahead with the aim of making Himachal Pradesh self-reliant and expressed confidence that it would become the most prosperous State in the country by 2032.

Siang dam protest: Arunachal Pradesh govt. frees 4 activists

Abhinay Lakshman
ITANAGAR

Four activists arrested on October 9 for protesting against the National Hydroelectric Power Corporation's 11,200MW Siang Upper Multipurpose Project (SUMP) were on Saturday released from Jully jail in Itanagar by the Arunachal Pradesh government, in what the Chief Minister's Office called a "goodwill gesture".

This came two days after the Siang Indigenous Farmers' Forum (SIFF), which has been leading protests against the SUMP and the Pre-Feasibility Report (PFR) study for the project, declined an invitation from Chief Minister Pema Khandu to meet for talks over the agitation that has been ongoing in the Siang region for more than a year now.

The SIFF had responded to Mr. Khandu's invitation for talks in Itanagar by saying that their demands for the release of all anti-dam arrestees and detainees, as well as the withdrawal of armed security forces from the villages of Upper Siang district, must be met first.

Those released on Saturday include the SIFF's Geku village Youth Wing President Adum Tayom, as well as Omak Paron, Okut Paloh, and Oson Paron, who were organising villagers opposed to the dam project.

'27 villages at risk'

The protesters have argued that the dam, as proposed, risks submerging as many as 27 villages where the State's Adi community have lived for centuries.

In a letter to the SIFF on Friday, which was signed by the Chief Minister's Principal Private Secretary, the State government said that it had agreed to release the four activists "as a confidence-building measure to create a positive atmosphere for dialogue and reconciliation".


Members of the tribal community in Yingkom village in Upper Siang district of Arunachal Pradesh. RITU RAJ KONWAR

The CMO also conveyed that the State government "commits to resolve sincerely and in a transparent manner all issues of concern to the Adi community through a mutually agreeable roadmap", further asking the SIFF leadership to communicate a preferred date for the next meeting and a list of delegates who would attend the dialogue.

On Saturday evening, SIFF General Secretary Likeng Libang told *The Hindu*, "We will now sit with our associate organisations like the SUMP Affected Areas Youth Association (SAAYA) and take a decision in the next one to two days about how to respond to this letter and gesture from the State government."

A day before the letter was sent to the SIFF, the Youth Wing General Secretary of Geku village, Dubit Siram, told *The Hindu* that their demands had always been for the release of all those detained and arrested over the anti-dam protests.

"This includes the four people of Geku village, but also six more people who were arrested from Riga village, and all the youth and activists detained in the aftermath of the October 23 incident in Pasighat."

The arrest of the four Geku-based activists on October 9 had only intensified the anti-dam protests, culminating in a solidarity march on October 23 in Pasighat.

However, when the protesters in Pasighat were met with *lathi* charge and tear-gas, they turned violent and set fire to the NHPC's premises, sparking another round of detentions and arrests, including that of SIFF's legal advisor Ebo Mili.

The CMO's letter said the SIFF's demands for the removal of armed security forces from Upper Siang villages and the withdrawal of FIRs against protesters could be "discussed" whenever it agrees to meet the State government.

The CMO further stated that the State government has also agreed to reinstate Gaonburhas and Gaonburhis (village elders) who were removed for protesting activities related to the SUMP.

U.P. police appear to have little regard for citizens' rights: HC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Allahabad High Court has strongly criticised the Uttar Pradesh Police over what it described as a routine infringement of citizens' fundamental rights. It also ordered release of the petitioner, observing that the police appear to have little regard for constitutional freedoms.

"The situation that exists in the State of Uttar Pradesh relating to the civil liberty is shameful, to say the least. The police appear to have little regard for the fundamental rights and civil liberties of citizens, and the infringement of these rights seems to have become a matter of routine for the U.P. Police," a Division Bench of Justices Atul Sreedharan and Achal Sachdev said in its order of November 3. The case concerned a man whose family alleged that he was forcibly picked up by police personnel in plain clothes from outside Nangal police station in Bijnor district on September 5. His formal arrest was shown only on September 7.

The State had informed the court that CCTV footage was unavailable due to a malfunction but the Bench observed that such an excuse would not be acceptable in cases of alleged unlawful detention. The State was also directed to pay ₹20,000 as litigation costs within seven days.

As Advani enters 100th year, PM Modi praises his political acumen

Veteran leader nurtured generations of activists and gave BJP a 'clear foundation rooted in the principle of Nation First', Modi says; Advani set a remarkable example working with Vajpayee, and changed the course of Indian politics, PM adds

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

As former Deputy Prime Minister and senior Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) leader Lal Krishna Advani celebrated his 99th birthday and entered the 100th year of his life on Sunday, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said ideological clarity and intellectual sharpness set Mr. Advani apart as a leader. There were very few people whose lives had touched so many different chapters of modern India, Mr. Modi said in an article.



L.K. Advani greeting Narendra Modi in Ahmedabad, in 2007, after the latter was sworn-in as Gujarat CM for the third time. FILE PHOTO

Born on November 8, 1927, Mr. Advani, as a young man in 1947, experienced the pain of leaving behind his familiar world in Sindh, Mr. Modi said. "He rebuilt his life from scratch without bitterness. This trait of being able to build from scratch, against all odds, has stayed with him throughout. It was seen while he was strengthening the Jana Sangh and later building the BJP," Mr. Modi wrote in the article, titled 'Bharat Ratna LK Advani Ji at 100!'.

Mr. Advani's tenure as BJP president saw the Congress falling sharply from 400 seats in Parliament to below 200 seats in 1989, and BJP become the single largest party in Parliament for the first time in 1996.

When Mr. Advani was BJP president, Congress fell sharply from 400 seats in Parliament to below 200 seats in 1989

Mr. Advani nurtured generations of activists and gave the BJP a "clear foundation rooted in the principle of Nation First", the Prime Minister said.

"Two qualities always set Advani Ji apart as a leader. First, his ideological clarity and intellectual sharpness. This was reflected in his speeches and writings. The Jana Sangh and BJP resolutions he authored remain worth reading even today, while his interviews were consistently incisive and precise. Second, the manner in which he exposed the pseudo-secularism propounded by a large section of the Indian polity for many years," Mr. Modi said in the article.

Stating that Mr. Advani had taken up every responsibility with immense diligence, Mr. Modi said that, after working as a Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) *pracharak* in Rajasthan, Mr. Advani went to Delhi, where he worked closely with the late former Prime Minister Atal Bihari Vajpayee. "History shows that it is rare for two towering political leaders to work together for several decades, cooperating with each other without becoming competitors. Advani Ji and Atal Ji set a remarkable example. Together, they changed the course of Indian politics," Mr. Modi said.

In the 1991 Lok Sabha elections, when Mr. Advani contested from Gandhinagar, Mr. Modi said he had been involved in the campaign. "The people of Gandhinagar sent him to Parliament time and again. As a voter of Gandhinagar, I also had the honour of voting for Advani Ji on numerous occasions. The care and attention he devoted to his constituency is something to learn from," Mr. Modi said.

Watershed moment

The Emergency was a watershed moment in Mr. Advani's life, the PM said, adding that the veteran leader had been at the forefront of saving democracy and protecting the Constitution. On Mr. Advani's contributions as an administrator, Mr. Modi said that as Deputy Prime Minister and one of India's longest-serving Home Ministers, Mr. Advani had been instrumental in strengthening India's security apparatus. "His work in improving the lives of our security forces is remembered with great fondness. His unequivocal stand against terrorism ensured India got a tough anti-terror law," the Prime Minister said.

Terming the Somnath-Ayodhya Rath Yatra as an iconic moment in Mr. Advani's life, Mr. Modi said it changed the course of Indian society for the better. "I consider it a privilege that I got the opportunity to be involved in this Yatra from the ideation stage to execution. Being present at Somnath when the Yatra began was particularly special. A Yatra can be very demanding, requiring long hours, constant travel, physical endurance and an ability to remain focused despite fatigue. Advani Ji embodied this endurance," the PM added.

Maintaining that Mr. Advani had always shown what probity in public life was about, Mr. Modi said the former was also a voracious reader, a big fan of cinema and theatre, and an enthusiastic film critic.

Abhishek Banerjee alleges attack by 'BJP hooligans' on his Kolkata residence

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Mamata All India Trinamool Congress leader and Diamond Harbour MP Abhishek Banerjee's residence located in the Kalighat area of Kolkata was attacked in the early hours of Saturday.

Mr. Banerjee shared the video of the attack on his social media handle claiming that this was the seventh attempt on his life in the last six months.

"After two days of continuous recce, this is how BJP hooligans attacked my house at 2 a.m. today. Watch the footage and see for yourself... This is the seventh attempt on my life in the last six months. Yet, there has been no police action and no judicial intervention," the Trinamool leader posted on social media.

In the video shared by Mr. Banerjee, a mob is seen attacking the house with sticks and tearing banners on shops next to the house. A few police personnel in uniform are seen pushing away the mob.

Clashes break out

On the occasion of the MP's birthday, his supporters had been gathering in front of his house since the early hours. A group of BJP supporters appeared on the scene and started shouting slogans, "thief, thief". Photographs of the Trinamool leader, cutouts and banners hung with birthday wishes were torn. When Trinamool supporters tried to stop this, an argument started between the two camps, and clashes broke out.



Diamond Harbour MP Abhishek Banerjee protesting in Kolkata on Saturday. Ex-West Bengal CM Mamata Banerjee is also seen. ANI

Mr. Banerjee came out of his house and met his supporters, some of whom had sustained injuries. He also sat in protest with his supporters. "There is a conspiracy to attack me and kill me," he alleged.

Kolkata Police has been enforcing prohibitory orders under Section 163 of Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) outside Mr. Banerjee's residence in Kalighat area on account of the perceived threat to his safety.

"Hooligans are running riot across the State because the judiciary continues to turn a blind eye. Thank you, Milords, for remaining mute spectators!" he said.

Former Chief Minister Mamata Banerjee criticised the attack on her nephew. "Who gave them the right to attack someone's house at 3 a.m.? Who authorised such an attack? We have come here to lodge our complaints against the harassment, intimidation, and deliberate obstruction occurring in our locality," she told reporters outside her residence in Kalighat.

West Bengal Minister and BJP leader Dilip Ghosh dismissed the allegations as "drama" and asked, "Who has the time to kill Abhishek Banerjee?"

Presidency expels student for 'defacing' Vivekananda poster

Shrabana Chatterjee
KOLKATA

The Presidency University has expelled a student and barred a former student from the campus for allegedly defacing posters of Swami Vivekananda inside the premises, official sources said.

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) had alleged that Left student factions vandalised the poster and filed a police complaint on October 14.

Following an investigation by an inquiry committee, which reviewed CCTV footage and heard various stakeholders, the university decided to bar both individuals from taking admission to any future course. One is a current student, while the other completed her post-graduate course a few months ago.

"Two students have been expelled from the studentship/post-studentship academic activities. It has also been decided that they won't be allowed admission to any future degree program in this university," the sources said.

University registrar Debajyoti Konar said the institution has always stood for dignified academic discourse but is "not in a position to tolerate any abuse to any thinkers, ideas or organisations."

University registrar Debajyoti Konar said the institution has always stood for dignified academic discourse

Campus divided

The Students' Federation of India (SFI) condemned the expulsion on Saturday. "By imposing an expulsion that threatens to destroy the academic lives of these two students, the administration has established a deeply dangerous precedent," the SFI Presidency unit said in a statement.

Meanwhile, Ananta Barui, state media in-charge, ABVP, told *The Hindu* on Saturday, "Our message is clear: ABVP possesses the only vaccine capable of eliminating the Chinese virus of anti-national ideology." The Left student wings had previously denied the ABVP's allegations.

Commenting on the development, Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari said, "ABVP has started the work of cleaning the Tukde-Tukde gang from Jadavpur and Presidency. This work must be continued."

Dhirendra Shastri row puts political spotlight on Lord Krishna in U.P.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Anuj Kumar
NEW DELHI

This Deepavali, political rivals in Uttar Pradesh are sparring over Lord Krishna.

The coordinated defence of influential religious storyteller Dhirendra Shastri by prominent seers, Bharatiya Janata Party spokespersons, right-wing groups, and the silence of the Uttar Pradesh government, has led political analysts to view the controversy surrounding his recent flippant remarks on Lord Krishna not as an isolated gaffe but a catalyst to stir the Shri Krishna Janmabhoomi movement before the U.P.elections, with him riding a stalking horse to coalesce BJP workers and push the Yadav leadership of the Samajwadi Party (SP) on its commitment to their presiding deity.

A poster has already appeared at BJP State Headquarters in Lucknow proclaiming, "*Jo Ram Ko Layen Hain Woh 27 Main Krishna Ko Layenge* [Those who brought Ram, will now bring Krishna in 2027]," showing PM Narendra Modi dressed as Ram and U.P. Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath as Krishna.



Bageshwar Dham head Dhirendra Krishna Shastri. File. PTI

In a reference to Lord Krishna's *tribhanga* (three-bend) dancing posture, Mr. Shastri, 30, at a Ram Katha event on October 29 in Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh, said, "Those who follow Krishna might feel bad, but Krishna is very crooked (*tedha*). Even when he stands, he is bent at three places." In the viral reels from the event, he contrasted this by saying Lord Ram always stands perfectly straight. He also questioned the significance of Krishna's flute-playing and how it's less worthy than Ram's bow and arrow.

Calling Mr. Shastri, a "BJP-protected" individual, SP president Akhilesh Yadav sought action against him and questioned why the U.P. government had taken no punitive action, arguing that any ordinary citizen would face immediate arrest for similar statements.

Mr. Shastri apologised, saying his comments were taken out of context and meant in jest, reflecting the playful devotional traditions of Braj culture, where devotees affectionately "complain" about the deity. Questioning SP's religious credentials, BJP spokesperson Guru Prakash said the party had no moral authority to lecture others on Hindu deities.

Ayodhya to Mathura

Interestingly, the political ecosystem that typically champions a robust, assertive, and unyielding interpretation of faith is now urging the public to look for "deeper theological context" and philosophical nuance regarding Mr. Shastri's seemingly crude remarks.

Observers say that, with the Ram episode seeming to have run its course in terms of electoral dividends, the party can now look up to Krishna and shift the electoral epicentre from Ayodhya to Mathura.

"It is like one avatar making way for the other," says a Vishwa Hindu Parishad official in Meerut. He reminds us the fight for Krishna Janmabhoomi is being fought only in courts, with little mass mobilisation.

A Noida-based 'nationalist' poet pointed out that hundreds of devotees attended the congregation in Shivpuri. "Shastri has a distinct style that mixes sharp colloquial humor with scriptural narration and aggressive cultural nationalism. If he gives them a hint, it will release the tension of the BJP and put a question mark on SP's commitment towards the God with a Yaduvanshi lineage."

It is like using the Lord both as centripetal and centrifugal force. No wonder the right-wing ecosystem is quick to press SP to declare its stance on the Shahi Idgah and Shri Krishna Janmabhoomi. Political observers feel BJP could make it a Yadav versus Muslim issue for the SP.

Assam CM is inciting protests in Zubeen death case, says MLA

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Sibsagar MLA and Raijor Dal president Akhil Gogoi has accused Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma of encouraging people to protest against judges and witnesses in the Zubeen Garg death case.

On Friday, the Chief Minister flagged a threat to his family after a group threatened to besiege his house over the case. He also said he would bring the threat by Zubeen Garg Nyay Dabi Samiti to the notice of the Supreme Court and the Gauhati High Court, as it could amount to an attempt to murder.

Mr. Gogoi, who leads the Samiti, responded by saying the Chief Minister's remarks amounted to contempt of court.

Denying he threatened the judiciary, the MLA said his protests targeted the Assam government's handling of the investigation. "I have not said a single word against the court or judges. We have never spoken of surrounding the courts. It is the Chief Minister who has said that," he said in a statement the Samiti issued on Friday evening.

"We are protesting against the executive's failure to submit a charge sheet supported by adequate evidence before the court," Mr. Gogoi said, pointing out that the Chief Minister also advised people to confront some 160 witnesses who allegedly did a volte-face to let singer Amritprava Mahanta, one of the seven accused in the Garg death case, get bail on October 9.

Garg died while swimming in the sea off Singapore on September 19, 2025.

Ensure no more polls are held using post-SIR rolls, activists tell President

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

People Against Special Intensive Revision (PASIR), a platform of various class, mass and civil society organisations campaigning against the SIR, has urged President Droupadi Murmu to ensure that no further election is held using the post-SIR voter rolls.

In a statement issued on Saturday, the PASIR National Coordination Committee said it had resolved to intensify its struggle against the SIR.

Among its other demands, PASIR called for the prosecution and removal of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, restoration of voting rights of all citizens, a return to paper ballots, and repeal of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act of 2023.

It also demanded that the Supreme Court's guidelines be adopted to ensure the democratic accountability of the ECI.

PASIR will also launch a nationwide campaign, Reclaim Our Democracy, from November 26 to December 20.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, KHAIRIBHANDAN & DEO IRRIGATION PROJECT, KARANJIA, AT/PO : KARANJIA, DIST:- MAYURBHANJ-757037
Tel : 06796-296144, e-mail - cce.dip.dowr@gmail.com

"e" Procurement Notice No.19/CCEKDIP of 2026-27 - Bid Identification No. 19/CCEKDIP of 2026-27

1.	Nature of the Work	:	Civil Work
2.	Number of Works	:	01 (One) Nos of Individual Work
3.	Approximate amount put to tender	:	Rs.246.60 Lakh
4.	Period of Completion	:	9 (Nine) Calendar Months including rainy season
5.	Class of Contractor	:	"B" & "A" Class Contractor
6.	Date & time of Availability of Bid document in the portal	:	Dt.11.11.2026 at 10 AM to 25.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM
7.	Last date & time of seeking tender clarification	:	Dt.21.11.2026 up to 1.00 PM
8.	Last date & time of receipt of Bids in the Portal	:	Dt.25.11.2026 up to 5.30 PM
9.	Date, time & place of opening of Technical Bid/s (Cover-I)	:	Dt.26.11.2026 at 10.30 AM in O/o the Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia
10.	Date, time & place of opening of Financial Bid/s (Cover-II)	:	To be intimated after evaluation of Technical BID
11.	Name & address of the officer inviting Bid	:	Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia, AT/PO-Karanjia, PS-Karanjia, Dist-Mayurbhanj, PIN-757037

*Further details can be seen from the Govt. web site : www.tendersodisha.gov.in.
Any addendum/corrigendum/cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said Website
32001/1286/2627
Chief Construction Engineer, Khairibhandan & Deo Irrigation Project, Karanjia
OIPR-32001/32337/1/26-27/0018

U.T. OF LAKSHADWEEP
LAKSHADWEEP DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION LIMITED
(A GOVERNMENT OF INDIA UNDERTAKING)
Ph: 04842323448/458, www.ldclindia.com

E-TENDER NOTICE
Onboard Canteens on Passenger Vessels

LDCL invites online bids to operate, manage and upgrade onboard canteens and allied facilities on passenger vessels for three years, subject to annual performance review under Quality and Cost Based Selection (QCBS) method.
Tender ID 2026_UTL_3508_1
Pre-bid meeting : 19 November 2026 at 3 PM IST.
Submit bids by 7 December 2026 at 2:30 PM IST.
Tender documents and bids: https://tendersutl.gov.in
Sd/-
Managing Director, LDCL

AUCTION SALE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY
INCOME TAX DEPARTMENT
OFFICE OF THE TAX RECOVERY OFFICER, KOCHI-1

Immovable property situated at Choornikara Village (5.61 Ares) in Ernakulam district attached by Income Tax Department will be sold in public auction through E-auction on MSTC platform at 11:00 A.M. on 27th November, 2026. Auction notice of the property and terms and conditions can be viewed on www.mstcindia.co.in. Scan QR code for direct access to the link. Intending bidders may please register with www.mstcecommerce.com by remitting one time registration (non-refundable) charges of Rs. 1000/- + GST. EMD is Rs. 1 lakh.

Contact: -
For Registration: Shri Santhosh Kumar (MSTC) (Mob: 8884600700) For Details: Shri E Muanthang Vaiphei, TRO, Kochi-1 (Mob: 8547000839) / Shri Sunny, TRI O/o PCIT, Kochi-1 (Mob: 8816917886)

INBRIEF



Sharad Pawar discharged from Mumbai hospital

NCP-SP chief Sharad Pawar was on Saturday discharged from a Mumbai hospital after undergoing treatment for chest and respiratory infection. Mr. Pawar, 85, later proceeded to his residence near the Breach Candy Hospital, where he was under treatment for the last three days. Dr. Pratit Samdani of Breach Candy Hospital told presspersons that Mr. Pawar has been discharged in a stable condition. "He will continue his treatment at home. He had suffered from a bronchitis attack and a chest infection, which are now improving," the doctor said. Industrialist Gautam Adani and NCP leader Praful Patel had visited the hospital. PTI

Indian diplomat elected to UN's advisory committee

Indian diplomat Shivani Gupta has been elected to the UN's Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions (ACABQ) for the 2027-2029 term. India's Permanent Mission to the UN expressed its gratitude to all UN member states for their trust as it announced Ms. Gupta's election. She will begin her term in January 2027. The ACABQ consists of 21 members appointed by the Assembly in their individual capacities. The members are elected for a period of three years to ensure accountability and efficiency in utilising member states' contributions in support of the UN's global work. PTI

BJP MLA Sankalp Amonkar inducted into Goa Cabinet

Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) MLA Sankalp Amonkar was sworn in as a Cabinet Minister in the Pramod Sawant-led Goa government on Saturday, filling the berth that had remained vacant since the death of former Agriculture Minister Ravi Naik in October last year. Governor P. Ashok Gajapathy Raju administered the oath of office and secrecy to Mr. Amonkar in the presence of Mr. Sawant and other Cabinet colleagues. The new induction is expected to strengthen the BJP in the Mormugao region ahead of the 2027 Assembly election. Mr. Amonkar had contested the 2022 Assembly election on a Congress ticket and defeated three-time BJP MLA Milind Naik from Mormugao by a margin of 1,941 votes.

'All angles' being probed after blast at police outpost in U.P.

Anti-Terrorist Squad and bomb disposal teams were rushed to a police outpost in Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh, after an explosion left a person injured, the police said on Saturday. A police sub-inspector and a food delivery person were present at the outpost when the blast took place near its boundary wall on Friday night and the latter sustained minor injuries, the police said. While the motive behind the blast is unclear, the police said that all angles were being probed, including the possibility of a terrorist attack. The police are also verifying a social media post by an organisation named "Tehrik-Ul-Mujahideen" which claimed responsibility for the blast. PTI

SUDOKU

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2					5			9
4	7	5				1		
		1	5					4
	5						3	
6					9	2		
		3				4	1	8
5			7					3
1			4		6			

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

No. SS7055 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

2	4	8	6	9	1	7	5	3
9	7	6	5	3	8	2	1	4
5	1	3	7	4	2	9	8	6
6	2	4	9	1	5	8	3	7
8	3	9	2	7	4	1	6	5
1	5	7	3	8	6	4	9	2
3	9	5	8	2	7	6	4	1
4	8	2	1	6	3	5	7	9
7	6	1	4	5	9	3	2	8

Rajnath warns of evolving threats, calls for highest military readiness

Addressing personnel at key airbase near China frontier, Defence Minister warns of adversaries exploiting 'vulnerabilities'; reviews Army's LAC infrastructure, lauds initiatives along the border aimed at strengthening ties with local communities

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh visited members of the armed forces at multiple locations in West Bengal on Saturday and highlighted a changing nature of warfare while describing the northeast as India's "first edge" rather than its "last edge".

The security landscape around the country has become increasingly complex and the armed forces must maintain the highest level of operational readiness to effectively counter any threats to national security, he told personnel at the Bagdogra Air Force station.

Delivering his message on the eve of Deepavali from the key airbase near the frontier with China in the Eastern sector, Mr. Singh, without naming any country, said the adversary now avoids direct confrontation but seeks to exploit certain "vulnerabilities".



Rajnath Singh shares sweets with Army personnel at Sukna Military Station in West Bengal's Darjeeling district. PTI

He called upon the armed forces to keep special focus on strengthening domain awareness, cyber resilience, and information integrity to effectively counter emerging security threats, according to the Defence Ministry.

Describing Bagdogra as a strategically important region and a crucial link in India's security framework, Mr. Singh commended the courage and dedication of the defence personnel towards safeguarding national interests. He stated that the Air Force personnel deployed in the region serve as a robust shield for the security of the eastern sector, and their preparedness is fundamental to maintaining stability in the region.

The Defence Minister later reviewed the operational preparedness of the Army's Trishakti Corps at Sukna, with a focus on infrastructure development along the Line of Actual Control (LAC), deployment of advanced military equipment, and adoption of emerging technologies to enhance combat effectiveness.

Mr. Singh appreciated its contribution to infrastructure development and community welfare initiatives in border areas aimed at strengthening ties with local communities.

Highlighting the changing nature of warfare, he said security challenges were no longer confined to conventional exchanges of gunfire and artillery but increasingly involved hybrid warfare, proxy wars, cyberattacks, drone incursions, and information warfare.

He cautioned that adversaries were using social media to spread rumours, deploying drones to monitor sensitive locations, and attempting to compromise military systems through cyber attacks. He exhorted personnel to remain vigilant and prepared to tackle emerging threats across all domains.

Describing Sukna as a critical logistics hub for eastern India, Mr. Singh said its geographical sensitivity necessitated round-the-clock operational readiness. He highlighted its importance in the movement of supplies, weapons, food, medical provisions, and personnel to forward locations. Mr. Singh also stressed the importance of soldiers' mental health and emotional well-being, urging them to communicate openly with their colleagues and seek support to deal with stress arising from demanding duties and separation from families.

Assam OIL facility fire death toll rises to three

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Two of six persons injured in Friday's fire following an explosion at an Oil India Limited (OIL) facility in eastern Assam's Dibrugarh died on Saturday.

Tapas Gogoi, working for a Mumbai-based private agency engaged by the oil exploration major, died due to his injuries at a private hospital in Dibrugarh town at around 3 a.m.

Another worker, Rupam Gogoi, died at a private hospital in Guwahati at around 11 a.m., taking the death toll in the fire incident to three. The third person, identified as Raju Dutta, died from the impact of the explosion on Friday morning. The fire broke out around 9.05 a.m. at the indirect bath heater in OIL's intermediate tank farm at Tengakhat. The bath heater was isolated on November 4 for maintenance. Four other workers injured in the incident are undergoing treatment.

Floral gold



Deepavali blooms: Women harvest marigold flowers on the eve of Deepavali at the CSIR-IIIM field station at Bonera in Pulwama district, south Kashmir on Saturday. IMRAN NISSAR

Arrangements in place for festive rush, says Railway Minister

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Union Minister of Railways Ashwini Vaishnaw said that the government's "war room" set up for the festive rush was closely tracking crowds across 28 key stations in the Indian Railways network. "We are ensuring that there are additional trains and waiting areas in stations," Mr. Vaishnaw said, displaying a live dashboard of crowd levels in the various railway stations in the country.

More tracks, more halts

Over 18,000 additional trains had been arranged for this period, Mr. Vaishnaw said, adding that this was well above the 12,000 special trains arranged last year around the same period. The additional trains, Mr. Vaishnaw said, came thanks to an addition in tracks.

The only station that has reached severe crowding by the Railway Ministry's yardstick is New Delhi (NDLS), where Friday evening saw massive crowds from 4 p.m. onwards. Mr. Vaishnaw said that the crowd was eased out by the additional trains within four hours, and that on Saturday morning, no such crowd built up in the railway station.

Mr. Vaishnaw said that a First Information Report (FIR) had been filed against misleading claims of station crowding that allegedly used old footage, and instructed officials to have those clips taken down from social media.

Delhi traffic jams rose 12.6% in a year; Qutab Road, Chirag Delhi among worst hotspots

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

Qutab Road, Chirag Delhi and Bara Tooti Chowk are among the 10 locations identified as persistent traffic congestion hotspots in Delhi, with commercial activity, roadside parking, freight movement, construction work and poorly designed junctions emerging as major contributing factors, according to an analysis by ASTraM (Actionable Intelligence for Sustainable Traffic Management) shared exclusively with *The Hindu*.

Qutab Road recorded the highest average daily congestion length among the 10 locations, at 59.10 km, followed by Chirag Delhi (42.57 km), Bara Tooti Chowk (38.90 km), Lothiyan Marg-Church Road (34.44 km) and Kalindi Kunj (30.76 km).

Senior traffic police officers and personnel deployed on the ground told *The Hindu* that the increasing number of vehicles on roads with limited width are a major cause of congestion. They also pointed to junction-related bottlenecks and other local factors.

Srinivas Ganji, Service Area Leader at Arcadis, which developed and deployed ASTraM in partnership with traffic police authorities in India, said the findings indicated that congestion could not be attributed to traffic volume alone. Commercial establishments, wholesale markets, roadside parking, loading and unloading activities, and encroachments reduced usable road space, while poorly channelled traffic and conflicting vehicle movements contributed to queues at several junctions.

At Qutab Road, congestion was attributed to high commercial activity, roadside parking, loading and unloading operations, encroachments and heavy traffic demand. At Chirag Delhi, average daily congestion length rose by 80.38% over the year, from around 23.6 km in September 2025.

Northeast's first AI-enabled career intelligence facility starts operation in Manipur

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Conflict-scarred Manipur has become the first State in the northeastern region to get an artificial intelligence (AI)-enabled facility that aims to mould careers.

Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh on Saturday inaugurated the AI-enabled Career Intelligence Hub at the Tamphasana Girls' Higher Secondary School in Imphal, the State's capital.

Established under the Members of Parliament Local Area Development Scheme as the region's first-of-its-kind facility, the initiative marked a "significant step towards integrating AI into the education and career guidance ecosystem in the State".

The Chief Minister said the government undertook the initiative to provide students with technology-driven career guidance, personalised counselling, and information on emerging career opportunities.



Manipur CM Yumnam Khemchand Singh interacts with students at a science event in Imphal on Saturday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

He commended students who focused on their education and future instead of participating in agitations over the past few months, advising others to pursue dialogue as the preferred means of resolving any differences and addressing critical issues.

"AI has advanced significantly and is increasingly transforming various fields and professions," he said, underscoring the need for students to upgrade for the career challenges ahead.

Earlier, the Chief Minister lauded two districts–Imphal West and Pherzawl–for achieving '*surakshit*' safe status in October under the National AIDS Control Organisation's (NACO) Mobilisation for AIDS Suraksha initiative.

"This achievement means that 95% of the estimated number of people living with Human Immunodeficiency Virus (HIV) in a district are aware of their status, 95% of those aware of their status are receiving antiretroviral therapy (ART), and 95% of those undergoing ART have achieved viral suppression," he said.

Rajasthan wins award for renewable energy efforts

The Hindu Bureau
JAIPUR

Rajasthan has received a national award for its outstanding performance under the Renewable Energy State Assessment Framework (RE-SAF), developed by the Union Ministry of New and Renewable Energy. Vice-President C.P. Radhakrishnan gave away the award at a function in New Delhi over the week-end.

Minister of State for Energy Heeralal Nagar, who received the award, said Rajasthan had emerged as the country's largest green energy hub over the years. "The State now has an installed renewable energy capacity of 51.6 GW and a solar power capacity of 45 GW," he said.

Mr. Nagar said the State was playing a "pivotal role" in achieving the national goal of 500 GW non-fossil fuel-based installed power capacity by 2030. Rajasthan had received top honours under RE-SAF developed by the Union Ministry in collaboration with the Power Finance Corporation, he said.

INBRIEF



Coca-Cola's Indian bottling arm HCCH files IPO papers

Global beverage major The Coca-Cola Company's Indian bottling business, Hindustan Coca-Cola Holdings Ltd. (HCCH), has filed draft papers with SEBI to raise funds through an initial public offering (IPO). The proposed offering would be be entirely an offer for sale (OFS) of up to 99.75 crore equity shares by promoter Hindustan Coca-Cola Overseas Holdings Pte Ltd, according to the draft red herring prospectus (DRHP) dated November 6. PTI

IL JIN Electronics files draft papers for ₹2,500-crore IPO

IL JIN Electronics (India) Ltd., an arm of Amber Enterprises India Ltd., has filed preliminary papers with market regulator SEBI to raise ₹2,500 crore through an initial public offering (IPO). The proposed IPO is entirely a fresh issue of equity shares, with no offer for sale, as per the draft red herring prospectus. The firm plans to use the proceeds to repay or prepay some outstanding borrowings, among others. PTI

Prestige Group buys 100% in Allure Developers for ₹524 cr.

Realty firm Prestige Estates Projects Ltd. has acquired a 100 % stake in Allure Developers for ₹524 crore as part of its expansion plan in Delhi-NCR. In a regulatory filing, Prestige Estates said it has entered into a share purchase agreement on November 6, to acquire a 100% stake in Allure Developers Pvt Ltd. With this acquisition, Allure has become a wholly owned subsidiary of the company. Allure is undertaking development of a residential project in Noida Sector 150. The company will pay consideration in tranches of up to ₹523.76 crore. PTI

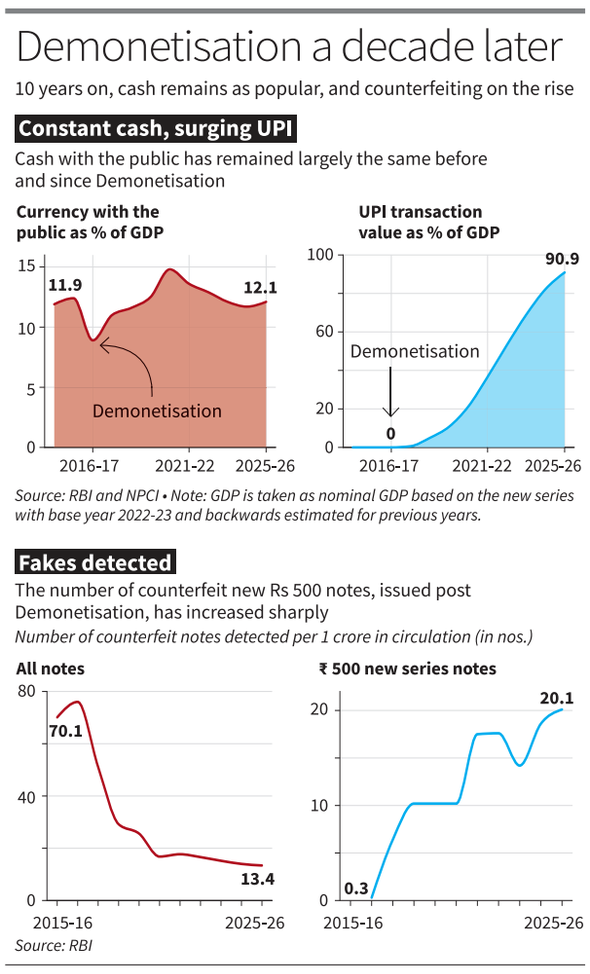
10 years of note ban: cash use consistent, fake notes on rise

This Deepavali marks 10 years since PM Narendra Modi announced overnight demonetisation of 86% of the country's cash; data shows some stated goals of the move remain largely unmet

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Ten years after Demonetisation, Reserve Bank of India (RBI) data show the exercise has had little impact on reducing cash in circulation and detection of fake currency, particularly ₹500 notes also increased.

On the other hand, the value of transactions on the Unified Payments Interface (UPI) had grown steadily year after year, even when measured as a percentage of India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP).



Cash usage unchanged

"The magnitude of cash in circulation is directly linked to the level of corruption," PM Narendra Modi said when announcing note ban decision on November 8, 2016. "Inflation becomes worse through the deployment of cash earned in corrupt ways."

The "high circulation of cash also boost hawala trade which is directly connected to black money and illegal trade in weapons".

One of the stated aims of demonetisation, therefore, was to turn India into a less-cash society. The data show that this objective remains largely unfulfilled.

The RBI's data on currency with the public show this amount, as a percentage of GDP, stayed largely the same as it was prior to note ban. Currency with the public as a percentage of GDP stood at 11.9% in 2015-16, the financial year preceeding demonetisation and rose marginally to 12.1% by March 31, 2026. The value of UPI transactions as a percentage of GDP, however, had grown from zero in 2016-17 to nearly 91% in 2025-26.

Fake notes, a problem

"Have you ever thought about how these terrorists get their money," Mr. Modi further said in his speech in 2016. "Enemies from across the border run operations using fake currency notes. This has been going on for years. Many times, those using fake ₹500 and and ₹1,000 notes have been caught and many of the notes seized."

Another aim of demonetisation was to end the scourge of counterfeiting of Indian currency. However, performance on this metric also was uneven.

The RBI has data on the number of counterfeit notes detected per one crore of notes in circulation. Across all notes, the data shows a significant improvement in terms of counterfeiting.

That is, the number of total fake notes detected per crore of notes in circulation fell from 70.1 in 2015-16 to 13.4 in 2025-26.

However, in the wake of demonetisation, the government also introduced a new series of ₹500 notes and ₹2,000 notes that were supposed to be more secure and difficult to fake.

Detection up

The RBI data shows the central bank's detection of fake ₹500 notes had shot up since demonetisation.

While it found 0.3 fake ₹500 notes per 1 crore of those notes in circulation in 2016-17 when they were introduced, this number stood at 20.1 as of 2025-26.

Making a calculation for the ₹2,000 note is more tricky because the RBI in 2023 began taking the note out of circulation.

However, the data shows once it started doing this, its detection of fake ₹2,000 notes shot up. The detection of fake notes can be for two reasons. The first is that there is a rise in counterfeiting, and the second is that detection has become better. It is unclear from the data which of these is the driving factor.

SoftBank sells almost 1.56% Lenskart stake for ₹1,896 crore

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI



Goldman Sachs emerged as the largest buyer.

Japanese technology investor SoftBank trimmed its stake in eyewear retailer Lenskart Solutions, selling a 1.56% holding for ₹1,896 crore through open market transactions, according to block deal data on the BSE.

SoftBank, through affiliate SVF II Lightbulb (Cayman) Ltd, offloaded 2.72 crore shares in 10 tranches at an average price of ₹697.15 apiece on Friday.

The combined deal transaction stood at ₹1,896.24 crore.

After the transaction, SoftBank's stake in Gurugram-based Lenskart fell to 5.71% from 7.27%.

Local and foreign institutional investors picked up equal number of shares at the same price. U.S.' Goldman Sachs emerged as the largest buyer, acquiring 91.84 lakh shares worth over ₹640 crore.

Tata Steel Q2 net profit jumps 16% to ₹3,700 crore

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

Tata Steel on Saturday posted a more than 16% year-on-year rise in consolidated net profit to ₹3,700 crore in the September quarter, driven by higher revenues, mainly from India operations.

It clocked ₹3,183 crore profit after tax (PAT) in the second quarter of the preceding 2025-26 financial year, the company said in a statement.

During the latest July-September quarter, consolidated revenue rose to ₹65,436 crore from ₹58,689 crore a year ago.

The company produced 8.07 million tonne (MT) and sold 7.92 MT of steel in Q2 FY27 as against 7.73 MT output and 7.91 MT deliveries a year ago.

T. V. Narendran, CEO & MD, said: "We delivered strong growth in deliveries and earnings this quarter, backed by a resilient supply chain and close customer engagement, despite ongoing geo-economic uncertainty and higher raw material costs."


Sanjeev Sharma (Left) with T. K. Sridhar (Right)

'Automation boosted ABB jobs, hiring low skilled staff'

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

Contrary to fears automation will lead to job losses, especially among lower-skilled workers, high-precision engineering firm ABB India found automation has not only allowed it to substantially increase its workforce in India but also to employ lower-skilled workers and train them, CEO and MDSanjeev Sharma said in an interview.

Also, the firm committed to invest $75 million in India over 2026 and 2027 to fuel organic expansion in India with new focus on Tier-II and Tier-III cities, ABB India MD-designate T. K. Sridhar said during the joint interview.

As per the firm's data, revenue almost doubled to about $1.4 billion in 2025 from $730 million in 2021.

Of $75 million it will invest, $22 million will be in Nashik electrification unit, $21 million in motion unit at Bengaluru, $14 million in lectrification and automation units in Nelamangala, $12 million in electrification R&D lab-office in Hyderabad and $6 million in motion plant in Vadodara.

(The author was in Bengaluru at the invitation of ABB India)

₹904-crore SBI fraud case: CBI books Future Retail, Biyani

Yohaan Varghese
MUMBAI


Kishore Biyani

The Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI) has registered a case against Future Retail Limited, promoters Kishore Biyani and Rakesh Biyani and several others for allegedly defrauding the State Bank of India (SBI) of ₹904.32 crore.

The agency also conducted searches at multiple premises linked to the company's promoters and directors in Mumbai on Friday and seized documents relevant to the investigation.

Complaint from SBI

The case was registered following a complaint filed by SBI's Stressed Assets Management Branch-III in Mumbai. The FIR also names the company's managing director, executive directors, guarantors, unidentified public servants and other individuals.

According to the complaint, Future Retail Limited allegedly misused credit facilities extended by the bank, resulting in a financial loss of ₹904.32 crore. The CBI has registered the case under provisions relating to criminal conspiracy, cheating and the Prevention of Corruption Act.

Fund diversion

The bank alleged that the company failed to utilise the sanctioned funds in accordance with the terms and conditions of the loan facilities. Instead, portions of the funds were allegedly diverted to associate companies and related entities, raising suspicions of financial irregularities.

Investigators are examining the movement of funds between Future Retail Limited and its associated entities to determine how the loan proceeds were utilised, which accounts received the money and whether the transactions involved fraudulent arrangements.

During the searches conducted on Friday, CBI officials seized documents and other materials considered relevant to the investigation. The seized records are being examined to trace financial transactions and establish whether loan funds were diverted from their intended purposes.

The agency is also investigating the roles of Kishore Biyani, Rakesh Biyani and other individuals named in the case.

The possible involvement of unidentified public servants in the alleged irregularities will also be examined.

The investigation will focus on tracing the ultimate utilisation of the loan funds, identifying the beneficiaries of the alleged diversion and determining the roles of those suspected of involvement in the transactions. Further investigation is underway.

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE ADDITIONAL CHIEF ENGINEER,
EASTERN CIRCLE-I, CANTONMENT ROAD, KATAKA.
Email id :- seeccuttack@gmail.com

"e" Procurement Notice No.ACE, EC-I/12 of 2026-27

1.	Nature of work	: Stone Work.
2.	Total no. of works	: 01 No.
3.	Tender Amount	: Rs. 421.60 lakh (Approx.)
4.	Tender paper cost	: Rs.10,000/- (Non refundable)
5.	EMD required	: Rs. 4,21,600/-
6.	Class of contractor	: 'A'
7.	Period of completion	: 08 (Eight) Calendar Months
8.	Online for bidding	: 12.11.2026 at 10.00 hrs. to 26.11.2026 up to 17.30 hrs.
9.	Date & time of opening of Tender (Technical bid)	: 27.11.2026 at 11.30 hrs.

Other terms and conditions can be seen from the Govt. website "www.tendersodisha.gov.in".
All corrigendum / cancellation of tender if any, will only be uploaded in the above web site.

Additional Chief Engineer, Eastern Circle-I, Kataka.
32001/1279/2627
OIPR-32001/32370/1/26-27/0011

OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER, RWS&S DIVISION, JAGATSINGHPUR.
Tel.No.06724 - 223485, mail - rwssjspur@gmail.com
e-Procurement Notice - Bid Identification No.37 of 2026-27
Letter No. 3020, Date: 02/11/2026

The Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Jagatsinghpur on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites P1 composite bids in Double Cover system in online mode for different works on Percentage rate basis from eligible Class of contractors.

1.	Name of work	: Construction of Laboratory Building & Execution of PWS.
2.	No. of work	: 02 No.
3.	Estimated Cost	: Rs.14966148/-to Rs. 20358113/-
4.	Cost of Tender paper	: Rs. 10000/-
5.	Class of Contractor	: "B" & "A" Class
6.	Availability of Tender in Website	: 09.11.2026 to 23.11.2026
7.	Submission of Bid in Online	: 09.11.2026 to 23.11.2026
8.	Date of seeking Clarification	: 09.11.2026 to 13.11.2026
9.	Date of Opening of bids	: 25.11.2026 (11.00 A.M.) onwards.
10.	Name and address of O.I.T.	: Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Jagatsinghpur.
11.	All other details can be seen from the web site	: www.tendersorissa.gov.in
12.	Bid cost and Bid Security should be submitted in online mode.	
13.	Subsequent corrigendum / addendum if required shall only be appeared in above website.	

Superintending Engineer, RWS&S Division, Jagatsinghpur
25001/1480/2627
OIPR-25001/25024/1/26-27/0007

Rajasthan State Road Development And Construction Corporation Ltd., JAIPUR
No. : NIT/2026-27/9205 - 21 Date : 06/11/2026

निविदा सूचना/2026-27

निम्नलिखित परियोजनाओं पर पथकर वसूली हेतु ई-टेन्डिरिंग प्रकिया से ऑनलाईन निविदा आमंत्रित की जाती है:-

कार्य का विवरण	कार्य की कुल अनुमानित लागत(रु.)	निविदा सूचना संख्या
Selection of Bidder for Collection of User Fee on the basis of competitive bidding through e-procurement basis for the following For a Period of one Year:-		
On Nasirabad-Kekri-Deoli (SH-26) BOT Road. UBN: RRC2627SLOB00746	3884.11 Lakh	अल्पकालीन ई-458/26-27
On Jaipur-Bhilwara Road (SH-12). UBN: RRC2627SLOB00747	4961.91 Lakh	
On Udaipur-Salumber BOT Road (SH-32). UBN: RRC2627SLOB00745	1373.11 Lakh	
On Hanumangarh-Suratgarh (SH-94) BOT Road. UBN: RRC2627WLRC00743	1479.80 Lakh	
On Kotputli-Sikar-kuchman BOT Road. UBN: RRC2627WLOB00742	6287.09 Lakh	
On Banswara-Ratlam BOT Road. UBN: RRC2627SLOB00749	897.53 Lakh	
On Mahuwa-/hindaun-Karauli(SH-22) BOT Road for a period of 90 days. UBN: RRC2627SLOB00748	246.56 Lakh	अल्पकालीन ई-459/26-27

निविदा से सम्बन्धित प्रपत्र में निविदा शुल्क, धरोहर राशि, डाउनलोड करने व खोलने की तारीख सहित सम्पूर्ण विवरण एवं संशोधन वेबसाईट: http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in, http://sppp.rajasthan.nic.in तथा http://pwd.rajasthan.gov.in/rsrdc पर देखा जा सकता है। इच्छुक संवेदकों को अपने डिजिटल हस्ताक्षर के माध्यम से वेबसाईट http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in पर रजिस्टर्ड करवाना आवश्यक है।
महाप्रबंधक

KALYANA KARNATAKA ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION
STORES & PURCHASE DEPARTMENT, CENTRAL OFFICES,
Sarige Sadana, Main Road, Kalaburagi-585 102.
Mobile No. 77606 86172 (COSP), 77609 92029 (S.O).

No. KKRTC/CO/COSP/09/2026-27. Dated:06.11.2026.

TENDER INVITING NOTICE (THROUGH KPP PORTAL MODE ONLY)

Tenders through KPP portal (pre-qualification & commercial) are invited for supply of following items.

Sl. No.	Tender No.	Tender Nomenclature	Estimate Value (Rs.)	Last date for submission of tender
1	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0239	Procurement of Automotive Batteries	1.97 Core	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs
2	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0240	Procurement of New Tyre,Tube & Flap sets, Tubeless Tyres and Additional Tubes & Flaps	21.30 Core	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs
3	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0241	Procurement of Ball and Roller Bearings	2.19 Core	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs
4	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0242	Procurement of Clutch and Clutch Parts	5.15 Crore	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs
5	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0243	Procurement of Gaskets	0.42 Crore	23.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs
6	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0244	Procurement of Rubber Parts	1.32 Crore	23.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs
7	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0245	Procurement of Air Suspension Parts	1.45 Crore	23.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs
8	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0246	Procurement of Auto Cables and Wires	0.22 Crore	23.11.2026 at 15.00 hrs
9	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0223/Call-2	Procurement of Window flocked EPDM Rubber Channel	0.11 Crore	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs
10	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0211/Call-3	Supply and Installation of Fire and Detection & Suppression	0.40 Crore	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs
11	KKRTC/2026-27/ IND0212/Call-3	Procurement of First Aid Box With Medicine	0.57 Crore	07.12.2026 at 15.00 hrs

All the details of Tender, Registration, Tender form documents etc. are available at https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in/.Mail to cospnekrtc@gmail.com or support@eprochelpdesk.com for further information if required. Further, any addendum /corrigendum related to changes in terms and conditions of tender, specification and calendar of events etc. will be uploaded only through KPP portal.

Sd/- Controller of Stores and Purchases
(Tender Inviting Authority)
DIPR/Kalaburagi/659/KSMC&A/2026-27

APPOINTMENT

NATIONAL INSTITUTE FOR EMPOWERMENT OF PERSONS WITH MULTIPLE DISABILITIES (DIVYANGJAN)
(Dept. of Empowerment of Persons with Disabilities (Divyangjan), Ministry of Social Justice & Empowerment, Govt. of India)
Muttukadu, East Coast Road, Kovalam (P.O), Chennai - 603 112
Tamil Nadu – India. Phone: 044 – 27472046, 27472113, 27472423
www.niepmd.nic.in. Email: niepmd@gmail.com, niepmd@gov.in director@niepmd.tn.nic.in
~ Re-Accredited by NAAC (B+ 2nd Cycle)

Manpower Engagement Notification (Temporary) No.08/2026
(Online Application only)

NIEPMD invites online Applications from the eligible candidates for the following contractual engagement at CDEIC- NIEPMD (D), Chennai and CDEIC- CRC Madurai.

CDEIC - NIEPMD (D), CHENNAI

Clinical Psychologist/Rehabilitation Psychologist – 1, Occupational Therapist – 1, Audiologist &Speech Language Pathologist (ASLP) – 1, Early Interventionist – 1, Special Educator(ID) – 1, Special Educator (MD/LD/ASD/HI/VI) – 1, Physiotherapist – 2, Nurse – 1, Trained Caregivers – 2, Activity Teacher (Full Time) – 1, Need Based visits of external Medical Doctors/allied health professionals in relevant specialties – 1, Social Worker – 1, Data Entry Operator – 1

CDEIC - CRC MADURAI

Occupational Therapist – 1, Audiologist & Speech Language Pathologist (ASLP) – 1, Early Interventionist -1, Special Educator(ID) – 1, Special Educator (MD/LD/ASD/HI/VI) – 1, Physiotherapist – 1, Nurse – 1

The aspiring applicants fulfilling the eligibility criteria in all respect can submit their application through online mode. The online registration of application will be made available on NIEPMD website, Chennai official link i.e. https://niepmd.nic.in/notice-category/recruitments/ For all other details, terms and conditions, please log on to the website www.niepmd.nic.in

Sd/-
DIRECTOR

Cellophane bees produce a kind of plastic that degrades: study

Divya Gandhi

In March 2023, a team of scientists travelled to eastern Tennessee, the U.S., trowels in hand, and dug a few centimetres into the earth to follow small tunnels into nests created by a ground-nesting bee, *Colletes inaequalis*. They collected the translucent cell lining of the nests and transported it on ice to a lab, for a reason: to test its unique composition.

At the peak of an active nesting period, they found the lining, much like synthetic polyester, "was quite flexible and could be folded without noticeable fracture or deformation," the scientists said in their paper, published recently in the *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*.

When the team returned to the bee nests the next year and tested the lining again – which now contained pollen and late-stage larvae – they found it had cracked and crumbled. Specifically, they found the nest linings 11 months after they were built suffered "significant degradation," with the polyester content falling from 73% to 40% in four months in ambient soil.

Indeed, these bees of the Colletidae familyare not called the "cellophane" or "polyester" bees for nothing: their nests are lined with a material that is a mix of silk and polyester secreted from the female bees' abdomen, and it degrades quickly.

The finding opens avenues to solving the long-standing quest to create a biodegradable plastic.

"Nearly a third of plastic produced globally is mismanaged and enters the environment. Roughly one third is polythene, which persists in the environment for centuries," the paper noted. The polluting material has become critical to a range of fields, from agriculture to pharmaceuticals. Almost none of this plastic is biodegradable because the polymers consist of entirely carbon-carbon bonds that do not break readily under natural or engineered biodegradation conditions.

"To address the plastic pollution crisis, many have attempted to design biodegradable polythene-like plastics, primarily polyesters... Unfortunately, most [polythene]-like polyesters exhibit little biodegradability due to their crystallinity and ability to repel water, the paper added. There is therefore a growing need for materials that are environmentally compatible while also meeting the needs of packaging", the researchers pointed out.

The paper conceded that it was intriguing that the Colletes polyester showed no evidence of accumulation in the environment over time, even though bees of this genus nest annually in aggregations that can consist of more than 10,000 individual nests. Subsequent generations of bees return to the same aggregations and build new nests underground every year for decades.

House lizards can contaminate a meal but are not poisonous

Media reports from around India have periodically fuelled the belief that lizards can poison food; but while such incidents raise legitimate food-safety concerns, they also risk giving an already misunderstood animal a worse reputation

Nobinraja M.
BENGALURU

The common house gecko *(Hemidactylus frenatus)* is a familiar sight in many Indian homes and has adapted well to human life. But what does science say about the idea that it can poison food?

Recent reports from Tamil Nadu and other parts of India have put house lizards in an unfavourable spotlight. In September, children at a government school in Kottaiyur in Tiruvallur district reportedly fell ill after a lizard was found in their breakfast. Similar incidents were reported in Mannankadu, near Pattukottai, in February and in Jambai in Kallakurichi district in September 2025.

These and other reports have periodically fuelled the belief that lizards can poison food. But while such incidents raise legitimate food-safety concerns, they also risk giving an already misunderstood animal a worse reputation.

"There are no known toxins or venom in house geckos. If they bite you, or you bite them, there are no fatal consequences. If they fall in your food, there is no risk of transfer of any poison of any kind either," Subhasmita Patro, a herpetologist at the Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru, said.

"Yes, house geckos are carriers of several disease-causing pathogens found on their skin and droppings that can potentially cause intestinal distress, diarrhoea, and typhoid," Dr. Patro added. "However, the chances of a gecko being infected with [these] pathogens is very low."

"But in contrast, a high percentage of geckos can be infected with several intestinal parasites such as nematodes and trematodes. However, these internal parasites generally do not pose any direct health risks to humans under normal living conditions."

House geckos are not the only potential source of microbial contamination. Houseflies, for instance, can transfer pathogens such as Salmonella and Escherichia coli to food.

The children may fall ill for other reasons. "While house geckos are not known to be poisonous or venomous to humans, hygiene remains a concern if they fall into food," Vrinda Lath, an assistant professor of emergency medicine at Kasturba Medical College, Manipal, said. "Although such incidents are uncommon, food contaminated by a gecko should not be consumed. Fear and panic may also trigger symptoms such as nausea, vomiting, and hyperventilation."

Establishing whether a lizard actually caused the reported illnesses requires careful investigation. Often, the facts around such incidents are blurred. For example, the incident at Kottaiyur Panchayat Union Middle School in Tiruvallur district on September 24 acquired three different narratives across four news sources.

One news article said that the cooks spotted the lizard while transferring the food. Another said teachers had checked the food only after the students started complaining of dizziness.

They are effectively different accounts of when and how the lizard was discovered. The sequence of events is important to identify the cause. If the children were informed about the lizard before symptoms developed, panic may have played a role. If symptoms appeared before the lizard was found, food contamination will have to be investigated.

The reported student enrolment figures also vary, as does the type of food served. One report stated the children were made to drink salt water to induce vomiting. While 39 children were discharged and allowed to return home, one girl was admitted to hospital with diarrhoea. This also raises the question of whether the salt water itself contributed to her symptoms, as research has documented that consuming excessive amounts of salt can cause diarrhoea. These inconsistencies highlight why such incidents require careful investigation.

According to the U.S. Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, the symptoms of a Salmonella infection usually begin six hours to six days after infection. So children falling ill immediately after a meal does not fit the typical timeline for salmonellosis.

In 2014, when 350 schoolchildren in Bengaluru fell ill after a lizard was reportedly found in their midday meal, early media reports linked the discovery to the mass hospitalisation.. However, health officials later suggested mass hysteria may have contributed to the symptoms. A year on, the Forensic Science Laboratory ruled out the lizard as the cause and pointed to unclean utensils and unhygienic conditions, although no residues of the toxic substances they were looking for were detected.

"The fears surrounding house geckos in India stem more from folklore rather than biological reality," Dr. Patro said.

In fact, house geckos excel at indoor pest control. "If you spot a few geckos in your home, the best approach is simply to leave them alone," Dr. Patro said. "If you prefer to move them, you can gently usher them outside with a broom."

(Nobinraja M. is a postdoctoral researcher at the Conservation Genetics Lab in ATREE, Bengaluru)

Reptile reputation

Establishing whether a lizard actually caused the reported illnesses after falling in food requires careful investigation

- The common house gecko is frequently found in Indian homes but carries a false reputation as poisonous
- Recent news reports have mistakenly blamed these reptiles for causing sudden illness among many schoolchildren
- Scientific experts say these common house lizards lack any toxins or venoms that are harmful or dangerous to humans
- Reported sicknesses are often caused by highly unhygienic conditions or mass panic rather than the animal itself



Eyes wide open: 'If they bite you, or you bite them, there are no fatal consequences'. CRICKET RASPET (CC BY)

- Inconsistent media narratives emphasise a strong need for proper investigations into these alleged food-poisoning incidents
- People should often leave these geckos alone because they provide indoor pest control services, experts added

How supermarkets became targets of cyberattacks

John Xavier

When 150 Intermarche stores in France found their refrigeration systems running at 50 degrees Celsius in October, the first question was the usual one: who wants the money?

Three weeks later, the same pattern repeated in supermarkets across Belgium, Estonia, Finland, Ireland, Italy, Luxembourg, the Netherlands, Portugal, Germany and Sweden.

Outlets of Carrefour, Spar and Delhaize were hit, and even a few restaurants run by furniture maker Ikea. Still, no one asked for a ransom. No customer data was stolen, and no database has turned up on the dark web.

For a decade, the image of a cyberattack has been a locked screen, a crypto wallet address and a database of stolen credentials. Criminals attack for profit, either by encrypting systems and demanding payment or by stealing data that can be sold.

This hack was completely different. The attackers only wanted to spoil food, empty shelves and cause public anxiety. A cybercriminal has little reason to destroy the stock of the businesses it hopes to extort. An attacker with a different purpose does not share that restraint.

The method was strikingly ordinary. Modern supermarkets manage refrigeration through central controllers, many connected to the internet so that maintenance contractors can adjust settings without a site visit.

That convenience opened the door to a hacker who did not need to invent anything new. They just had to trigger the "forced defrost" function, pushing target temperatures to 50 degrees Celsius, and stretching the defrost cycle from one hour to eight.



A notice informing customers that refrigerators are temporarily out of service at the Delhaize Shop & Go store. REUTERS

It was a normal command sent to an exposed controller.

The weak link appears to be software. Controllers in older systems were built for convenience and reliability, not internet-grade security, and they typically stay in service for 10 to 20 years, far beyond the support cycle of ordinary software.

Hardware installed today may outlive several generations of the systems used to manage it. But newer equipment was not spared either.

Reports suggest that systems made by Danish engineering firm Danfoss were targeted.

Interestingly, Claroty researchers disclosed vulnerabilities in the web interfaces of Danfoss controllers in August, about two months before the French attack, and found that units running older software were exposed.

Danfoss said it has long advised customers to update firmware and keep systems behind a firewall. While that recommendation is valid, it assumes every operator knows what its controllers are connected to.

Legacy software explains how the attackers got in. But it does not explain why. Spoiling stock gives an attacker nothing, so the likelier objective is disruption itself: testing how far the everyday supply chains a society depends on can be pushed.

The question for other countries, India included, is not whether the same attack could happen but whether anyone has checked. Indian vendors already sell IoT (Internet of Things) refrigeration monitoring to supermarkets and dark stores. And most temperature-monitoring systems read data and raise alerts rather than change settings. But whether remote links can alter controller settings, and how well they are secured, is not clear.

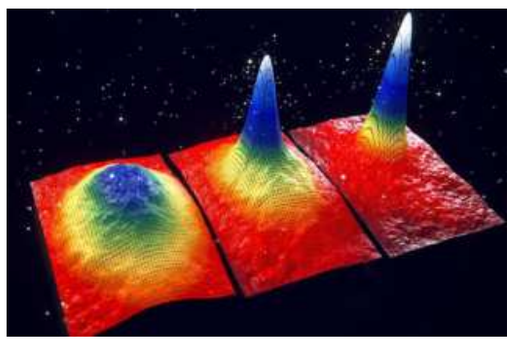
Whoever is behind the cyberattack on supermarkets in Europe, the lesson is already clear. Critical infrastructure is no longer limited to power grids and hospitals. The fixes are not sophisticated. Patch controllers promptly, and replace those out of support. Take critical hardware off the public internet. Put all remote access behind a VPN with multi-factor authentication. And regulators should ask whether food retail needs mandatory standards for operational technology security.

SNAPSHOTS



Toothbrush beats dental plaque using small shocks

Scientists in China have developed a toothbrush that cleans teeth by combining physical scrubbing with a spark. Its bristles, made of a material called PVDF, generate a mild electric charge when they bend during brushing, producing reactive molecules that damage the outer membranes of oral bacteria and pry them off teeth. In a three-month clinical trial, participants using this toothbrush had much less dental plaque and gum inflammation compared to those using standard nylon brushes.



Lowest recorded temperature created on space station

Researchers onboard the China Space Station have made a breakthrough in quantum physics. Using specialised lasers to form an optical dipole trap, they created a Bose-Einstein condensate, an unusual state of matter, at just 9.7 picokelvins, or trillionths of a degree, above absolute zero – the lowest equivalent temperature ever recorded. The atomic cloud expanded so slowly that it remained visible for an unprecedented 7 s. The feat opens the door to highly sensitive experiments in space.



The ancient Mayans faced severe mercury poisoning

Severe mercury pollution devastated local ecosystems and threatened the health of the ancient Maya, per new research. Researchers analysed sediment cores from two lakes in the Yucatán Peninsula and found that during the Classic Period (250 to 920 AD), their mercury levels far exceeded modern safety limits. The extreme pollution likely stemmed from the Maya's widespread use of cinnabar and liquid mercury, which washed into the lakes, coinciding with a total collapse of the aquatic food web.

Question Corner

Buried secrets

Why do cats bury their food?
– Avni Karnatak

Cats bury their food and their poop for related but somewhat different reasons. They inherited both these habits from their wild ancestors, who developed them to conceal smells and avoid danger. Smaller cats are vulnerable to larger predators, and covering their leftovers could keep from giving away their presence. Some domestic cats even scratch at the floor around their food bowls when there is nothing they can use to bury the food. Likewise, cat faeces contain chemical signals that other animals can sense. They include fatty acids, such as acetic and butanoic acids, and sulphur-containing compounds such as 3-mercapto-3-methyl-1-butanol. Burying it is another defence mechanism – or they can leave it exposed to reveal their presence to other cats. Scientists have found that feral cats sometimes bury faeces in the central parts of their home ranges but leave them exposed near the edges.
Some scientists believe burying faeces may also help the cats maintain hygiene around their resting and feeding areas by keeping parasites away.

Readers may send their questions / answers to science@thehindu.co.in

Why is the use of voter IDs for welfare schemes contentious?

What did Panchayati Raj Minister Rajiv Ranjan Singh say? Have voter IDs been used before? What are the concerns?

Sobhana K. Nair

The story so far:

On November 3, Union Minister for Panchayati Raj Rajiv Ranjan Singh alias Lalan Singh announced that voter cards, along with biometric authentication, will replace Aadhaar as the basis for identifying beneficiaries and processing payments for welfare schemes. He argued that Aadhaar cards can be easily made at every street corner, implying that they can lead to fraudulent beneficiaries. He presented the use of voter cards along with biometric authentication as a possible mechanism to deal with such cases.

Are voter IDs used as identification documents to access welfare schemes?

In common Hindi parlance, the voter ID is often referred to as *pehchaan patra* (identity card). Like the ration card, it has often served as an entry document on the basis of which other entitlement documents are issued. For example, to obtain a job card under the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, voter IDs were among the documents that could be used.

In some States, such as Delhi, governments have made voter IDs compulsory for accessing certain pension schemes. A beneficiary requires endorsement from the local councillor or legislator to be enrolled under the pension programme.

The government has not clarified whether Singh's proposed identification formula will be extended to all welfare schemes

However, voter IDs have so far not been used exclusively as the identifying or verifying document for welfare delivery across the country. Beginning with Madhya Pradesh and Rajasthan, 10 States have also introduced 'family cards', recognising that many schemes are targeted not at individuals but at families or households.

What are the concerns about using voter IDs for accessing welfare programmes?

Opposition parties have linked this announcement to the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, in which more than 13 crore electors have been removed. They argue that disenfranchisement will now be coupled with exclusion from welfare programmes.

In West Bengal, Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari has already moved to restrict beneficiary lists to those whose names feature on the electoral rolls. On June 4, the West Bengal government issued an order through its Food and Supplies Department linking State-run welfare schemes, including Public Distribution System ration cards, to electoral rolls.

Nikhil Dey, founder member of the Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS), said the move is questionable in its intent. He says, "The government had introduced Aadhaar as the single solution to plug leaks from the public exchequer. Now it is saying Aadhaar is no longer enough. It can be argued that Aadhaar serves as a financial address, since it is linked to beneficiaries' bank accounts. What purpose does the voter ID serve?"

Mr. Dey argued that the measure would heighten insecurity and inject panic, given the mass disenfranchisement associated with the SIR process. He pointed out that 22 lakh people in West Bengal had appealed against the Election Commission of India's decision to remove them from the electoral rolls and of them, 21 lakh are still awaiting a decision from judicial tribunals, which are expected to take decades to clear the backlog. Outside West Bengal too, there are numerous examples of alleged illegal exclusion.

"Now exclusion will operate at two levels: first by taking away people's right to vote and then by taking away their access to welfare," he said.

What could the proposed change mean for welfare delivery?

In a post on X on November 6, following a push back from Opposition parties and to counter Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi's remarks on the issue, Mr. Singh asserted that no rightful beneficiary would be left out. He also indicated that the voter ID would be used along with Aadhaar, a distinction he had not made earlier.

The Panchayati Raj Ministry itself does not administer welfare schemes aimed directly at individual beneficiaries. Instead, it works through gram sabhas. The Sixteenth Finance Commission, for the award period 2026-31, has recommended grants totalling ₹4,35,236 crore for 2.55 lakh panchayats and traditional local bodies. The distribution of these funds falls directly within the Ministry's ambit.

As the arm of government that deals with gram sabhas, the Ministry indirectly influences the delivery of a range of rural welfare programmes. So far, however, the government has not clarified whether Mr. Singh's proposed identification formula will be extended to all welfare schemes.

Mr. Dey cautioned that the proposal should not be dismissed as an empty threat, citing the precedent set in West Bengal.

Why are the U.S. midterm elections significant?

What do the results tell us about American voters' attitudes towards President Donald Trump? What do they mean for Democrats and Republicans? What lies ahead for Democrats? Why are these results so important for the rest of the world?

Narayan Lakshman

The story so far:

Midterm elections in the U.S. earlier this week ended President Donald Trump's trifecta control of the federal government, as Democrats swept the polls and the Republican Party lost control of both the Senate and the House of Representatives.

The election result was particularly significant for Democrats as they won historically "red States" such as Texas, South Carolina, North Carolina, Iowa, Kansas, Ohio, and Maine, besides holding onto their traditional strongholds, such as Colorado, Oregon, and Illinois, and retaining control of key swing States, such as Georgia, Michigan, and Virginia.

Mr. Trump will now have to work with Democratic lawmakers on major policy issues including the economy and cost of living, immigration enforcement, and foreign policy, particularly the war in Iran and its impact on global oil prices.

Meanwhile, a Democrat-controlled Congress will challenge the policies and actions of the Trump White House, likely putting the brakes on numerous initiatives of the President over the remaining two years of his term.

How does this election boost the Democratic Party?

The loss of both houses of Congress implies that Mr. Trump will now have to strike deals with Democratic lawmakers to get his policies passed. Under the U.S. constitutional division of powers, Congress controls appropriations, has the authority to introduce and pass legislation, and can hold hearings and conduct investigations, including into federal agencies and private corporations that affect consumers. It also has the power to approve or reject nominations made by the President to government offices.

On the flip side for the Democrats, the President still holds the right to veto bills passed by Congress, and this limits the extent to which Congress can rewrite laws and regulations in areas such as immigration enforcement

On the flip side for the Democrats, the President still holds the right to veto bills passed by Congress, and this limits the extent to which Congress can rewrite laws and regulations in areas such as immigration enforcement. Despite their strong showing in the midterm elections, Democrats lack the two-thirds supermajority required to override the presidential veto.

The so-called "bluenami" also saw some new records set at the State level: Democrats won a Senate seat in Texas for the first time since 1988 after James Talarico ousted Republican Ken Paxton; in Texas, Gina Hinojosa is poised to become the first Latina Governor, defeating the high-profile, Trump-backed Republican incumbent, Greg Abbott; Democrat Abdul El-Sayed became the first Muslim Senator in history when he swept the Michigan race; Chris Pappas of New Hampshire made news as the first openly gay person to be elected to the Senate; and Senate Minority Leader Hakeem Jeffries will soon be the first African American Speaker of the House.



Democratic candidate Chris Pappas, seen with his partner Vann Bentley, celebrates his election to the Senate, in New Hampshire. REUTERS

What is the Republican position after the loss?

On the Republican side, the election results might have come as a shock even though Mr. Trump's job approval ratings were at an all-time low for his second term before the votes came in. On the one hand, Mr. Trump fumed that it was because his name was not on the ballot that the Republican cause collapsed, yet, ironically, for many voters the midterm election was in fact a referendum on the second Trump administration's performance in office.

If the President intends to do more than serve as a lame duck, by preserving his policy agenda in the hope of leaving a legacy of his political values after two more years of governance, he will have to build bridges and negotiate and compromise with Democrats in Congress. The signs are not good as he has, in the days following the election, appointed hardliner aide Stephen Miller as his Chief of Staff, a move that might portend a tightening White House posture on the Iran war and immigration issues.

Simultaneously, fractures may be appearing in the Republican firmament as Vice President J.D. Vance said on social media that the primary reason for the election loss was the Iran war.

Which issues has the election foregrounded?

Most analyses of the election outcome suggest that voters vented their frustration at soaring oil prices, specifically the price of gas at the pump. While Brent crude traded at around $70 per barrel prior to military action against Iran in late February 2026, it spiked past $110-$118 over the spring and summer of this year, only dropping below $100 after the midterm election results were in. Making matters worse, Mr. Trump's tariff regime also appears to have led to a setback to American households, whose costs rose sharply by $1,700 to $2,500 per year, as per the Joint Economic Committee of Congress.

Similarly, the widespread raids by Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) and deportation of ever-greater numbers of undocumented migrants led to protests across States and galvanised progressives around immigration reform. Matters reached a flash point when U.S. citizens Alex Pretti and Renée Good were killed by ICE agents on the streets of Minneapolis, Minnesota in January, and especially after Mr. Trump labelled Pretti an "insurrectionist" and "agitator".

What is the way forward for Democrats?

Democrats are celebrating their victory and planning a series of investigations into, and interrogations of, the functioning of the Trump White House, to introduce accountability into the functioning of a runaway Trump machine. Yet they might consider that overreaching – for example, by initiating fresh impeachment proceedings against Mr. Trump – may score political points but yield little in the way of more inclusive, equitable, and democratically accountable policies for the people. A potentially more rewarding way forward for congressional Democrats may be to engage with the White House to address the pain points arising from the policies of the past two years. These include health insurance policies in some States that have moved away from the principles of the Affordable Care Act, and the internecine trade war with neighbouring countries, in which tariffs have been weaponised.

How could the post-election scenario impact world politics?

The Democrat-controlled Congress could now set clear limits on U.S. involvement in conflicts abroad by curtailing military appropriations and refusing to certify war efforts that the White House may unilaterally embark upon, such as reckless nuclear adventurism with Iran. Similarly, through greater oversight of federal government agencies such as the Justice Department and ICE, the Senate and House could put pressure on enforcement policies involving the unlawful targeting of minorities, the inhumane treatment of migrants and asylum seekers, and the persecution of religious minorities seeking entry into the country.

In February 2026, despite being packed by Mr. Trump and his Republican predecessors with conservative justices, the U.S. Supreme Court upheld a lower court ruling that Mr. Trump lacks the authority to impose tariffs under the International Emergency Economic Powers Act. Now, a "blue" Congress may not be able directly impact tariffs as it does not have the supermajority required to override the presidential veto, yet it could exert pressure on the White House and force compromise on this matter by agreeing to other avenues of cooperation that the administration values.

What are the changes to the Agnipath scheme?

What has changed for Agniveers? Why has the government introduced these changes? What did the assessment of the Agnipath scheme after four years of implementation show? How will the changes benefit Agniveers and the armed forces?

Saurabh Trivedi

The story so far:

On November 4, in a major overhaul of the Agnipath scheme, the government announced that Agniveers set to exit the military at the end of their four-year tenure will be given an additional two-year extension. This will be followed by an opportunity to join the armed forces as regular soldiers. The decision was approved by the Cabinet on the recommendations of the three services.

Under the revised arrangement, the existing provision of enrolling 25% of Agniveers into the regular cadre after completion of their initial four-year tenure will remain unchanged. However, the remaining 75%, who were earlier required to leave the service after four years, will now be offered a second engagement period of two years. At the end of this extended tenure, they will also be considered for regular enrolment, subject to their willingness and meeting the objective selection criteria.

The government has also approved higher remuneration and an enhanced Seva Nidhi package (a one-time lump-sum financial benefit paid to Agniveers upon completing their four-year engagement) for those opting for the second engagement period. However, upon regular enrolment, they will be placed one rank below those inducted directly into the regular cadre after the initial four-year tenure under the 25% retention provision.

Based on evaluations and feedback from the services, the armed forces recommended an additional two-year engagement period for the 75% of Agniveers who were not selected for regular enrolment

Based on evaluations and feedback from the services, the armed forces recommended an additional two-year engagement period for the 75% of Agniveers who were not selected for regular enrolment. The recommendation, he said, had been under discussion for the past three or four months before receiving Cabinet approval.



A newly recruited Agniveer embraces family members during a passing-out parade, in Patna, on May 31, 2026. PTI

Why has the government changed the scheme?

The decision follows a comprehensive assessment of the Agnipath scheme after four years of implementation. Introduced on June 14, 2022, the scheme envisaged recruitment of young personnel for a four-year tenure, with up to 25% of each batch being retained in the regular cadre. The remaining 75% were to return to civilian life with a financial package and other benefits.

As the first batch of 18,000 Agniveers approaches the completion of its four-year tenure, the armed forces have undertaken a detailed evaluation of their performance, skills, physical fitness, motivation, and operational contribution. The assessment is aimed at determining whether the existing four-year engagement model adequately serves the organisational requirements of the three services and the aspirations of the recruits.

Chief of Defence Staff General N.S. Raja Subramani said the scheme was never intended to remain unchanged and that the armed forces had committed to periodically reviewing its implementation and the performance of Agniveers. According to him, a centralised database was maintained across the Army, Navy, and Air Force to track the performance of Agniveers, with annual assessments conducted against objective parameters. Based on these evaluations and feedback from the services, the armed forces recommended an additional two-year engagement period for the 75% who were not selected for regular enrolment. The recommendation, he said, had been under discussion for the past three or four months before receiving Cabinet approval.

What did the four-year assessment reveal?

The government's assessment identified several positive outcomes of the scheme, including recruitment from a wider range of districts across the country and a more standardised and transparent selection process. The armed forces reported high levels of physical fitness, morale, motivation, competitive spirit, and discipline among Agniveers. The technological adaptability, skill development, and educational qualifications of Agniveers were cited as important gains. Another significant outcome was the opening up of various branches of the armed forces to women.

The decision to provide an additional engagement period was aimed at making better use of this trained manpower. General Raja Subramani said the fact that an Agniveer was not selected among the initial 25% did not mean that the individual was unsuitable or had performed poorly. The selection was relative, based on the requirements and available vacancies in the organisation. The additional two years would allow these personnel to gain further experience, improve their skills, and demonstrate their suitability for regular service.

What does the second engagement period mean for Agniveers?

It provides a longer service opportunity to those who would otherwise have exited after four years. At the end of the six-year engagement, they will be considered for enrolment as regular soldiers provided they are willing and meet the criteria. Because all willing Agniveers now have a pathway to stay in the armed forces rather than exiting prematurely, they are no longer eligible for post-service reservation benefits in the Central Armed Police Forces or State Police forces that were previously announced.

What changes for the armed forces?

For the armed forces, the arrangement is expected to help retain personnel who have already undergone military training and acquired operational experience. It could also reduce the need for them to repeatedly invest in training new recruits to meet certain organisational requirements.

PROFILES

The progressive's progress

Abdul El-Sayed

The Michigan Senator-elect describes himself as 'just a capitalist who understands how capitalism works' and identifies as a progressive; his candidacy was backed by leading figures such as Bernie Sanders and Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez

Srinivasan Ramani

In a country where, for more than a quarter of a century, the word "Muslim" has been used as an accusation in politics, Abdul El-Sayed's election as the first Muslim member of the U.S. Senate breaks perhaps the thickest of glass ceilings in American public life. Dr. El-Sayed, a physician and epidemiologist, defeated the Republican former Congressman Mike Rogers with 52.5% of the vote, seven percentage points ahead of his rival.

It would be easy to dismiss this victory as merely a byproduct of the "blue wave" in the U.S. midterms, which carried Democratic candidates to wins even in Republican strongholds such as South Carolina, Texas, and Kansas. But that would be a reductive reading. The odds Dr. El-Sayed faced make the win remarkable in its own right.

As was the case in the Democratic primary, the money was stacked against him. According to OpenSecrets, which tracks Federal Election Commission data, outside groups spent $154.4 million attacking Dr. El-Sayed and another $51.1 million supporting Mr. Rogers over the 2025-26 election cycle, more than $205 million in all. Outside spending in Dr. El-Sayed's favour came to about $101 million: $44 million backing him and $57.1 million attacking Mr. Rogers. According to the media tracking firm AdImpact, $278 million was spent on television and digital advertising alone, making it the most expensive Senate race in Michigan's history and one of the costliest in the country this year.

The pro-Israel lobby, in particular, spent heavily against him. In the primary, the United Democracy Project, the super PAC directed by AIPAC, spent $30.6 million backing Haley Stevens, the Democratic establishment's candidate. According to Track AIPAC, a watchdog, the Israel lobby's support for Mr. Rogers came to $31.6 million. This was hardly surprising. Dr. El-Sayed has been outspoken on Israel, calling it a "rogue state" and an "ethno-state". He argued that it should not exist as an explicitly Jewish state, a position he had toned down by the closing stretches of the race. He has not wavered, however, on his pledge to end U.S. military aid to Israel, as well as to Saudi Arabia, Jordan and Egypt.

Other candidates on the party's left, New York Mayor Zohran Mamdani foremost among them, have been just as vocal in opposing Israel's actions in Gaza. That stance appears to have helped them at the polls as Democratic opinion has turned against Israel. A Pew survey published in April found that 80% of Democrats and Democratic-leaning independents viewed Israel unfavourably, up from 69% a year earlier and 53% in 2022.

Unlike Mr. Mamdani and others in the party who call themselves democratic socialists, Dr. El-Sayed describes himself as "just a capitalist who understands how capitalism works" and identifies as a progressive. Even so, his candidacy was backed by leading figures on the American left, including Senator Bernie Sanders and Representative Alexandria Ocasio-Cortez.

Reshaping health policy

Their support is easy to explain. As a public health specialist, he had "Medicare for All" as his campaign's key policy marker. This is a universal single-payer system in which one public insurer, funded through taxation, covers everyone, similar to Canada's Medicare. Senator Sanders championed the idea for decades before other Democrats, including several progressives now in the House and the Senate, took it up. Dr. El-Sayed has said he intends to use his Senate seat to shape Democratic health policy, both in Washington and in the 2028 presidential contest.

His slogan, "Money out of politics, money in your pocket, Medicare for All", also bound him to the democratic socialists. He refused corporate PAC donations and campaigned against the artificial intelligence data centres Big Tech is building across Michigan, which residents blame for rising electricity bills, heavy water use, and noise.

Analysts in the State credited his firm stance on the issue with clinching the primary. Mr. Rogers, too, later

ILLUSTRATION: R. RAJESH



called for a moratorium on new data centres. Dr. El-Sayed has also been a trenchant critic of President Donald Trump, of his anti-immigration policies, and of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE), which he has called for abolishing.

Dr. El-Sayed, who completed his DPhil in public health on a Rhodes scholarship at Oriel College, Oxford, took a medical degree from Columbia University, but went on to become an epidemiologist. At 30, he became Detroit city's health officer, then the youngest in any major American city, and helped rebuild the health department in a city that had gone bankrupt. He also took on corporations over refinery emissions and pollution issues during his tenure. He launched a bid for Governor in 2017 but lost the 2018 primary to Gretchen Whitmer, now the State's Governor, after winning only 30% of the vote. He was Wayne County's health director from 2023 to 2025 and further built his following through a public health podcast that he has hosted since 2019.

He ran a combative campaign in the Senate race. When Republicans and Mr. Trump attacked his faith, name and family, he mocked the attacks and retaliated by calling them out. Mr. Trump called him a "jihadist", derided him as "Abdul Ramadan" and used his middle name, Mohamed, as a taunt. Dr. El-Sayed brought every attack back to the issue of affordability. "My name is not the reason you can't afford gas. My name's not the reason you can't afford your groceries," he told a rally.

When a reporter asked him about his family's past in Egypt, which the Republicans had raked up to attack him, he retorted: "I was raised here in Michigan... and you want to ask me about what was happening in Egypt in the 1970s? Are you serious?"

On election night, after winning the race, he had the last word. "I know you struggled with my name," he told the President in his victory speech. "You can just go on and call me Senator." He then told Mr. Rogers to "enjoy your retirement... You chose hate. And Michigan chose hope."

Litmus test

Within the Democratic Party, though, Dr. El-Sayed faced a different kind of critique. Liberal commentators argued that insurgents like him, along with the democratic socialists, lacked broad appeal beyond urban Democratic strongholds, particularly in closely contested Rust Belt States such as Michigan, where pockets of urban Democratic support sit alongside large rural areas that have swung towards Mr. Trump. Centrist Democrats who had supported Ms. Stevens in the primary considered his left wing politics too risky in a swing State. The Senate race was seen as a litmus test of whether the progressive current could win beyond its strongholds.

In the final weeks of the Senate race, Ms. Stevens grew increasingly critical of Dr. El-Sayed's positions on Israel. On November 1, she withdrew her endorsement and backed Mr. Rogers, a move that drew condemnation across the Democratic Party.

In the end, none of it was enough to stop him. Dr. El-Sayed won comfortably in a State that helped send Mr. Trump to the White House in 2016 and again in 2024, a victory no less significant than the Democratic wins deep in Republican territory in Kansas, South Carolina and Texas. It also weakens the longstanding claim that single-payer health care is an electoral liability outside safe Democratic seats.

THE GIST

- The Democratic Senator-elect has been outspoken on Israel, calling it a 'rogue state' and an 'ethno-state', arguing that it should not exist as an explicitly Jewish state
- As a public health specialist, El-Sayed had 'Medicare for All' as his campaign's key policy marker
- His victory weakens the longstanding claim that single-payer health care is an electoral liability outside safe Democratic seats

Ambition without ambition

Jon Ossoff

While headlines scream Ossoff looks more presidential after his Senate win, he remains focused on his State while attacking Donald Trump and his family

G.R. Rajeev

There is something of an investigative journalist in Jon Ossoff, who served as managing director and chief executive officer of Insight: The World Investigates, a London-based investigative television production company. During his Senate campaign as Democratic candidate in Georgia and even before, he had been mounting a blistering campaign against corruption. It resonated with the voters struggling with rising food prices and unaffordable fuel.

Mr. Ossoff won the November 3 election against Republican Mike Collins, becoming the only incumbent Senate Democrat to defend a seat in a State President Donald Trump carried in 2024. Ever since his win in the 2021 Senate race in Georgia, the charismatic Mr. Ossoff has been making the lists of possible candidates for the Democratic ticket in the 2028 Presidential election. But, like Barack Obama before his 2004 Senate win and scores of others before him, Mr. Ossoff, now 39, who in 2021 became the youngest U.S. Senator since 1980, has been vehemently denying any such aspiration. The media, however, has been quick in spotting in him similarities with Mr. Obama.

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR



While headlines scream Mr. Ossoff looks more presidential after his Senate win, he remains focused on his State while attacking Mr. Trump and his family. He helped popularise the term "Epstein class" to describe them on social media. "I have zero interest in running for president in 2028. I love serving the State of Georgia," Mr. Ossoff told MS Now in April. He reiterated his "zero interest" in a Senate debate early in October.

Different path

While others on the "presidential list" have been preparing policy agenda and striving for visibility, Mr. Ossoff has been targeting Mr. Trump and hitting the right notes with a war-weary Georgia electorate. "His ties to GOP [Grand Old Party] officials and reputation for constituent service gave him crossover appeal. Several Republican mayors and local leaders endorsed his reelection, complicating Collins' efforts to paint him as a 'radical Democrat'," the *Atlanta Journal-Constitution* wrote after his stupendous win.

"A wave is building. The kind that comes once a generation, when people have been pushed too far, and they decide all at once and all together that enough is enough," Mr. Ossoff said at a campaign speech months ahead of the "Blunami" that lashed as comeuppance for Mr. Trump and the Republican Party. Since returning to the White House, according to news reports, Mr. Trump has made more than $1 billion from his family's cryptocurrency businesses alone. Mr. Ossoff was prescient.

In the senate, Mr. Ossoff introduced legislation to prohibit members of Congress and their spouses from trading stocks in public companies. He has been vocal in his protest against Israel's bloodlust even in the early days of conflict in Gaza, and there was fear that the Jewish votes may turn against him. Nearly 50 Jewish groups and synagogues signed a letter against Mr. Ossoff and Senator Raphael Warnock, also from Georgia, for their Senate votes to block transfer of certain weapons to Israel. "The Jewish community is not a monolith," Mr. Ossoff later said. "These are complex national security and foreign policy issues, and the breadth of Jewish American public opinion reflects that."

"My father is the grandson of Jewish immigrants from Lithuania and Russia who arrived in the U.S. in the early 20th century, with nothing. My mother is an Australian immigrant, who is not Jewish, so prior to my bar mitzvah I entered the mikvah to make it official. I was raised in a Jewish household, went to the Temple, which is a Reform synagogue here in Atlanta, and was bar mitzvah'd and shortly thereafter made my first trip to Israel," he said in an interview with the *Moment* magazine in 2017.

In a Democratic field full of young progressive aspirants for the Presidential ticket, Mr. Ossoff appears to be more pragmatic, keeping his cards close to the chest and tending to his constituency rather than be perceived as an overly ideological figure.

The urban planner

Nithya Raman

Before entering U.S. politics, L.A.'s first South Asian Mayor-elect worked among the urban poor in Chennai, where she used data to expose gaps in slum resettlement and public facilities

Joan Sony Cherian

After defeating Karen Bass, the incumbent Mayor of the second most populous city of the U.S., Nithya Raman wrote on X, "Los Angeles, I am deeply honored to be your next mayor." A member of the city council since 2020, Ms. Raman has a track record of civic activism, advocating for affordable and increased housing. Entering the electoral race at the very last minute, she is now L.A.'s the first South Asian Mayor-elect as well as the first candidate to defeat an incumbent Mayor of the city since 2005.

Born in Keralam, Ms. Raman spent a part of her early childhood between Thiruvananthapuram and Thrissur. Her father, Venkataraman, used to work for Keltron, and her mother, Sudha, was a former employee of the Indian Overseas Bank. The family migrated to the U.S. when Ms. Raman was six. She graduated from Harvard University in 2003, and then got a master's degree in urban planning from MIT. She became a U.S. citizen at 22. Post her studies, Ms. Raman spent a few years in India working among the urban poor. In Delhi, she worked with organisations which focused on slum settlements. Her work then took her to

ILLUSTRATION: SREEJITH R. KUMAR



Chennai, where she led Transparent Chennai, in which she and her team would map slum resettlement colonies and the state of public facilities. Using data evidence, she exposed the gap between government programmes and grassroots reality.

Her experience in urban planning and data-driven programmes hugely influenced her later work in the U.S as a city councillor. She would use similar methods to advocate for affordable and increased housing, to end homelessness and to make Los Angeles more walkable. Data released by the Los Angeles Homeless Services Authority stated that street homelessness in the district that Ms. Raman represented went down by 49% while city-wise it went up by 8%.

Ms. Raman is a member of the Democratic Socialists of America (DSA), a political advocacy platform which believes in democratic socialism. With her election as Mayor, she will be joining the ranks of Zohran Mamdani, Mayor of New York City, and Janeese Lewis George and David Morales, Mayor-elects of Washington DC, Providence, R.I., respectively, who are all DSA members. However, Ms. Raman stands out among them as her ties with the group have often been strained.

Complex relationship

Ms. Raman won a city council position through a DSA endorsement in 2020 but has since then had major disagreements with the organisation, particularly on issues related to the genocide in Gaza and the Mansion tax. The former flared up right after her entry into the mayoral race. The DSA did not endorse her in the primary and extended support only after she defeated the Republican nominee to enter into the run-offs with Ms. Bass. Even after the endorsement, the DSA had a re-vote to confirm/rescind the endorsement as some members claimed that Ms. Raman did not make her views on the BDS (Boycott, Divest and Sanctions) movement against Israel clear and that she had in 2024 accepted support from a pro-Israel group. The re-vote narrowly passed in Ms. Raman's favour.

The second issue relates to the Mansion tax, which is an additional tax imposed on the sale of high-value properties in Los Angeles, the proceeds of which would go to housing programmes. However, after assuming office, Ms. Raman proposed a reform of the tax as evidence emerged that the revenue generated from it was far less than what was projected. This again angered DSA members.

Talking to *Vanity Fair*, Ms. Raman remarked that "I did not join the DSA because I had a deep ideological drive, but I do really care about issues and they were the only political organisation in LA talking about renters' rights". Ms. Raman might have found overlap with several issues she and the DSA believe in, but she considers herself politically independent which enables her to look at policies on their own merit, rather than within a larger ideological framework.

WASHINGTON

Trump appoints Stephen Miller as Chief of Staff after midterms rout



AP

U.S. President Donald Trump on Friday named Stephen Miller, architect of his hardline immigration policy, as his new Chief of Staff, after Republicans were hammered in the midterms. Mr. Miller will replace Susie Wiles, who becomes the first major White House casualty from the Democratic landslide earlier this week. AFP

GAZA CITY

Heavy rain inundates shelters for people displaced by war in Gaza



AP

Heavy rain on Saturday flooded tens of thousands of displaced people's tents in war-devastated Gaza, Palestinian authorities said. In a statement, the Hamas-run government media office said that about "70,000 tents were flooded on the first day" of rains, with civil society groups pointing to the risk of spread of diseases. AFP

WASHINGTON

U.S. offers reward for information about Iranian nuclear programme



AP

The U.S. military said on Friday that Washington was offering a $20 million reward "and possible relocation" for information about Iran's nuclear programme. Iran's lack of compliance with the International Atomic Energy Agency has led to the agency's loss of 'continuity of knowledge' on the matter, the State Department said. AFP

WASHINGTON

China confirms discussions under way on Xi-Trump-Putin meeting



AP

Beijing has confirmed for the first time that it is discussing a historic meeting between Chinese leader Xi Jinping, U.S. President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin. China "is in communication with relevant parties regarding a meeting between the three heads of state," a Chinese Foreign Ministry said. AP

U.S. strikes island in Hormuz as Iran says 'its forces have grown stronger'

Friday's strikes are the first since Trump's Republican Party was dealt a stunning rejection in the U.S. midterm elections; Washington says it targeted an air defence system on Qeshm island; Iran Guards lift limit on long-range ballistic missiles

Associated Press
WASHINGTON

President Donald Trump said the U.S. military on Friday carried out limited strikes on Iran's Qeshm island in the Strait of Hormuz, targeting an Iranian air defence system, as Iran said its military has grown "stronger" since the outset of its war with the U.S.

Friday's strikes are the first since Mr. Trump's Republican Party was dealt a stunning repudiation in the U.S. midterm elections.

"They built a little bit of an anti-aircraft device and we knocked it out in about 15 minutes, maybe five," Mr. Trump said.



Water wars: Iran's military reported on Saturday that a tanker in the Strait of Hormuz caught fire after striking a naval mine. REUTERS

On Saturday, Iran's Tasnim news agency reported that two missiles had struck the island. The Iranian Army said that its air defences had "struck and destroyed" a U.S. drone flying over the island.

Meanwhile, Iranian Foreign Minister Abbas Araghchi said on Instagram on Saturday that over the past 48 hours he held phone calls with Ministers from 12 countries.

U.S. President Donald Trump called Qatari Emir Sheikh Tamim bin Hamad Al Thani on Friday to discuss efforts to end the war.

Tanker hit in Hormuz

On Saturday, Iranian Army said that a tanker in the Strait of Hormuz "caught fire and came to a halt after striking a naval mine". The U.S. had recently said all mines had been cleared from the waterway.

Tehran has fortified its grip on the strait, which normally carries about one-fifth of global oil consumption.

Iranian Army spokesman Mohammad Akraminia said the forces "are on higher alert and are stronger than they were at the beginning of the war". "They now possess greater motivation, commitment and self-confidence," he added, state news agency IRNA reported on Saturday.

The Revolutionary Guards (IRGC) have lifted a self-imposed limit of 2,000 kilometres on the range of its ballistic missiles, suggesting the country may seek to develop missiles capable of reaching more distant targets. IRGC spokesman Hossein Mohebbi told Fars news agency on Saturday that "the increase in the range of Iran's missiles continues steadily". "There is no pause in this regard."

(With inputs from AFP)

Paraguay President removed from office over bank scandal

Associated Press
ASUNCION

Ousted Paraguayan President Santiago Pena was placed under house arrest on Friday on suspicion of breach of trust and influence peddling, among other charges, after the Senate removed him from office over the collapse of Ueno, a government-linked bank, which left millions of customers unable to access their accounts.

Vice-President Pedro Alliana was sworn in as President to serve out the term, which ends in August 2028.

Mr. Pena was ordered to remain at one of his homes in Asuncion until he appears before prosecutors on Saturday. Lawmakers accuse him of using his political influence to steer hundreds of millions of dollars in public funds into Ueno while regulators overlooked risky insider lending. Mr. Pena has denied wrongdoing.



Taking stock: Vice-President Pedro Alliana was sworn in as the new President following Santiago Pena's impeachment. REUTERS

Payouts begin

When regulators seized Ueno Bank on November 3, its customers could no longer withdraw cash, or use their cards or digital app to buy anything.

Some depositors began recovering their money from November 5.

Advance payments to impacted depositors began on Thursday afternoon, Jose Maciel of the Central Bank's Deposit Guarantee Fund said.

The first phase concerns clients with deposits of up to around $1,600, without loans and with an account at another bank in Paraguay, the official said.

Six people dead after gunman opens fire in Polish city; one held

Agence France-Presse
KRAKOW

Poland's police said on Saturday that six people had been killed and a dozen wounded after a gunman opened fire in the city of Krakow.

The man – a Polish citizen – drove a car onto Krakow's Main Market Square and began shooting at random people, said police. Officers shot the suspect who is now in custody, they added.

"The death toll now stands at six: four women and two men," the police said on X. A dozen others were wounded.

The police added that the man had been clad in military fatigues at the moment of the attack and was armed with a long gun.

In his car, "police officers discovered other firearms and a large quantity of ammunition", Krakow police spokeswoman Katarzyna Cislo said.

The police did not say what the motive was.

Prime Minister Donald Tusk called the attack "a tragic shooting".

"Our highest praise goes to the heroic police officers who risked their lives in the line of duty," Mr. Tusk said.

President Karol Nawrocki said his thoughts were with the victims, the wounded and their families.

Russia has intensified strikes to pressure us during talks: Ukraine

Agence France-Presse
KYIV

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy on Saturday accused Russia of intensifying strikes across the country to put pressure on Kyiv at upcoming talks after an overnight barrage triggered power cuts as temperatures drop.

At least nine people were wounded, he added.

The strikes on Ukraine's energy infrastructure came days before the trilateral U.S.-brokered meeting in Abu Dhabi scheduled for November 10.

Ukraine's Energy Ministry said "a massive attack on a number of energy facilities" had plunged five regions – Dnipropetrovsk, Donetsk, Kyiv, Zhytomyr and Kharkiv – into darkness and significantly hampered electricity transmission in Kyiv and surrounding region.

"By intensifying its attacks on Ukraine and our infrastructure at this very moment, Russia is trying to additionally lay the groundwork for putting pressure on Ukraine's position and that of its partners," Mr. Zelenskyy said.

He also said Russia had throughout the night launched 172 drones and 36 ballistic missiles, among which, according to him, were KN-23 missiles manufactured and supplied by North Korea.

25 killed, dozens wounded in Saudi strikes near Yemen's Sanaa: Houthis

Associated Press
CAIRO

Yemen's Houthi-run Health Ministry said on Saturday that air strikes hit homes in al-Shariya, a village near Yemen's capital, Sanaa, killing at least 25 people and wounding 30, mostly women and children. A spokesperson for the Ministry, Anees Alasbahi, accused Saudi Arabia of carrying out the strikes.

Footage from Houthi-run Al-Masirah TV of the aftermath of Saturday's strikes showed staff carrying limp bodies of multiple young children out of ambulances at a local hospital.

Mr. Alasbahi told Al-Masirah at least 25 people were killed, up from a toll of 22 he had announced earlier. He told the channel that civilians were still buried under the rubble of houses hit in the strikes, and that subsequent strikes targeted emergency workers as they tried to pull survivors out of the wreckage.



Dire straits: A girl injured in an air strike receives treatment at a hospital in Houthi-controlled Sanaa, Yemen, on Saturday. AP

'Safe transit via email'

The *Wall Street Journal* reported on Friday that Houthis are policing maritime transit of the Red Sea through a system under which vessels can request safe passage via email.

After the group declared a maritime blockade of Saudi Arabia earlier this year, some ships began contacting them before transiting the Red Sea, the *Journal* reported.

If the Houthis reply, they typically do so within 24 hours, the newspaper said, citing crew member accounts and emails it reviewed.

The *Journal* included one email in which the Houthis responded to a request from a Chinese ship: "We hope you are keeping well. We are glad that you understood the criteria for the scope of the vessels ban," they said.

(With inputs from AFP)

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01	16 04.11.2026	2026_UAD _547826_1	नगर के डिवाइडर मरम्मत, नवीन निर्माण एवं 02 वर्ष अवधि के लिए सौंदर्यीकरण एवं संधारण कार्य निगम क्षेत्रान्तर्गत।	3,80,35,776/-	3,80,400/-	15,000/-	24 माह

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कार्यपालन यंत्री
नगर पालिक निगम, सतना (म.प्र.), सतना, दिनांक 04.11.2026

स्वच्छ सतना - लक्ष्य अपना

NORTH EASTERN RAILWAY

Tender Notice

Online open E-tender are invited by Senior Divisional Electrical Engineer (TRS)/ N. E. Railway/ Loco Shed Gonda acting for and on behalf of the President of India for the following work.

Tender Notice No. & Description - **1.** Tender No.:- LS-GD-2026-Ovh-Compressor, "Overhauling of Main compressors of Electric locomotive for 2 years (2026)" Estimated Cost (in Rs.) :- 52,33,149.30, Period of Completion :- 24 months, Earnest Money (in Rs.) :- 1,04,700.00, • Offers can be uploaded by tenderer, up to 12:00 Hrs. on 26/11/2026. • Detailed information, minimum eligibility criteria, Terms and conditions regarding this e-tender are available at website **www.ireps.gov.in** • Tenderer should check any correction/corrigendum related to this e-tender notice on website before uploading their offer.

Note:- 1. Manual offers are not allowed against there tenders and any such manual offer received, shall be ignored. 2. For full details and submission of bid, Kindly visit the official website of Indian Railways i.e. **http://www.ireps.gov.in**

ADEE/TRS, N. E. Railway/Loco Shed Gonda
CPRO/EL - 255
"Never travel on roof and foot boards"

Government of Karnataka
DEPARTMENT OF MINES & GEOLOGY
Office of the Director, No. 49, Khanija Bhavan, South Block,
Race Course Road, Bengaluru-560 001 Phone No:22384134/35

No. DMG-17012/26/2025/2026-27 Dated: 05.11.2026

NOTICE INVITING TENDER

The Department of Mines and Geology is calling tender for auction of Seized iron ore at Karnakata state mineral corporation limited. Mining lease no 2629 under notification through MSTC.

Eligibility conditions, terms and conditions, date and time for participating in the electronic auction are provided in the Tender Document. Separate Lot wise auction notifications are published in MSTC portal. Tender Documents, notifications, updates and other details for the e-auction process of respective lots shall be available in electronic form only at the website of MSTC Ltd. **https://www.mstcecommerce.com/auctionhome/aucsearch/search.jsp**

The auction of Iron ore for each lot is "AS IS WHERE IS AND NO COMPLAINT BASIS". The interested bidders shall ascertain the quantity and quality of the Iron ore before participation. The Department is not responsible for any dispute arising after confirmation of the bid. Interested bidders may visit the MSTC Ltd website.

Sd/-
Director,
Department of Mines & Geology

DIPR/CP/3595/NR/2026-27

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A GENIUS

'No one presented the seam better than Shami in world cricket'



FILE PHOTO: GETTY IMAGES

I was lucky that I was the coach at that time. Without him the fast bowling unit would not have functioned. No one presented the seam better than him in world cricket. Sad to see him go. I definitely thought he had another 30-40 wickets left in him. He should've played in the last 12 months — Ravi Shastri on Mohammed Shami.

HIGH PRAISE

Shami defined an era of Indian pace bowling: BCCI's accolade



FILE PHOTO: GETTY IMAGES

The BCCI on Saturday paid a glowing tribute to Mohammed Shami, saying the wily India pacer defined an era of pace bowling in Test cricket. Shami ended his Test journey with 229 wickets from 64 matches. "Thank you for defining an era of Indian pace bowling, Test Cap #279," posted the BCCI on social media.

RELIEVED SKIPPER

Happy we got there in the end on a challenging pitch, says Gill



CREIMAS/BCCI

As long as we get the win (it's fine). It wasn't easy to bat. Getting them out for 134, I thought it'll be an easy target, but it wasn't. Happy we got there in the end. The pitch was challenging but we lost two extra wickets than we'd have liked in the end — Shubman Gill after K.L. Rahul, *in pic,* ensured India was ahead on DLS.

COMMENDABLE SHOW

East Bengal makes history in AFC Women's Champions League



PTI

East Bengal FC became the first Indian team to reach the AFC Women's Champions League knockout stage, securing a quarterfinal berth despite a 0-2 loss to North Korea's April 25 SC in its final Group B match in Kolkata on Saturday. **The result:** East Bengal 0 lost to April 25 SC 2 (Han Jin-Hong 2, Oh Sol-Song 43).



Distinguished career: Shami was a key component of the Indian pace attack for the better part of his Test journey. FILE PHOTO

End of an era as Shami exits Tests

TRIBUTE

K.C. Vijaya Kumar

Cricketing mornings redolent with the smell of cut grass and a wisp of petrichor from last night's rain may be the ideal ally for the fast merchants. Yet, the bigger challenge is to run in hard under the afternoon sun and test the batter's technique.

Mohammed Shami was a speedster, who could do both: excel in the morning and equally decimate batting orders in the post-lunch session. The seam position would be immaculate, and his energy boundless. Shami belongs to the pantheon of great Indian pacers, headlined by Kapil Dev, Jasprit Bumrah, Javagal Srinath and Zaheer Khan, for the sheer impact he had on games. When he retired from Tests late on Friday night, Indian cricket, despite having moved on from him, will be poorer.

Shami's 229 wickets from 64 Tests, could have been more if injuries hadn't affected his career. In terms of potential he could have bagged 300 scalps but when he called quits at 36, his final Test yield stands fifth among Indian fast bowlers with Kapil, the persevering Ishant Sharma, Zaheer and Srinath ahead of him.

Bumrah will go past Shami soon, but with the latter's exit, a specific era in Indian pace bowling history has wound to a close. Bumrah remains the link while Mohammed Siraj is expected to nurse the flame.

Hailing from Uttar Pradesh but finding success as a spearhead with Bengal, Shami made his India Test debut fittingly at Eden Gardens, his home ground, against the West Indies in 2013. Rohit Sharma too made his maiden appearance in the longest format with Shami, scoring a 177. All from that playing XI, ranging from the great Sachin Tendulkar to Pragyan Ojha, now the current chief selector, have moved into their post-Test phase even as Rohit and Virat Kohli turn out in ODIs.



Shami. FILE PHOTO

For three years, Shami tried to wing his way back into the Indian Test unit. Having recovered from an injury, he strove hard for Bengal. The selectors were still not convinced about him lasting the rigours of five days in Tests, and when he missed the bus for the current New Zealand tour, Shami turned pragmatic.

In his departure, Indian cricket has lost an excellent pacer. Even as he keeps his hopes afloat in white-ball cricket, there is a silent grief in not seeing him in Test whites, clattering stumps, and doing that half-nod, half-smile gesture.



Truly memorable: Shami followed up his fifty with an early wicket as India scored a thrilling victory in the 2021 Lord's Test. FILE PHOTO

India prevails in a low-scoring thriller

Rahul's unbeaten 26 takes the visitor ahead by four runs on DLS method before the heavens open up; Gurnoor's spell shoots out the Kiwis for 134

INDIA IN NZ

Press Trust of India
WELLINGTON

India's star-studded batting line-up suffered a real scare before K.L. Rahul ensured a young fast bowling unit's superb show did not go waste as the visitor clinched a hard-fought four-run win over New Zealand on DLS method in a rain-affected low-scoring second ODI here on Saturday.

Chasing 135 in 47 overs, India was struggling at 113 for seven in 26 overs when the heavens opened up with Rahul unbeaten on 26 (38b, 2x4, 2x6). The DLS par-score at the time was 109 before the match was called off, giving the Men in Blue an important win.

India leads the five-match series 2-0 with the third match scheduled in Hamilton on Tuesday.

The strapping Gurnoor Brar, who recorded career-best figures of four for 30, was complemented well by Auqib Nabi (two for 31) and Anshul Kamboj (two for 25) as the pace trio decimated the Kiwis for 134 in just 41 overs.

With the pitch aiding bounce and movement, the chase became tougher than expected. Skipper Shubman Gill was caught in the slip cordon off the very first ball he faced from Jacob Duffy for a duck. Duffy then claimed his second wicket as he got Virat Kohli (seven) to drive one uppishly to short cover.

Rohit Sharma (23, 28b, 2x4, 2x6) tried an expansive drive to be caught at slip off Kyle Jamieson.

Axar Patel (seven) played a false ramp shot while Shreyas Iyer (30, 46b, 4x4, 1x6), after doing all the hard work, fell to the short ball again.

With scoreboard pressure not being there, Rahul soaked in the pressure. He hit Duffy for a six to get his team past the 100-run mark, but the quick wickets of Naman Dhir (12) and Kamboj (one) pushed India on the back foot before rain dashed the hopes of the Kiwis.

Earlier, Gurnoor used the short-ball tactic to perfection, cutting through the middle-order as the home team slumped to 53 for five at the end of 20 overs. Daryl Mitchell (55, 104b, 5x4, 2x6), who was dropped by Gill on 21, and skipper Mitchell Santner (31, 38b, 1x4, 2x6) added 59 for the sixth wicket.

Axar (two for 28) accounted for Mitchell and the host lost its last five wickets for the addition of just 22 runs.



Crucial strike: Gurnoor is delighted to end Santner's resistance. CREIMAS/BCCI

SCOREBOARD

NEW ZEALAND
Will Young c Rahul b Nabi 6 *(17b, 1x4)*, Tim Seifert c Kamboj b Nabi 0 *(5b)*, Henry Nicholls b Kamboj 11 *(26b, 1x4)*, Daryl Mitchell c Kamboj b Axar 55 *(104b, 5x4, 2x6)*, Tom Latham c Dhir b Gurnoor 7 *(22b)*, Glenn Phillips c Kamboj b Gurnoor 0 *(4b)*, Mitchell Santner c Rahul b Gurnoor 31 *(38b, 1x4, 2x6)*, Nathan Smith c Rohit b Gurnoor 3 (9b), Kyle Jamieson b Axar 7 *(14b, 1x4)*, Blair Tickner b Kamboj 2 *(5b)*, Jacob Duffy (not out) 1 *(3b)*; Extras (b-2, lb-2, nb-1, w-6): 11; Total (in 41 overs): 134.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-0 (Seifert, 1.5 overs), 2-11 (Young, 5.4), 3-23 (Nicholls, 8.4), 4-53 (Latham, 19.2), 5-53 (Phillips, 19.6), 6-112 (Mitchell, 34.6), 7-119 (Santner, 35.5), 8-127 (Jamieson, 38.2), 9-132 (Smith, 39.5).

INDIA BOWLING
Arshdeep 7-1-16-0, Nabi 7-0-31-2, Kamboj 8-0-25-2, Gurnoor 10-2-30-4, Axar 9-1-28-2.

INDIA
Rohit Sharma c Nicholls b Jamieson 23 *(28b, 2x4, 2x6)*, Shubman Gill c Nicholls b Duffy 0 *(1b)*, Virat Kohli c Young b Duffy 7 *(7b, 1x4)*, Shreyas Iyer c Latham b Jamieson 30 *(46b, 4x4, 1x6)*, Axar Patel c Duffy b Fisher 7 *(17b, 1x4)*, K.L. Rahul (not out) 26 *(38b, 2x4, 2x6)*, Naman Dhir c Seifert b Duffy 12 *(16b, 2x4)*, Anshul Kamboj c Duffy b Jamieson 1 *(3b)*, Auqib Nabi (not out) 1 *(1b)*; Extras (lb-1, nb-1, w-4): 6; Total (for seven wkts. in 26 overs): 113.

FALL OF WICKETS
1-4 (Gill, 1.1), 2-17 (Kohli, 3.4), 3-39 (Rohit, 8.4), 4-47 (Axar, 12.5), 5-86 (Shreyas, 19.6), 6-108 (Dhir, 24.4), 7-111 (Kamboj, 25.3).

NEW ZEALAND BOWLING
Jamieson 10-1-35-3, Duffy 7-1-35-3, Smith 5-1-19-0, Fisher 4-0-23-1.

Toss: India.

Player-of-the-Match: Gurnoor Brar.

India won by four runs (DLS Method) to lead the five-match series 2-0.

Third ODI
November 10, Hamilton, 7.30 a.m. IST.

Chennaiyin notches up first win in style

ISL

K. Keerthivasan
CHENNAI

It was a transformed Chennaiyin FC that turned up at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium here on Saturday.

Playing a brand of football it rarely displayed in its previous four matches, the host served up a pre-Deepavali treat to its fans with an impressive 5-3 win – its first of the season – over East Bengal FC in the Indian Super League.

Braces from Brison Fernandes and Irfan Yadwad, along with a penalty converted by Ramon Tanque, completed a dominant performance by home side.

Chennaiyin launched attacks from both flanks and through the centre, creating several chances.

Brison drew first blood after a fine pass from the right by Irfan. Unmarked, he fired a powerful right-footed shot past goalkeeper Prabhsukhan Gill. He then made it 2-0 with a strong strike from outside the box.

East Bengal struggled to break through Chennaiyin's defence but reduced the margin through Ake Loba, who scored from close range after Daniel Ramirez dispossessed Ayush Dev and set him up.



Irfan. X@CHENNAIYINFC

Brison was in the thick of things again when Jeakson Singh brought him down inside the box. Ramon converted the resulting penalty.

A handball by Chennaiyin's Muhammed Saheef early in the second half gifted East Bengal a penalty and Ramirez made no mistake. The visitor then showed greater purpose, attacking down the flanks.

However, Chennaiyin reasserted its supremacy when substitute Lalhriatpuia's fierce shot was deflected into the net by Irfan. Soon the latter added his second with a fine finish after a through pass from Ramon.

The results: Chennaiyin FC 5 (Brison Fernandes 4, 18, Ramon Tanque 41-pen, Irfan Yadwad 59, 67) bt East Bengal FC 3 (Ake Loba 29, Daniel Ramirez 47-pen, David Hmar 90+1).

At Pune: Inter Kashi 0 lost to SC Delhi 3 (Carlos Fortes 6, Juan Pena 74, Rodriguinho 88).

Bayern and Dortmund stay level

EURO LEAGUES

Agence France-Presse
MUNICH

Bayern Munich and Borussia Dortmund posted identical 2-1 wins on Saturday to be tied on 21 points at the top of the Bundesliga with the former ahead on goal difference. While Bayern got the better of Mainz, Dortmund got the better of Elversberg.

The results: Premier League: Leeds 1 (Okafor 79) bt Tottenham 0; Arsenal 1 (Odegaard 72) bt Hull City 0; Fulham 1 (Muniz 83) drew with Newcastle United 1 (Murphy 80).

Bundesliga: Borussia Dortmund 2 (Nmecha 55, 71) bt Elversberg 1 (Futkeu 81); RB Leipzig 5 (Banzuzi 33, Nkunku 35, Raum 45+1, Romulo 60, Baumgartner 66) bt Augsburg 2 (Kade 1, Ogundu 90+2); Mainz 1 (Tietz 90+2) lost to Bayern Munich 2 (Kimmich 14, Karl 57); Paderborn 2 (Obermair 45, Pieringer 73-pen) drew with Eintracht Frankfurt 2 (Burkardt 23, 90+3).

On Friday: Premier League: Everton 3 (Barry 56, 61, Dewsbury-Hall 81) bt Coventry 1 (Gboho 52).

LaLiga: Sevilla 0 drew with Alaves 0.

Bundesliga: Hamburg 3 (Muheim 11, Nandja 59, Gronbaek 70) bt Borussia M'Gladbach 1 (Hack 44).

Serie A: Venezia 2 (Basic 54, Perez 65) bt Udinese 1 (Moreno 57-og).

Vaishnavi and Rutuja cause a flutter, storm into the final

WTA CHENNAI OPEN

Nihit Sachdeva
CHENNAI

Vaishnavi Adkar and Rutuja Bhosale became the first-ever all-Indian pair to reach a Tour-level final as they took down the second-seeded Polish-American duo of Weronika Falkowska and Alana Smith 6-2, 2-6, [10-8] at the WTA 250 Chennai Open on Saturday.

Cheered on by 500-odd spectators on centre court at the SDAT Stadium, the Indian duo got off to a quick start as they broke Smith's serve to love for a 2-1 lead. The advantage increased to 4-1 when Rutuja hit a forehand return right at Falkowska's feet to get the double-break. World No. 128 Rutuja held to love and secured the opener soon.

However, from 2-2 in the second essay, there was a sudden dip in the Indian pair's level. The 21-year-old Vaishnavi served consecutive double-faults and handed the break to the opponents in the sixth game. Down 2-5, the Indians were forced to use a medical timeout as Vaishnavi faced a left hip issue. The Falkowska-Smith duo broke Rutuja immediately after resumption to clinch the second set.



Two to tango: Vaishnavi and Rutuja raised their level to oust the second-seeded duo of Falkowska and Smith. R. RAGU

The Polish-American pair led 8-6 in the super tie-break before an inside-out forehand from Rutuja and Vaishnavi's overhead smash restored parity. Down match-point, Smith let a forehand down the line from Vaishnavi pass only to watch it land in.

"It's an incredible feeling to reach the final on home soil, doing it with someone I really enjoy playing with. We had no idea we were the first Indian pair (to reach a Tour-level final). It's something that I will always remember," said the 30-year-old Rutuja.

"It's the last Tour-level event in India. So, I'm really glad that we could make the best out of it," said Vaishnavi.

In singles, Magda Linette, the 2022 runner-up, returned to the final with a 2-6, 6-2, 6-3 win over Anastasia Zakharova. Linette, the 34-year-old Pole, will face defending champion Janice Tjen, who beat USA's Robin Montgomery 6-3, 6-4, for the title.

The results (semifinals):
Singles: Janice Tjen (Ina) bt Robin Montgomery (USA) 6-3, 6-4; Magda Linette (Pol) bt Anastasia Zakharova (Rus) 2-6, 6-2, 6-3.

Doubles: Vaishnavi Adkar & Rutuja Bhosale bt Weronika Falkowska (Pol) & Alana Smith (USA) 6-2, 2-6, [10-8]; Naima Karamoko & Simona Waltert (Sui) bt Isabelle Haverlag (Ned) & Panna Udvardy (Hun) 6-4, 6-4.

INBRIEF



FILE PHOTO: K.V.S. GIRI

Baroda star Hardik to miss SMAT as injury delays return

Hardik Pandya's absence from competitive cricket will continue, with the all-rounder missing from Baroda's 15-member squad for the upcoming Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy T20 tournament. His brother Krunal Pandya has been named captain of the side. Hardik last featured in competitive cricket on May 24 in the IPL. The all-rounder was initially included in India-A's one-day squad for the October series against Australia-A but had to withdraw after suffering a fresh shin injury.

Velavan loses in quarterfinals of London Open squash

India's Velavan Senthilkumar bowed out of the London Open squash after losing to France's World No. 99 Amir Khaled-Jousselin 11-13, 6-11, 7-11 in the men's quarterfinals.



Hridoy's epic double hundred hands Bangladesh the lead

Towhid Hridoy became the highest individual scorer for Bangladesh as he lifted his team in the second and final Test against the West Indies at Sylhet on Saturday. His unbeaten 242 helped Bangladesh reach 386 and take a 30-run lead in the first innings. In reply, the West Indies was seven for no loss when bad light forced early stumps.

The scores: West Indies 356 & 7/0 in 4 overs vs. Bangladesh 386 (Towhid Hridoy 242 n.o., Jomel Warrican 4/104).

Raiza-Mairaj pair finishes fourth in four-team final

India's disappointing campaign at the ISSF World Championships continued as both its skeet mixed teams returned empty-handed, with Raiza Dhillon and Mairaj Ahmad Khan coming close to a podium finish before ending up fourth and last in the four-team final in Doha on Saturday. Raiza and Mairaj managed a combined score of 19 in the final. Finland's Marjut Heinonen and Eetu Kallioinen clinched gold.

Former India women's hockey team coach Bhangu no more

Gurdial Singh Bhangu, the coach who masterminded India's historic women's hockey gold medal at the 2002 Commonwealth Games, passed away in Surrey, Canada. He was 86. Hockey India condoled his demise in a post on X. Bhangu's name will forever be associated with one of the most memorable victories in Indian women's hockey. Under his guidance, India defeated England 3-2 in the Commonwealth Games final at Manchester. Bhangu took over as India's chief coach in 1998, following the team's 12th-place finish at the Women's Hockey World Cup. Under his guidance, India claimed the silver medal at the Bangkok Asian Games later that year. His contribution to Indian hockey was recognised with the Dronacharya Award in 2000.

LIVE TELECAST

SUNDAY

Bangladesh vs. West Indies: Second Test, Day 4, FanCode, 9.30 a.m.

Men's u-19 Asia Cup: India vs. Pakistan, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.

SAFF Championship: VETO App, 3 & 7.30 p.m.

ISL: Sony Sports Ten 2 & LIV, 5 & 7.30 p.m.

Premier League: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 7.30 & 10 p.m.

Formula One: Sao Paulo GP, F1 TV, F1 TV Pro App & FanCode, 10.30 p.m.

LaLiga: Atletico Madrid vs. Barcelona, FanCode, 1.30 a.m. (Monday).

New Zealand-A vs. India-A: Third 'Test' , Day 3, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 3.30 a.m. (Monday).

MONDAY

Bangladesh vs. West Indies: Second Test, Day 5, FanCode, 9.30 a.m.

Men's u-19 Asia Cup: Sony Sports Ten 1, 5 & LIV, 10.30 a.m.

New Zealand-A vs. India-A: Third 'Test', Day 4, Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 3.30 a.m. (Tuesday).

Jaiswal slams second ton, hits top gear ahead of Tests

The southpaw's strokeful knock and his 175-run opening stand with Sai Sudharsan put India-A in control after being asked to take first strike in the final 'Test'; the in-form Padikkal falls cheaply

INDIA-A IN NZ

Press Trust of India
LINCOLN

Yashasvi Jaiswal scored his second consecutive First Class hundred, steering India-A to 227 for two at stumps on the opening day of the third 'Test' against New Zealand-A here on Saturday.

Jaiswal (102, 138b, 16x4, 2x6), whose form had become a matter of concern after the first red-ball game of the tour, has regained his touch ahead of the two-Test series beginning on November 19. He and B. Sai Sudharsan put on 175 runs for the opening wicket.

Play was called off after rain lashed the Bert Sutcliffe Oval in the 70th over of the day. The pitch had a greenish look to it but the Indian batters had a good time batting on it.

Sai Sudharsan (77, 205b, 10x4) and captain Dhruv Jurel (12) were in the middle when stumps were drawn.

The game has added significance with the presence of Jasprit Bumrah, Ravindra Jadeja and Prasidh Krishna, who are the playing the final India-A game as part of their preparation for the Test series.



Turning on the style: Jaiswal cut and drove with panache en route his hundred. FILE PHOTO: R.V. MOORTHY

The day well and truly belonged to Jaiswal, who batted aggressively against the New Zealand-A pacers and came up with several cuts and pulls and delightful cover drives.

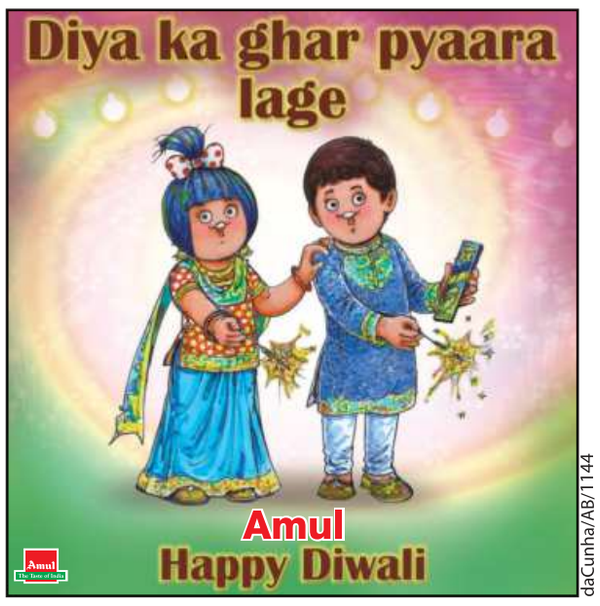
The left-hander got to his half-century with a copybook cover-drive off seamer Brett Randell. He was particularly severe on Jarrod McKay, picking him for three straight boundaries twice in his innings. He was dropped on 54 to add to the woes of the home team.

He got into the 90s with a rasping cut off Cameron Paul before completing his century with a sweep in the 44th over bowled by off-spinner Dean Foxcroft.

He departed soon after as he hit a delivery from Danru Ferns straight into the hands of the mid-off fielder. McKay removed the in-form Devdutt Padikkal (15) in the 63rd over. The batter went for an expansive drive only to be caught behind.

The first two matches ended in draws.

The scores: India-A 227/2 in 69.3 overs (Jaiswal 102, Sai Sudharsan 77 batting) vs. New Zealand-A.
Toss: New Zealand-A.



daCunha/AB/1144

Khawaja claims entire Australian team knew about 'Sandpapergate'

Agence France-Presse
SYDNEY



Umpires Illingworth and Llong question Bancroft. AFP

Usman Khawaja claimed on Saturday that the entire Australian team knew about the 2018 "Sandpapergate" scandal in Cape Town and said it also employed the tactic during the previous Test at Port Elizabeth.

Captain Steve Smith, his deputy David Warner and Cameron Bancroft were sent home in disgrace and found by a Cricket Australia investigation to be the only three players with prior knowledge of the ball-tampering plot.

But former opener Khawaja, who retired this year after 88 Tests, told the *Sydney Morning Herald* that everyone knew.

"It was all of us. Not the batters, not the bowlers, not the staff. All of us," he said ahead of the release of his autobiography next week.

Bowlers Pat Cummins, Mitchell Starc, Josh Hazlewood and Nathan Lyon all denied publicly in 2021 that they knew about it.

Khawaja said he spoke in the dressing room after the Cape Town Test urging the team to take collective responsibility, rather than scapegoating Warner, Smith and Bancroft.

Darren Lehmann, who was head coach at the time, denied there was widespread knowledge of the plot, while claiming ball-tampering was once ever-present in international cricket.

Plans or mindset, Uday is 'clear' about his path

Tarun Shastry
NEW CHANDIGARH



Uday. FILE PHOTO: SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

One outright win, three draws, 13 points and third place in the points table.

The numbers tell only a part of Punjab's Ranji Trophy campaign. But captain Uday Saharan isn't one to dwell on what might have been. Consider its latest outing against Andhra. Staring down the barrel at 71 for five on day one, Punjab fought back to declare at 592 for nine.

"When you are 71 for five, you hope and think anything around 200 or 250 would be good. But to score 592, that's a big thing," Uday told *The Hindu*.

"It wasn't turning, and it wasn't seaming. So, it would be a bit harsh on the bowlers if I told them to go and take 20 wickets."

With the Ranji season resuming only in January, Uday's attention now turns to white-ball cricket.

"In red ball, I am really clear about my plans. How do I operate? How do I go in? How do I set up my innings? In the white ball, it's all about a clear mindset," he said.

The shorter format has already opened another avenue for the youngster, who had attended IPL trials with Mumbai Indians, Rajasthan Royals, Royal Challengers Bengaluru and Sunrisers Hyderabad. "Yes, I have given [trials]," he said.

With the mini-auction approaching in December, there is plenty to keep Uday occupied.

Sanvir ready for the white-ball format

Tarun Shastry
NEW CHANDIGARH



Sanvir. TARUN SHASTRY

What do you do when wickets tumble in a hurry on the first morning of a Ranji Trophy encounter?

Walk in, negotiate the difficult period and go on the double.

Punjab's Sanvir Singh did precisely that against Andhra, his sensational 205 rescuing the host from 71 for five and powering the side to a mammoth total.

"It felt really good because this was my first match of the season. I came in at a crucial stage. Salil (Arora) and me batted through that session, and after that, we piled on the runs," Sanvir told *The Hindu*.

With moisture making batting difficult initially, the duo chose patience over adventure.

"We weren't thinking about any target. We were just playing sessions," he added.

As the surface baked under the afternoon sun, the moisture dried up, making batting easier, and the 30-year-old made the most of it on his way to a maiden double-hundred.

Sanvir, who was part of the Sunrisers Hyderabad set-up in 2023 and 2024, felt that a few days of practice would be sufficient to adjust to the change in formats as the action shifts to white-ball cricket.

"I just want to enjoy my game and contribute to wins in whatever format I play," he said.

AFC award for Nivetha

Sports Bureau



Nivetha.

R. Nivetha has won the youth female Coach of the Year Award at the Asian Football Confederation (AFC) Elite Youth Football Awards 2026.

She will receive the award at a ceremony, to be held in Kuala Lumpur on December 8 and 9, in conjunction with the AFC Women's Football Conference and the AFC Youth Conference.

"It's a dream come true to receive the award. Now, I have to manage expectations and continue doing my duty with dedication. My goal is to ensure India does well in the 2027 AFC U-17 Women's Asian Cup in China," the 34-year-old told *The Hindu*.

Nivetha has been associated with the Indian u-17 women's team since 2020-2021.

Timeless Vision may have the edge over her rivals

HYDERABAD: The five-year-old mare Timeless Vision, demoted to Class II, may have the edge over her rivals in the upper division of the Democracy Plate, the feature event on the opening day of the Hyderabad Winter Races on Monday, November 9.

1 OSMAN SAGAR TROPHY (Div. II) (1,400m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 1.20 p.m.: 1. Aprameya (1) Neeraj 60, 2. Mantle Plume (4) B.R. Kumar 58.5, 3. War Captain (6) Rafique Sk. 57, 4. Northern Sky (8) Mukesh K 56.5, 5. Khamagani (3) Gaurav S 56, 6. Vespucci (5) Mohit S 56, 7. Velvera (2) P. Ajeeth K 55.5 and 8. See My Attitude (7) Kuldeep Jr. 54.
1. APRAMEYA, 2. MANTLE PLUME, 3. NORTHERN SKY

2 DEMOCRACY PLATE (Div. II) (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85 (Cat. II), 1.55: 1. High Speed Dive (8) Rafique Sk. 60, 2. Star Of Opera (6) Surendra S 58.5, 3. Certainty (1) Arjun S 58, 4. Walking Thunder (5) P. Ajeeth K 58, 5. Dyanoosh (4) Sonu K 56, 6. Glorious Power (3) Bhawani S 55, 7. Dubai Touch (2) Neeraj 54 and 8. Catch The Worm (7) B.R. Kumar 53.
1. STAR OF OPERA, 2. DUBAI TOUCH, 3. HIGH SPEED DIVE

3 KAMAREDDY TROPHY (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 40 to 65 (Cat. II), 2.30: 1. Hurricane Bay (11) Md. Ekram 61, 2. Ojas Maximus (8) Suraj Narredu 61, 3. Miss Smiley Angel (7) Mukesh K 59.5, 4. Cosmic Gift (6) Trevor 55, 5. Home Run (3) Akshay K 55, 6. Divine Tiger (4) Kuldeep Jr. 54.5, 7. Catchme If You Can (1) D.S. Deora 52.5, 8. Red Hot Punch (12) Ashad Asbar 52.5, 9. Excalibur (9) P. Ajeeth K 52, 10. N R I Crypto Power (2) B.R. Kumar 52, 11. Her Ladyship (5) G. Naresh 51 and 12. Alcahol Free (10) Rafique Sk. 50.
1. OJAS MAXIMUS, 2. COSMIC GIFT, 3. N R I CRYPTO POWER

4 OSMAN SAGAR TROPHY (Div. I), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.05: 1. Digital Empress (5) P. Ajeeth K 60, 2. Grit 'N' Grace (7) Mukesh K 59, 3. Caramel (2) Md. Ekram 56.5, 4. Gacchanmanasvin (8) Swarup S 56.5, 5. Sara (3) Mohit S 56.5, 6. Beech Wood (1) G. Naresh 56, 7. Golden Aura (4) Sonu K 55.5 and 8. American Gangster (6) Gaurav S 54.
1. GRIT 'N' GRACE, 2. DIGITAL EMPRESS, 3. GACCHANMANASVIN

5 ARMAGNAC PLATE (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 20 to 45 (Cat. III), 3.40: 1. Juramento (10) Sonu K 60, 2. Top In Class (11) A.A. Vikrant 60, 3. Inderdhanush (4) Kuldeep Sr. 59, 4. Victoria Dhora (3) Abhay S 58.5, 5. Phoebus (7) Trevor 56.5, 6. Bodhi (12) Kuldeep Jr. 55, 7. Magical Touch (6) Afroz K 55, 8. Veera's Princess (8) Ajay K 55, 9. First Kiss (13) Mukesh K 54.5, 10. Miss Lovely Angel (2) Rafique Sk. 54, 11. My Day (5) Gaurav S 54, 12. Silver Lining (1) Md. Ekram 54 and 13. Rate Of Interest (9) G. Naresh 52.
1. BODHI, 2. FIRST KISS, 3. PHOEBUS

6 DEMOCRACY PLATE (Div. I) (1,100m), 3-y-o and upward, rated 60 to 85 (Cat. II), 4.15: 1. Timeless Vision (3) Akshay K 60, 2. Emerald Touch (1) Suraj Narredu 57, 3. Minecraft (2) Rafique Sk. 57, 4. Exclusive Black (6) Trevor 56, 5. Ayushman (5) Afroz K 54.5, 6. Darling's Boy (4) Kuldeep Sr. 53, 7. Torchbearer (7) Kuldeep Jr. 52.5 and 8. Warwick (8) Ashad Asbar 51.5.
1. TIMELESS VISION, 2. AYUSHMAN, 3. EMERALD TOUCH

7 OWN OPINION PLATE (1,200m), 3-y-o and upward, rated upto 25, (Cat. III), 4.50: 1. Aloy (14) Mohit S 62, 2. Ashwa Vivegam (13) Gaurav S 62, 3. Crimson Rose (7) Kuldeep Jr. 62, 4. Dhanadeepa (1) D.S. Deora 62, 5. Ruby Tuesday (6) Rafique Sk. 62, 6. Sporting Touch (2) Sonu K 62, 7. Vidyutprabhava (12) Santosh Raj 62, 8. Meadow (4) Md. Ekram 61.5, 9. Amboseli (10) Afroz K 60, 10. Most Beautiful (3) Deepak S 60, 11. Golden Inzio (5) A.A. Vikrant 56.5, 12. Char Ek Char (8) Kuldeep Sr. 56, 13. Hopewell Island (11) G. Naresh 50 and 14. Niloufer The Great (9) Ajay K 50.
1. AMBOSELI, 2. ASHWA VIVEGAM, 3. CHAR EK CHAR
Day's Best: **OJAS MAXIMUS**
Jackpot: 3, 4, 5, 6 & 7.
Mini Jackpot: (i) 1, 2, 3 & 4, (ii) 4, 5, 6 & 7.
Treble: (i) 2, 3 & 4, (ii) 5, 6 & 7.
Tanala: All races.

Ice Of Fire may score an encore in the Rajyotsava Cup

BENGALURU: Ice Of Fire, who is in fine fettle, may score an encore in the Rajyotsava Cup (1,400m), the feature event of the race to be held here on Sunday (Nov 8).
There will be no false rails.

1 NOVEMBER PLATE (1,200m), rated 00 to 25, 1.30 p.m.: 1. Amazing Storm (1) Vishal S 62, 2. Sea Diamond (4) M. Prabhakaran 62, 3. Hold Your Breath (2) Laxman S 61, 4. Victoria Moon (8) A. Hangal 61, 5. Anzac Parade (3) N. Darshan 58, 6. Martha (6) Rushal G.A 57.5, 7. Striking Eyes (5) Suhas K 56 and 8. N R I Millennium (7) S. Qureshi 54.
1. HOLD YOUR BREATH, 2. STRIKING EYES, 3. ANZAC PARADE

2 GOMOS PLATE (1,400m), rated 60 to 85, 2.00: 1. Lux Aeterna (5) Suhas K 60, 2. Crosswater (3) Aleemuddin 59.5, 3. Irish Coffee (4) Suraj 59, 4. Felisa (1) Arvind K 56.5, 5. Quattro (2) A. Asbar 55.5 and 6. Forseti (6) Shreyas S 55.
1. QUATTRO, 2. IRISH COFFEE

3 UDUPI PLATE (1,400m), rated 40 to 65, 4-y-o & over, 2.30: 1. Mister Brown (1) Trevor 60, 2. Akitania (5) Yash 59.5, 3. Glorious Strides (7) Suraj 59.5, 4. Circle Of Dreams (3) Akshay K 59, 5. Disciple (4) Aleemuddin 58.5, 6. Stravinsky (8) R. Vaibhav 55.5, 7. Knotty Imperador (6) Arul 54, 8. Live The Dream (2) Laxman S 53.5 and 9. Lasya (9) A. Asbar 52.
1. CIRCLE OF DREAMS, 2. MISTER BROWN, 3. GLORIOUS STRIDES

4 T.B. HANUMANTHARAJ MEMORIAL TROPHY (1,200m), rated 40 to 65, 3.00: 1. All Attraction (5) Vishal S 62.5, 2. Bellavita (6) Arul 62, 3. La Mcqueen (2) Aleemuddin 60, 4. Black Rainstorm (10) B. Nayak 59, 5. Royal Deccan (11) N. Darshan 59, 6. Joondalup (9) Laxman S 57, 7. Auspicious King (8) R. Vaibhav 56, 8. Deep Respect (7) Darshan 55, 9. Doncaster Belle (4) Trevor 54.5, 10. Hazel (1) S. Shareef 54 and 11. Solara (3) Akshay K 51.
1. DEEP RESPECT, 2. DONCASTER BELLE, 3. SOLARA

5 RAJYOTSAVA CUP (1,400m), 3-y-o & over, 3.30: 1. Emphatic (2) Yash 60, 2. Ice Of Fire (7) A. Asbar 60, 3. Efficacy (1) Trevor 59.5, 4. Once You Go Black (5) Suraj 59.5, 5. Czar (4) Arul 58.5, 6. Galahad (3) Akshay K 58.5 and 7. Ricardo (6) Aleemuddin 58.5.
1. ICE OF FIRE, 2. EFFICACY

6 BANGALORE CITY POLICE CUP (1,400m), maiden 3-y-o only, (Terms), 4.00: 1. Approval (9) G. Praveen 57, 2. Shining Path (4) Arul 57, 3. Sun Supreme (1) Tousif 57, 4. Zenzele (7) Shreyas S 57, 5. Celtic Goddess (2) Akshay K 55.5, 6. Evermore (12) Md. Aliyar 55.5, 7. Fine Silver (5) A. Asbar 55.5, 8. Knotty Spirit (3) N. Darshan 55.5, 9. Perfect Dream (8) Trevor 55.5, 10. Sigrid (6) Aleemuddin 55.5, 11. Tyche (10) Srinath 55.5 and 12. Zakharova (11) Arvind K 55.5.
1. TYCHE, 2. CELTIC GODDESS, 3. ZAKHAROVA

7 MALAPRABHA PLATE (1,200m), rated 20 to 45, 4-y-o & over, 4.30: 1. Supreme Success (9) Vishwa V 62.5, 2. Jade Mountain (10) A. Asbar 61.5, 3. El Rey (6) Suraj 60, 4. Excellence (3) Aleemuddin 59.5, 5. Rocking Star (4) A. Hangal 59.5, 6. Darrington (2) Darshan 58.5, 7. Star Comet (1) Shreyas S 58.5, 8. Zayana (8) L.A. Rozario 58.5, 9. Noble Cause (7) Rafique S.K 56.5, 10. Big B (11) R. Vaibhav 54.5, 11. Black Rainforest (5) Lave Kumar 54 and 12. Sustaining Grace (12) Rayan 51.
1. EXCELLENCE, 2. EL REY, 3. JADE MOUNTAIN

8 JOG FALLS PLATE (1,400m), rated 20 to 45, 5-00: 1. Don DP (8) Salman Khan 60.5, 2. Como (5) Akshay K 58.5, 3. Honeypot (11) Tauseef 58, 4. Mnemosyne (6) Vivek 57.5, 5. Kaori (2) Srinath 57, 6. Brave Anjani (10) Ganesh S 56.5, 7. Valor Queen (12) Trevor 55.5, 8. Fortissima (9) L.A. Rozario 54, 9. Shahenshaah (3) Lave Kumar 54, 10. Elveden (1) Shreyas S 53, 11. Joyful Spirit (7) Rushal G.A 53 and 12. Sunlit Path (4) R. Robert 53.
1. VALOR QUEEN, 2. COMO, 3. FORTISSIMA
Day's best: **ICE OF FIRE**
Double: **QUATTRO - CIRCLE OF DREAMS**
Jkt: 4, 5, 6, 7 and 8; Mini Jkt: 5, 6, 7 and 8; Tr (i): 3, 4 and 5; (ii): 6, 7 and 8.

THE HINDU

News in Frames



Against the wind: People brave strong winds and rain as high waves batter the shore in Visakhapatnam on October 27, ahead of Cyclone Arnab. K.R. DEEPAK



Waves of warning: Visitors to the beach watch high waves crashing along the Visakhapatnam coast on October 27. K.R. DEEPAK



Rough ride: A motorist navigates a storm-battered street at Mangamaripeta in Visakhapatnam on October 28, a day after Cyclone Arnab brought heavy rain. K.R. DEEPAK



Road to recovery: Disaster response personnel work to restore a stretch of road washed away by waves at Uppada coastal village in Kakinada district after Cyclone Arnab. V. RAJU

Many twists in the monsoon's tale

Andhra Pradesh swung from drought to deluge, with two back-to-back cyclones causing an estimated ₹6,500 cr. in damage and leaving at least 17 dead; crops were flattened and coconut trees uprooted, with farmers in the Godavari belt facing at least two years of recovery

Andhra Pradesh is witnessing two extremes this year: drought and deluge. During the initial monsoon months of June and July, the State declared drought in 388 of its 688 mandals across 28 districts. By the end of October, however, extremely heavy rainfall had battered many of these mandals, except those in Rayalaseema.

Between October 28 and November 3, Andhra Pradesh was hit by two back-to-back cyclones – Very Severe Cyclonic Storm 'Arnab' and Severe Cyclonic Storm 'Murasu' – leaving the coastal districts in ruins.

With wind speeds reaching 140 kmph during Arnab and 110 kmph during Murasu, the two cyclones are estimated to have caused damage worth approximately ₹6,500 crore. They also left at least 17 people dead, uprooted hundreds of electricity poles and damaged roads across the State. Arnab wreaked havoc in the twin Godavari districts of East and West Godavari and in the north coastal region, including Visakhapatnam.

The destruction was immense, with thousands of coconut trees uprooted and paddy, cotton and chilli crops flattened in West Godavari, East Godavari, Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema, Bapatla, Guntur and Palnadu districts. Visakhapatnam, Eluru and East Godavari recorded extremely heavy rainfall of around 260 mm.

Coconut growers in the Godavari belt say it may at least take two years for them to recover the losses. While experts debate whether climate change played a role in these weather events, farmers and fishermen continue to bear the brunt of every disaster.

A similar situation last occurred in 2013, when cyclones Helen and Lehar battered the Andhra Pradesh coast. Before that, the State witnessed similar events in 1987 and 1976.

Text by Nellore Sravani



Grid down: Thousands of electric poles collapsed in Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district after Cyclone Arnab made landfall near Bendamurlanka on October 28. More than 10,000 new poles are being installed across the district. V. RAJU



Picking up the pieces: A family tries to salvage its fishing nets after Cyclone Arnab devastated Odalarevu village in Dr. B.R. Ambedkar Konaseema district. Some boats also had to be repaired. V. RAJU



Restoring power: Electricity workers from Bengaluru repair damaged power lines near the Old Bypass Road in Ongole, Prakasam district, on November 3, following Cyclone Murasu. KOMMURI SRINIVAS



Sea in turmoil: Fishermen try to move their boats to safer spots along the Pallepalem coast near Kothapatnam as Cyclone Murasu nears the Andhra Pradesh coastline on November 2. KOMMURI SRINIVAS



Before the storm: Fishermen carry boat engines and equipment to store under cover as the clouds gather over Pallepalem coast near Kothapatnam ahead of Cyclone Murasu. KOMMURI SRINIVAS



Blown away: The damaged roof of a petrol bunk at Chadhalawada village in Prakasam district on November 3, after Cyclone Murasu brought strong winds and heavy rain. KOMMURI SRINIVAS